

אריה, “brick(?)—cubits.” Perhaps a brick-cubit is between a cubit and a span (= half cubit), c. 30 cm.³⁸ WACHOLDER, GARCIA MARTINEZ, VERMES, and WISE follow Allegro and Milik.³⁹ It should be noted that ALLEGRO^{fr}, LURIE, PIXNER, WOLTERS, and BEYER consider אמות אריה as one entity.

אַרְבָּעִין, “forty,” like the other ‘tens’ in the Scroll, עֶשְׂרִין, “twenty” (7:6, 10:11, 12:9), עֶשְׂרִין (8:13), שֵׁשִׁין, “sixty” (2:6, 5:10, 10:7, 12:1), שִׁבְעִין, “seventy” (2:6), and שִׁבְעִין (4:12) are spelled with a (final) *nun* instead of final *mem*. The teens (20-90) have the same formation as the usual masculine plural לִים-, which occurs most of the time as לִין- in the Scroll (like כְּכָרִין, “talents,” later in this item). The plural לִין- ending occurs several times in the Masoretic Text (e.g., Ezek. 26:18; Job 31:10), although never in numbers. Mishnaic Hebrew uses both forms indiscriminately.⁴⁰

ארוה or אריה may well be a scribal error. If this is the case, it must be a dittography of אמות rather than ארבעין, since the word in question can be read as ארות where only the letters *reš* and *mem* are mixed up. It is unlikely that an entire word be left uncorrected when a single letter of the first word of the Scroll was corrected.

While Lurie’s reading is acceptable, his interpretation is not. If אמות אַרְבָּעִין is equal to 15 cubits, why is it not so indicated? It is either אמה “cubit” or אַרְיָה (MH), “a half brick” (also used as a measurement).⁴¹

The Aramaic cognate of אַרְיָה is אַרְיָחא, “half-brick, pole, bar.”⁴² Maimonides says that לְבִינָה (fem.), a “brick” is three by three handbreadths, and

38 Beyer, 224-25.

39 *The Dawn of Qumran*, 94; Garcia Martinez, 461; Vermes, 374; Wise, 191.

40 The *nun* ending is used in Moabite: שלשין, “thirty,” ארבעין, “forty,” חמשים, “fifty” (*KAI*, 1, 33 [#181:2,8,28]); Biblical Aramaic: עֶשְׂרִין, “twenty” (Dan. 6:2), תְּלָתִין, “thirty” (Dan. 6:8,13), שֵׁשִׁין, “sixty” (Ezra 6:3; Dan. 3:1, 6:1); Targumim: עֶשְׂרִין, “twenty” (Gen. 32:14,16), תְּלָתִין (Gen. 18:30), אַרְבָּעִין, “forty” (Gen. 18:29), etc. The *mem* ending is used in Ugaritic: *šrm*, “twenty” (41:5), *arb’m*, “forty” (41:2), *ṭlm*, “thirty” (3:19), etc.; Phoenician: שלשם, “thirty,” חמשם, “fifty,” תשעם, “ninety”; Punic: ארבעם, “forty,” חמשם, “fifty,” עסרם, “twenty,” שלשם, “thirty” (*KAI* 1, 1,4,9,14,20,21,25,26,29 [#3:2; #19:8; #41:5; #101:4; #110:3-4; #111:3-4; #130:2-3; #141:3; #158:3]), etc.

41 E.g., “and an אַרְיָה is a half of a brick of three handbreadths” (m. ‘Eruv. 1:3). The Talmudim compare to manner of writing of the Song of the Sea (Exod. 15:1-19) and Song of Deborah (Judg. 5:1-31) to bricklaying; i.e., אַרְיָה על גְּבִי לְבִינָה וּלְבִינָה על גְּבִי אַרְיָה, “a half brick upon a whole brick and a whole brick upon a half brick,” while the list of the ten sons of Haman (Esth. 9:7) and that of the kings of Canaan (Josh. 12:9-24) אַרְיָה על גְּבִי אַרְיָה, “a half brick upon a half brick and a whole brick upon a whole brick” (y. Meg. 3:7 [26a]; b. Meg. 16b). Rashi explains that אַרְיָה is the written text while לְבִינָה is the empty space which is twice the size of the written text.

42 E.g., “in a house of seven לְבִינָה וְאַרְיָה (bricks and a half brick) ... and it was missing one אַרְיָה (half brick)” (b. Shab. 129a). Also, אַרְיָה is the Targum for מוֹט, “pole, bar” (Num. 4:10, etc.), and בַּר, “pole, bar” (Exod. 27:6, etc.).

אַרְיֵה, "a half brick," is one-and-half by three handbreadths.⁴³ According to the uncovered square shaped bricks in Palestine, a half-brick is between 11.2 by 22.5 and 12.5 by 25 cm.⁴⁴ Additional interpretations of אַרְיֵה are discussed below.

אַמָּה (fem., pl. אַמּוֹת), "cubit," the most frequent word in the Scroll, it occurs thirty-five times. Its cognates are אַמְהוּא (pl. אַמִּין, Aramaic), and *am-matu* (Akkadian).⁴⁵ אַמָּה is a unit of length, the size of the אַמָּה, "forearm," of an average man; it is five, six, or seven handbreadths long. The accepted values in Halakhah varies, being 48 cm, 54 cm, 57 cm, and 62.4 cm. According to Brand, the cubit of the First Temple era was 45 cm.⁴⁶ Regarding the secondary meaning of אַמָּה (MH), "canal," see #21, 5:1-2.

There were various types of cubits. E.g., אַמָּה בִּינוּיִית, "average cubit" (m. Kel. 17:10); אַמָּה גְּמוּדָה, "short cubit" (y. Yoma 4:4 [20b]); אַמָּה גְּרוּמָה, "short cubit" (b. Zev. 62b); אַמָּה עֲצָבָה, "short cubit" (b. 'Eruv. 3b); אַמָּה שׁוֹחֶקֶת, "large cubit" (b. 'Eruv. 3b; cf. טַפַּח שׁוֹחֶק [masc.], "large handbreadth," b. Suk. 7a); אַמַּת הַכֵּלִים, "cubit of the (Temple) vessels" (m. Kel. 17:10); אַמַּת הַבְּנַיִן, "cubit of the (Temple) building" (m. Kel. 17:10); אַמַּת מֹשֶׁה, "cubit of Moses" (m. Kel. 17:9); אַמָּה שֶׁל קֹדֶשׁ, "Temple cubit" (b. 'Eruv. 48a); אַמַּת אִישׁ, "cubit of man," i.e., large cubit (Deut. 3:11). There were two measuring rods deposited in the Shushan Chamber of the Temple, one was one cubit of Moses plus one-half fingerbreadth, while the other one cubit of Moses plus one fingerbreadth (m. Kel. 17:9).

Furthermore, the difficult phrase, מִלּוֹ הַקֶּנֶה שֵׁשׁ אַמּוֹת אֲצִילָה, "the full reed is six cubits אֲצִילָה," is rendered by Jonathan as מִשְׁחַת קֶנֶה שֵׁשׁ אַמִּין רֹחַ (Ezek. 41:8). רֹחַ and אֲצִילָה have been explained as follows. Rashi: אַמּוֹת אֲצִילָה means large cubits (Exod. 24:11). Radak: אַמָּה, "cubit," is the distance from the tip of the forefinger to the elbow, while אֲצִילָה, "large." Thus, אַמּוֹת אֲצִילָה means "large cubits," i.e., the distance from the tip of the forefinger to the armpit. רֹחַ,

43 See *Tosephot Yom-Tov* (referring to Maimonides) and *Tif'eret Israel* on m. 'Eruv. 1:3.

44 See Y. Brand, "לאורך האמה העתיקה שלנו" in *Sinai* 40 (1958), 574. According to N. Lloyd, in Babylon the brick was 13 X 13 X 3-3.5 inches ("Brickwork," *Encyclopaedia Britannica* 4 [1941], 118a).

45 אַמְהוּא is one of those feminine nouns that form their plural in Hebrew with the suffix -ות (i.e., אַמּוֹת), while in Aramaic with -ין (i.e., אַמִּין; e.g., Dan. 3:1; Ezra 6:3).

46 Y. Brand, "לאורך האמה העתיקה שלנו" in *Sinai* 40 (1958), 673-81. Regarding the Halakhic views, see Y.G. Weiss, *Torah Metrology* (Heb.), 203 et passim. The various measurement of the cubit mentioned by Weiss vary between 432 and 632 mm. Ben-David concludes that the "builders cubit" was 560 mm. ("The Hebrew-Phoenician Cubit," *PEQ* 110 [1978], 27-28). Regarding the cubit of the Temple and of Qumran, see D. Chen, "Cubit of the Temple, Cubit of Qumran," *Proceedings of the Tenth World Congress of Jewish Studies, Jerusalem, August 16-24, 1989*, Div. B, Vol. 2 (1990), 9-14.

“width,” means that in the width there were six cubits. Ibn-Ezra: בָּאַמָּה, “according to ‘the’ cubit” of the Tabernacle” (Exod. 37:9), may refer to an אַצִּילָה type of measurement used in the First Temple. *Ma’amar Yom-Tov* (ad loc.) further explains that the length of this cubit was till the אַצִּילֵי יָדַיִם, “armholes”; cf. תַּחַת אַצְלוֹת יָדֶיךָ, “under your armholes” (Jer. 38:12).⁴⁷ *Mešudat David*: אַמּוֹת אַצִּילָה are large cubits, each having six handbreadths (Ezek. 41:8). BDB: אַצִּילָה might be an architectural term meaning “to the joining.”⁴⁸ Steinberg: אַצִּיל (masc.) is the upper arm. אַמַּת אַצִּילָה is a large cubit, the measure of the arm till the armpit, like אַמַּת אִישׁ (Deut. 3:11).⁴⁹ Harkavy: אַצִּיל means “wing of a building,” אַצִּילָה (with a directional *he*), “to the wing.”⁵⁰ Ben-Yehuda: אַצִּילָה (masc., the accent is on the penultimate syllable) cannot be connected with the feminine אַמּוֹת.⁵¹ Yehoash: אַצִּילָה could mean “at/to the upper arm” or “to the joining.”⁵² Even-Shoshan: אַצִּילָה is a “linear measurement longer than a regular cubit, apparently from the end of the middle finger to the armpit.” It may be an ancient measurement.⁵³ Others translate the phrase in question as: “a full reed of six cubits to the joining” (JPSⁱ); “a full reed of six long cubits” (NRSV, Koren); “its elevation was a rod’s length, or six cubits” (JPSⁱⁱ); “a full rod [thick], a six cubits space” (*Tanach*); etc.

Silber claims that אַמּוֹת אַצִּילָה never existed, it is an error originating from Radak’s explanation. Silber reasons: (1) Since אַמּוֹת is plural while אַצִּילָה is singular, it is grammatically erroneous. (2) אַמַּת אַצִּילָה as a measurement is unknown from Biblical or other sources.⁵⁴ Both of these reasons are not convincing. (1) The construct אַמּוֹת אַצִּילָה is the same as אַמּוֹת שֶׁל אַצִּילָה. Since אַצִּילָה defines אַמַּת, it need not be plural; cf. כְּמִדּוֹת גְּזִית וְאַרְזוֹ, “like the measures of the hewn stones and cedar wood” (1 Kgs 7:11); עָרֵי מְצוּרָה vs. עָרֵי מְצֻרוֹת, “fortified cities” (2 Chron. 14:5 and 11:10, respectively). (2) Being one of the many rare biblical words not found in other sources cannot be considered automatically incorrect.

As noted above, the length of an אַמַּת, “cubit, arm,” can be five, six, or seven טֶפַחִים (pl. of טֶפַח טֶפַח, BH, MH), “handbreadths.” The Hebrew קֶנֶה (const. קֶנֶה; pl. קֶנֶיִם; const. קֶנִּי) and the Aramaic קֶנֶה - קֶנִּי (emph. קֶנִּיאָ, pl. קֶנִּין, emph. קֶנִּיאָ, “reed” (or “rod”), is also used as a unit of length. Ac-

47 See also M.J. Weinstock, “He’arot uVi’urim” on *Ma’amar Yom-Tov* (164 n. 14), who refers to Ezek. 41:8.

48 BDB, 69b.

49 SB, 51b, 67a.

50 Harkavy, 36b.

51 BY 1, 368 n. 4.

52 *Yehoash’s Notes on the Bible*, 184a.

53 ESh^{dic} 1, 146a; ESh^{con} 1, 194b, respectively.

54 “הגיוני לשון בעקבות פשוטו של מקרא” in *Lešonenu* 26 (1961/62), 6. Neither Brand nor Weiss mention the term אַמּוֹת אַצִּילָה.

cording to Ezekiel and its Targum, a קנה, "reed," is six אַמּוֹת אֶצְלָה or אַמּין רֹחַ; i.e., "six large cubits." In the Aramaic text of New Jerusalem a 'reed' is equated to seven cubits; e.g., קנה חר אַמּין שְׁבַע, "one reed (i.e.) seven cubits" (4Q554 5:6); 21 קנין תלתה אַמּין, "three reeds (i.e.) 21 cubits" (4Q554 3:13-14). Since a regular cubit is equal six handbreadths, while a large one is equal to seven, therefore, a reed is equal seven regular cubits, i.e., $7 \times 6 = 42$ handbreadths, or six large cubits, i.e., $6 \times 7 = 42$ handbreadths. Thus, there is no conflict between the two systems in all three sources, Ezekiel, Targum, and New Jerusalem; the reed has a standard measurement. The above conclusion supports the notion that אַמּוֹת אֶצְלָה and רֹחַ אַמּין did exist, and the proper meaning is "large cubits."

The first letter of ארוח may be a prosthetic 'alef, the same as רוח/רוח, "side, direction, corner, edge, width, side, space, interval" (e.g., בארבע, "having four sid[es]," see #29, 7:5); cf. אורוע vs. אורוע, "arm" (Jer. 32:21 and Deut. 32:20, respectively).⁵⁵ Thus, אַמּוֹת אֶצְלָה = אַמּוֹת רֹחַ, the Hebrew equivalent of Targumic אַמּין רֹחַ, "spacious/large cubits." Accordingly, אַרְבָּעִין רֹחַ (= רֹחַ) אַמּוֹת אֶצְלָה means "forty large cubits" (cf. Pixner).

The 'alef of ארוח may be a contracted form of אֶל or עַל, "upon, over, in, at" (JA, MH). Thus, אַרְבָּעִין רֹחַ or אַרְבָּעִין רֹחַ = אֶלְעַל רֹחַ, "upon the width/interval/-space," and אַרְבָּעִין רֹחַ or אַרְבָּעִין רֹחַ = אֶלְעַל רֹחַ, "to/at/by/on/along the side/edge/-corner."⁵⁶ Moreover, ארוח may be a shortened form of לְבִנָּה אֶרְחוֹאֲרוֹת or לְבִנָּה אֶרְחוֹאֲרוֹת = לְבִנָּה אֶלְעַל רֹחַ/רוֹחַ, "a brick at the corner" cut in half not to protrude.⁵⁷

55 Prosthetic 'alef can be found in various sources. Masoretic Text: וּבְאֶזְרוֹעַ נְטוּיָה vs. וּבְאֶזְרוֹעַ נְטוּיָה, "and with an outstretched arm" (Jer. 32:21 and Ps. 136:12, respectively). Dead Sea Scrolls: וּבְאֶזְרוֹעַ נְטוּיָה (11QPs^a xv:14; see *DJD* IV, 36, x). Mishnah: גּוֹרֵל vs. גּוֹרֵל, "thumb, great toe" (m. Yoma 2:1 and m. Oh. 13:1, respectively). Phoenician: בעל אגור, "leader of troops" (*KAI* 1, 5; 2, 41 [#26, A-1]); cf. שְׂרֵי גִדּוּדִים, "leaders of troops" (2 Sam. 4:2). According to Ben-Hayyim, the Dead Sea sectarians did not pronounce the mobile *šewa*' as אבית גלותו (= בבית גלותו, DSH 11:6) shows; cf. אבית for בבית of better Mishnah manuscripts. Since there is no mobile *šewa*' in Samaritan, ב- is pronounced as אב (*eb*). This goes back to biblical times as אורוע - צערה - אצעה indicate. The Tiberian אַשְׁתִּים was pronounced as אַשְׁתִּים ("Traditions in the Hebrew Language, with Special Reference to the Dead Sea Scrolls," *SH* 4 [1965], 205; "מסורת השומרונים וזיקתה למסורת" *Lešonenu* 22 [1953/54], 227-28 and n. 13; also, *MNM* 2, 1249).

56 The preposition 'alef (A, MH) is an assimilated form of אֶל or עַל, "upon, above," and could mean -ב, "within the door-stop" (t. 'Eruv. 11:14). See J.N. Epstein *A Grammar of Babylonian Aramaic* (Heb., 1960), 132-36; *MNM* 2, 1258-59; also Jastrow, 1a (vocalizes as -א). Goldziher suggests that -א is abridged from אֶל, rather than עַל (I. Elbogen, "Bemerkungen Ignatz Goldzihers zu Lewys Neuhebräischem Wörterbuch," in J. Lewy, *Wörterbuch über die Talmudim und Midraschim* [1963] 4, 749). Since the *lamed* is assimilated, the letter following the 'alef, if it is possible, should have a *dageš forte*, or the *pataḥ* lengthened to a *qamaṣ*.

57 Ben-Yehuda (1, 390 n. 4) states that the origin of אריח is unknown.

אָרוּחַ may be a variant of אֹרֶחַ (cf. הַבָּאוֹת instead of הַבָּוֹאת, discussed earlier). Both אֹרֶחַ (H, A, masc., fem., from the root אָרַח, “to go, travel, lodging”), and its synonym דֶּרֶךְ (masc., fem., from the root דָּרַךְ, “to go, travel”), mean “way, path” (cf. Gen. 49:17; Isa. 30:11). Both of these are usually rendered by the Targumim as אֹרְחָא, אֹרְחָא, אֹרְחָא (e.g., Gen. 3:24, 18:11). (a) Perhaps, אֹרְחָא (= אֹרֶחַ) אֲמוֹת אֹרוּחַ means “road cubits,” a type of cubit to measure roads. Thus, אַרְבָּעִין אֹרְחָא (= אֹרֶחַ) אֲמוֹת אֹרוּחַ could mean “forty road cubits.”⁵⁸ (b) The Targum for דֶּרֶךְ אֶמָּה אֶחָת ... דֶּרֶךְ אֶמָּה רַחֵב (Ezek. 42:4). Although, the three synonyms, מִהֶלֶךְ (masc., from the root הָלַךְ, “to go”), דֶּרֶךְ, and אֹרֶחַ mean “way, path,” they could imply “distance.” Thus, the above verse and its Targum can be rendered as, “a distance of ten cubits ... a distance of one cubit.”⁵⁹

אָרִיָּה (also spelled as אִרְיָה and אִרְיָא), Ariah, was a district in Palestine (t. Kil. 1:3). אָרִיָּה וְכַפְרָנְיָה, “Ariah and her settlements” were the dwellings of the twenty-fourth priestly watch of מַעֲזִיָּה וּמַעֲזִיָּהוּ, Maaziah.⁶⁰

אָרִיָּה resembles the Arabic toponym ³Ariḥa - ³Al-Riḥa near the ancient city Jericho. Perhaps this name is derived from אָרִיָּה, or אִרְיָה may be a variant of יֶרִיחוֹ, יֶרִיחוֹ, יֶרִיחוֹ, Jericho, or בֵּית יֶרֶחַ, Beth Yerah. Regarding Jericho, see #24, 5:13; #54, 11:9.

בְּנֵי אָרַח or אֹרוּחַ could be a variant of the name Arah; בְּנֵי אָרַח, the sons of Arah of six hundred fifty-two or seven hundred men, returned with Zerubabel from Babylon (Ezra 2:5; Neh. 7:10).⁶¹ Perhaps the Arah family lived in אִרְיָה or אֹרוּחַ.

The phrase לְמִזְרַח אֲמוֹת אָרִיָּה אַרְבָּעִין has an unusual word order; one would expect לְמִזְרַח אָרִיָּה אֲמוֹת אַרְבָּעִין, “forty cubits toward east of Ariah.” Cf. חֲפֹרִיָּה חֲפֹר אֲמוֹת אַרְבַּע, instead of חֲפֹרִיָּה חֲפֹר אֲמוֹת אַרְבַּע, or חֲפֹרִיָּה חֲפֹר אֲמוֹת אַרְבַּע, “in it is hidden/dig four cubits (deep)” (see #11, 2:14); and אֲמוֹת תַּחַת הַמִּדְּפָיָה שְׁלוֹשׁ, instead of אֲמוֹת תַּחַת הַמִּדְּפָיָה שְׁלוֹשׁ, or אֲמוֹת תַּחַת הַמִּדְּפָיָה שְׁלוֹשׁ, “three cubits below the board/corpse” (see #14, 3:12-13). Accordingly, Ariah is located in or near the Valley of Achor. Yet Kohut, Jastrow, and Klein identify Ariah of the Talmud with Tarichaea, south of Tiberias. If their identification is correct, then Ariah of the Scroll cannot be identical with that of the Talmud.⁶²

אִל רִיחָה or אִרְיָה resembles the Arabic toponym Ariḥa or Al-Riḥa (אִל רִיחָה or אִרְיָה).

58 This is the reading and rendering of Wolters. This writer came to this possible solution independently; see Lefkovits^{diss} 1, 109-10.

59 This verse is rendered as: “a walk of ten cubits ... a way of one cubit” (JPSⁱ); “there was an areaway, 10 cubits ... and a road of one cubit” (JPSⁱⁱ); “a passageway ten cubits in width ... a one cubit pat” (Tanach); etc.

60 SY, 8b, 28b, 162-64. Regarding the priestly watches, see #30, 7:9.

61 Two additional persons named Arah are mentioned in the Masoretic Text (1 Chron. 7:39; Neh. 6:18).

62 Jastrow, 119b; AC 1, 279b; AAC, 66b; SY, 8b, 164.

near the ancient Jericho. Perhaps this name is derived from אַרִיחַ, or אַרִיחַ may be a variant of יְרִיחוֹ, יְרִיחוֹ, יְרִיחוֹ, Jericho, or בֵּית יְרִיחַ, bet Yerah. Regarding Jericho, see #24, 5:13; #54, 11:9.

Finally, the first letter of this word is an *alef*, while the last one can be read as *taw*. The middle two letters, *dalet/reš* and *waw/yod/zayin*, may be two parts of a single character; the first being the right leg and the top, and the second the left leg of a *het*, which remained unconnected at the upper left corner. Cf. אֲבֹת which has been recognized by Allegro as אֲמוֹת, where the *bet* is the left while the *ayin* is the right part of a *mem* (see #47, 10:9);⁶³ and a reverse situation may possibly in the word מְזוּחָרוֹ (Allegro^{dr}) instead of מְזוּחָרוֹ (Milik^{dr}), where the *he/het/taw* seems to be a *dalet/reš* and a *waw/-zayin/yod* that are touching each other (see #14, 3:11).⁶⁴ Accordingly, אֲדוֹת, אֲדוֹת, אֲדוֹת, or אֲדוֹת should be read as אֲחַת, “one” (fem.), connected with the next word אֲרָבָעִין, and it is in apposition of אֲמוֹת (also fem.); i.e., אֲמוֹת אֲחַת, אֲרָבָעִין, “forty-one cubits.”⁶⁵

Obviously, instead of אֲחַת אֲרָבָעִין, one would expect אֲחַת וְאֲרָבָעִין or אֲחַת וְאֲרָבָעִין, i.e., with the connective *waw*, “and.” Cf. “Today (is) אֶחָד וְאַרְבָּעִים יוֹם (forty-one days [masc.]) ... of the ‘Omer (count),” counted on the eve of the 26 of *Iyyar*; בֶּן אֲרָבָעִים וְאַחַת שָׁנָה רַחֲבָעָם בְּמָלְכוֹ, “Rehoboam was forty-one (fem.) years old when he began to reign” (1 Kgs 14:21).

אֲחַת אֲרָבָעִין is like אֲחַת עֶסְרָה (fem.), “eleven” (8:15).⁶⁶ In Hebrew unit(s) with tens, and ten(s) with hundred(s), etc., are connected with a *waw*, only unit(s) with teen, or unit(s) with hundred(s), etc., are not, they are in the construct state. Yet in the verse שִׁבְעִים אִישׁ וְחֲמִשִּׁים אֶלֶף אִישׁ, literally “seventy men, fifty thousand men” (1 Sam. 6:19), the connective *waw* is missing.” It actually means שִׁבְעִים אִישׁ וְחֲמִשִּׁים אֶלֶף אִישׁ, “seventy men and fifty thousand men,” i.e., “fifty thousand and seventy men” (see Radak and Ralbag). Cf. the possible reading of עֶשְׂרִין אֲרָבָע (= עֶשְׂרִין וְאַרְבָּע), “twenty-four” in

63 Allegro, 51, 162 n. 244.

64 Regarding, וְעָשָׂה אֶת תְּחוּמָּהּ כְּטַבֵּלָה מְרֻבָּעָה, “and he makes its border like a square tablet” (t. ‘Eruv. 4:13 [6:10]), Lieberman notes that one manuscript has תְּרוּמָה instead of תְּחוּמָה, where the *het* separated into a *reš* and a *waw*, thus creating the misreading תְּרוּמָה; and another one has תַּחְתִּיהָ instead of תְּחוּמָה, where the original *mem* separated into a *kaf* and a *yod*, then the *kaf* merged with the previous *waw* producing תַּחְתִּיהָ (*The Tosefta* 2, 108 and n. 63; *Tosefta ki-Fshutah* 3, 377 and n. 50; see also Zuckerman’s *Tosefta*, 145 and note to line 13). Similarly, Reich proposes that גַּר יוֹן may be an error for גַּחְוֹן, the *het* separated into a *dalet* and a *yod* (“בְּכַנּוּן גַּר יוֹן לְשִׁלָּה, לְתוֹלְדוֹתָיו שֶׁל מַעֲיִן הַגִּיחֹן בִּימֵי הַבַּיִת הַשֵּׁנִי”) in *El* 19 [1987], 330-33, 83^b; see #43, 9:14).

65 Regarding this item, many of the possible readings, such as אֲדוֹת, אֲדוֹת, אֲדוֹת, אֲדוֹת, אֲדוֹת, is immaterial, although some of them have meanings; e.g., אֲרִיָּה, “lion”; אֲרִיָּה, “lions.” Also cf. אֲרִיָּה, the Targum for יְאֹר, “canal”; e.g., Onkelos renders הַיְאֹרִים אֲרִיָּה, “the canals” (Exod. 8:1); אֲרִיָּהּ as יְאֹרֵיהֶם, “their canals” (Exod. 7:19).

66 אֲחַת עֶסְרָה is a scribal error for אֲחַת עֶסְרָה.

the Scroll (see #36, 8:13, Baker^{dr}, Allegro^{dr}).⁶⁷

אַחַת אַרְבָּעִין must be a dialectical peculiarity where the single is followed by tens without the *waw*. This usages occurs in the closely related languages. Phoenician: שלש חמשם שנה (= שְׁלוֹשׁ וְחֲמִשִּׁים שָׁנָה), “fifty-three years”; cf. תשע וְאַרְבָּעִים שָׁנָה, “forty-nine years” (Lev. 25:8). Punic: באחת (ת) ארבעם שנה (= בְּאַחַת וְאַרְבָּעִים שָׁנָה), “in the forty-first year”; בששת ארבעם שנה (= בְּשֵׁשׁ וְאַרְבָּעִים שָׁנָה), “in the forty-sixth year”; בששת חמשם שנה (= בְּשֵׁשׁ וְחֲמִשִּׁים שָׁנָה), “in the fifty-sixth year”; cf. בְּאַחַת וְשֵׁשׁ מֵאוֹת שָׁנָה, “in the six hundred first year” (Gen. 8:13); בְּעֶשְׂרִים וְשֶׁבַע שָׁנָה, “in the twenty-seventh year” (Ezek. 29:17). Neo-Punic: ששמן שש, instead of ששנם שש (= שְׁמוֹנִים וְשֵׁשׁ), “eighty three.”⁶⁸

Based on the above discussion, אַחַת אַרְבָּעִין, a single with tens without the connective *waw*, is a rare form, apparently unknown from any other Hebrew sources. See also Appendix B.

שְׁדָא אַחַת וְכָל כְּלִיָּהּ (see #57, 12:5). שְׁדָת כֶּסֶף וְכְלִיָּהּ (1:3). Both phrases have been analyzed as follows. ALLEGRO^{pr}: “a chest of silver and its contents”; “one chest and its contents.” שְׁדָא = שִׁידָא = שִׁידָה, “strong box, chest.” ALLEGRO וְכִלְיָהּ שְׁדָת כֶּסֶף וְכִלְיָהּ, “a money chest and its contents”; שְׁדָא אַחַת וְכָל כְּלִיָּהּ, “one chest and its contents.” שְׁדָת כֶּסֶף is a money chest rather than “a chest made of silver.” כְּלִיָּהּ is from the root כוּל, “contain,” cf. Syriac and Arabic כִּיל, “measure”; otherwise כְּלִי, “vessel, burden.”⁶⁹ MILIK: שְׁדָת כֶּסֶף וְכָל כְּלוֹה, “a coffer (full) of money”; שְׁדָא אַחַת וְכָל כְּלוֹה, “a coffer with its contents.” כְּלוֹה = *kullo* (וְכָלוֹה, “and its total”), the *waw* and *he* are double signs for the final *o*, a better reading than כְּלִי, “vessels.” וְכָל כְּלוֹה, “and its content,” from כִּיל וְכָל and כָּל כְּלִי, “measure, content”; or וְכָל כְּלוֹה, “and all its total,” repeated for emphasis.⁷⁰ LURIE: שְׁדָא אַחַת וְכָל כֶּסֶף וְכָל כְּלִיָּהּ, “a chest (and in it there are) silver and vessels”; שְׁדָא אַחַת וְכָל כְּלִיָּהּ, “(it is hidden) one chest, all the vessels and silver (which is in it, their value is).” In Talmudic sources שְׁדָה is a large chest with legs, and which people used to hide money. שְׁדָת כֶּסֶף does not mean “a silver chest,” rather a chest containing coins and vessels, since it is indicated that the total weight is 17 talents. The bottom of the final letter after כְּלִי is missing, it should be read as כְּלִים, “ceremonial vessels, probably priestly garments.”⁷¹ PIXNER: “[there is] a money chest and its contents”; “one chest with its con-

67 Occasionally the connective *waw* is missing but understood in the Masoretic Text, as well as in the Copper Scroll (see #32, 7:16).

68 KAI 1, 4; 2, 28 (#19:8); 1, 21; 2, 116-17 (#110:3-4); 1, 21; 2, 117 (#111:3-4); 1, 21; 2, 117-118 (#112:4); 1, 24; 2, 132-133 (#128:3); respectively. Donner and Röllig do not recognize this usage (KAI 2, 133).

69 Allegro, 33, 55, 134 n. 5, 135 n. 6; Allegro^{rev}, 21, 26.

70 Milik, 284-85, 298, 253 C-145-146; Milik^E, 139, 142.

71 Lurie, 53, 55 n. 5, 56 n. 6, 58, 123, 124.

tents" (as Allegro).⁷² WACHOLDER: "a chest of silver, whose total."⁷³ WOLTERS: שֵׁדָה וְכֵלֶיהָ, "a strongbox of silver and its vessels"; and שֵׁדָה אַחַת וְכָל כֵּלֶיהָ, "one strongbox and all its vessels."⁷⁴ GARCIA MARTINEZ: "(there is) a chest of money and its total"; "a chest and all its contents."⁷⁵ BEYER: שֵׁדָה וְכֵלֶיהָ, "a silver chest and its belongings"; and שֵׁדָה אַחַת וְכָל כֵּלֶיהָ, "one chest and all its belongings." שֵׁדָה and שֵׁדָה are Aramaism.⁷⁶ VERMES: "a box (filled with) silver"; "a box and its contents" (as Milik).⁷⁷ WISE: "a strongbox of silver and its vessels"; "one chest and all its vessels."⁷⁸

The term כֵּל occurs in the Scroll sixteen or eighteen times. Yet translating שֵׁדָה as "chest, coffer," mislead most scholars from reading the words in question as וְכֵלֶיהָ "and its (fem.) vessels/implements/components," and וְכָל כֵּלֶיהָ, "and all its (fem.) vessels/implements/components."

But what is שֵׁדָה (= שֵׁדָה = שֵׁדָה)? The absolute singular is שֵׁדָה as in שֵׁדָה אַחַת, "one (fem.) *siddah*." The construct singular is שֵׁדָה as in שֵׁדָה כֶּסֶף, "a silver *siddah*," i.e., a *siddah* made of silver or used for silver (coins). וְכֵלֶיהָ, "and its (fem.) implements," and וְכָל כֵּלֶיהָ, "and all its (fem.) implements," are in apposition to *siddah*. The feminine ending (^{alef} instead of *he*), the feminine numeral אַחַת, the feminine suffix *taw* in the construct state, the feminine plural possessive suffix of וְכֵלֶיהָ and וְכָל כֵּלֶיהָ, all indicate that שֵׁדָה is feminine noun. The silver שֵׁדָה with its components had a weight of 17 talents. This implies that the שֵׁדָה was made of or covered with silver, while that of Item #57 was not.

Both שֵׁדָה (sg.) and שֵׁדָה (pl.) occur only in the verse, "I (Qohelet) provided for myself male singers and female singers, and delights of the children of man, שֵׁדָה וְשֵׁדָה (many *siddot*)." The Targum elaborates on this verse as, "I (Qohelet) made ... bath-houses (with) מְרֻבִּין דְּשִׁדִּין מִיָּא פְּשֻׁרִי וּמְרֻבִּין דְּשִׁדִּין מִיָּא חֲמִימִי (faucets running tepid water, and faucets running warm water)" (Eccl. 2:8). Thus, שֵׁדָה (from the Aramaic root שֵׁדָה, "to pour, sprinkle"; see #38, 9:1) is explained as "faucets running water." The Talmudim say,

"שֵׁדָה and שֵׁדָה," here (in Babylon) one translates as שֵׁדָה (demoness) and שֵׁדָה (demonesses), (while) in the West (i.e., in Palestine) they say (that שֵׁדָה means שֵׁדָה (chest/carriage). Rabbi Johanan said, "There were three hundred types of שֵׁדָה (chests) in שִׁיחִין (Shihin), and what שֵׁדָה means, I do not know"

⁷² Pixner, 342, 357.

⁷³ *The Dawn of Qumran*, 94.

⁷⁴ "Analysis," 248, 252; Wolters, 32-33, 54-55. Regarding the renderings of וְכֵלֶיהָ and וְכָל כֵּלֶיהָ, Wolters and this writer arrived to the same conclusion independently (see Lefkovits^{diss} 1, 94, 120-21).

⁷⁵ Garcia Martinez, 460, 463.

⁷⁶ Beyer, 225, 232.

⁷⁷ Vermes, 374, 378.

⁷⁸ Wise, 191, 198.

(b. Giṭ. 68a).

Rabbi Jeremiah in the name of Rabbi Ḥiyya bar Ba said, “Eighty metal שִׁידוֹת (chests/carriages) were in שִׁיחִין (Shihin).” Rabbi Yannai said, “שִׁידָה did not exist in our time” (y. Ta’an. 4:5 [21b]).

The craftsmen of Shihin near Sepphoris were known to build שִׁידוֹת, *siddot*. The site שִׁיחִין, Shihin, may be the identical with הַאֲשִׁיחִין (see #55, 11:12). Furthermore, the Midrash explains, “שִׁידָה וְשִׁידוֹת are carriages of שִׁידָה וְשִׁידוֹתֵי” (Eccl. Rabbah on 2:8).

The above citations indicate that the Talmudic sages already had difficulty translating שִׁידָה וְשִׁידוֹת. Presumably, the similar spelling of שִׁידָה and שִׁידָה (pl. שִׁידוֹת), “demoness,” like her masculine counterpart שִׁיד (pl. שִׁידִים), “demon,” increased the confusion.

Rashi compares the biblical שִׁידָה with the Mishnaic שִׁידָה תִּיבָה וּמִגְדָּל, and explains the term שִׁידָה - שִׁידָתָא as “a luxurious coach (עֲגָלָה) for ladies and princes” (cf. the above Midrash).⁷⁹ Kohut connects שִׁידָה to the Arabic *sud-dah*, *Sopha*, *Sitz* (“sofa, chair”), and Greek σέδα, σέδας, *Tragstuhl*, *Lehne* (“carrying chair, arm chair”).⁸⁰

שִׁידָה, usually rendered as “large chest,” frequently occurs in the Talmudim. The following references may shed light on its meaning.

The שִׁידָה had legs that were shorter or longer than a handbreadth (m. Kel. 18:3); extended “rims” (m. Kel. 12:2); “a hood” (often fastened to it, m. Kel. 18:2); “a top, a bottom and walls” (m. Kel. 22:8); “a rim at the bottom or a rest” (m. Kel. 15:1); “a door” (t. Giṭ. 2:11; b. Shab. 122b); “a lower door hinge” (t. ‘Eruv. 11:18); “a key” (t. Giṭ. 2:11); inside or outside “drawers” (t. Kel. B.M. 8:1); and “hooks” (m. Kel. 12:2). The שִׁידָה rested on or was fastened to a low cart (b. Shab. 44b), which could be pulled or pushed (m. Kel. 18:2), and could be removed from it (t. Kel. B.M. 8:1). People kept or hid money in their שִׁידָה (t. Ma’as. Sh. 5:11-12; b. San. 30a), as well as in the low cart (m. Kel. 18:2). Often the שִׁידָה had a volume of 40 *se’ah* (= 1 by 1 by 3 cubits, m. Kel. 15:1); it used to be measured either inside or outside (m. Kel. 18:1). A person could be carried abroad in a שִׁידָה (t. Oh. 18:5). The water in a שִׁידָה having a hole at the bottom of a certain size and placed in the sea could be used for ritual bath (m. Miq. 6:5). In the

⁷⁹ Rashi on Eccl. 2:8; b. Giṭ. 68a; b. B.Q. 98b; b. ‘Eruv. 14b; 30b, b. Shab. 44b. Once Rashi says “a box” (b. Ket. 65a). Rashi interpret שִׁידָה וְשִׁידוֹתֵי as “male and female demons” (b. Giṭ. 68a). Ibn-Ezra explains שִׁידָה וְשִׁידוֹת as “a woman and women,” i.e., many women. He derives שִׁידָה from the root שָׁדַח, “to snatch,” i.e., women captured in a war, like רָחֵם וְרָחֵמִים, “a woman, two women” of the captured booty (Judg. 5:30). Many modern scholars follow Ibn-Ezra and interpret שִׁידָה as “woman, concubine,” some deriving it from Akkadian, while others amend the text to שִׁידָה וְשִׁידוֹת, “princess and princesses” (BY 7, 6908-09 n. 1; S.L. Gordon, *Ḥameš Megillot im Be’ur Hadaš*, on Eccl. 2:8).

⁸⁰ AC 8, 32. *He’Arukh* (549a) translates שִׁידָה as קַאסְטֶען (= *Kasten*, “box”).

event of fire on Sabbath, it was permissible to cover a שִׁידָה with a hide of a kid to protect it from burning (m. Shab. 16:5). The שִׁידָה used to be repaired by a carpenter (m. B.Q. 9:3; t. B.Q. 10:8; t. Kel. B.M. 8:1). Some שִׁידוֹת were made of wood (m. Kel. 18:2), while others of metal (t. Kel. B.M. 4:1; y. Ta'an. 4:5 [21b]). The last two facts correspond with the assumption that שִׁידָה כֶּסֶף is a *šiddah* made of or covered with silver, while שִׁידָה אֲחַת could be made of wood.

The definite article in Hebrew is the prefixed *he*, in Aramaic the suffixed *'alef* or *he* (which in some dialects lost its definitiveness). Hebrew expresses what is in English indefinite article in two ways: singular noun alone, or a noun is followed by "one," אֶחָד (masc.) or אַחַת (fem.).⁸¹ Thus, שִׁידָה and שִׁידָה אֶחָת mean "a/one *šiddah*," שִׁידָה כֶּסֶף and שִׁידָה אֶחָת כֶּסֶף mean "a/one silver *šiddah*." The Scroll uses both forms; e.g., שָׁמ קָלַל בּוֹ סִפֵּר אֶחָד, "three (is) a *qalal* (vessel), in it (there is) one document" (see #25, 6:4-5; #52, 11:7). Likewise, חֲפֹרִיחַפּוֹר אֶמָּה is the same as it were written חֲפֹרִיחַפּוֹר אַחַת, "is buried/dig one cubit (deep)" (see #20, 4:13-14); כֶּסֶף, "(a) silver," in a few places may mean אֶחָד כֶּסֶף, "one silver (piece/shekel)" (e.g., 8:6, 9:10); כָּלִי (pl. const.), "vessels of," occasionally can be vocalized as כָּלִי (sg. abs. and const.), "a/one vessel (of)," (e.g., 1:9, 3:8, 8:3).

The expression, "an object and (all of) its implements," as שִׁידָה כֶּסֶף וְכָלֶיהָ, "a silver *šiddah* and its (fem.) implements," and שִׁידָה אֶחָת וְכָל כָּלֶיהָ, "one *šiddah* and all of its (fem.) implements," is in Mishnaic Hebrew; e.g., מַחְרִישָׁה וְכָל כָּלֶיהָ ... וְעֵגְלָה וְכָל כָּלֶיהָ, "a plow and all of its (fem.) implements ... and a cart and all of its (fem.) implements" (m. Shevi. 5:6); שׁוֹר וְכָלִיו, "an ox and its (masc.) trappings" (m. B.Q. 5:6). Biblical Hebrew, however, usually prefixed the object with the definite article, plus adds the accusative אֶת־אֵת in front of the object and in front of "all"; e.g., וְאֵת הַשֻּׁלְחָן, "and the table and all its (masc.) vessels," וְאֵת כָּל כָּלִיו וְאֵת הַמִּנְבֵּה וְאֵת כָּלֶיהָ, "and the table and all its (masc.) vessels, and the Menorah and all its (fem.) vessels" (Exod. 30:27).⁸²

שִׁידָה is similar to but not identical with עֵגְלָה (fem.), "cart." The Mishnah clearly distinguishes the two terms.⁸³ Based on Rashi and the Midrash, שִׁידָה can be rendered as "a carrying chair" used for transporting princes, ladies,

81 In English, as in many Indo-European languages, indefinite article is used for singular nouns, while definite article for both singular and plural nouns; e.g., "a house" - "the house" vs. "houses" - "the houses." The indefinite article "a, an" actually means "one"; cf. *ein, eine* in German means both "a, an" and "one." So in Hungarian, *egy* means both "a, an" and "one." Some languages have no articles at all; e.g., Latin *mare* means "a/the sea," *urbis*, "a/the city"; Russian *дом (dom)* means "a/the house," *стол (stol)*, "a/the table."

82 And so its Targum, מִנְבֵּה וְיֵת מִנְבֵּה וְיֵת כָּל מִנְבֵּה וְיֵת כָּל מִנְבֵּה (TO; cf. Ps and TN).

83 "He who enters the land of the nations in a שִׁידָה, in a chest, or in a tower-like-chest, remains (ritually) clean; in a wagon, in a עֵגְלָה (cart), or in a ship, or in a raft, becomes defiled" (t. Oh. 18:5). The rationale for this Halakhah being that the first three objects are closed, while the remainder are open.

nobles, rather than “a large box.” Therefore, there is no need to amend כליה (Lurie), to separate the phrase in the middle (Lurie), or read it as *kullo* (Allegro and Milik), *kol* or *kalkalehah* (Milik). שִׁדָּת כֶּסֶף וְכִלֶּיהָ means, “a silver carrying chair with its implements,” and שִׁדָּא אַחַת וְכָל כִּלֶּיהָ, “one carrying chair with all of its implements.” This interpretation is similar to the alternate reading of כְּלִי דְמַע בְּלָגִין וְאַפִּירִין, “dedicated vessels consisting of lagenos and a carrying chair” (1:9; see Appendix D).

Finally, Brand suggests that the metal *šiddot* of Shihin, which later disappeared (see the above Talmud citations), were used to form large vessels.⁸⁴ If true, this might suggest that the *šiddot* mentioned in the Scroll were used to make large Temple vessels.

(1:4) מִשְׁקָל כְּכַרְיִן שִׁבְעָעֶשְׂרָה (= שֶׁבַע עֶשְׂרֵה) — מִשְׁקָל (abs.), “weight,” מִשְׁקָל (const.), “weight of,” is from the root שָׁקַל, “to weigh.”⁸⁵ Cf. וּמִשְׁקָלָהּ כֶּכֶר זָהָב, “and its (fem.) weight (was) one talent of gold” (2 Sam. 12:30); also,

(A wife is obligated to produce for her husband) מִשְׁקָל חֲמֵשׁ סֵלָעִים (a weight of five *sela*^c) thread of warp in Judea which is ten *sela*^c in Galilee, or מִשְׁקָל עֶשְׂרִי סֵלָעִים (a weight of ten *sela*^c) thread of woof in Judea which is twenty *sela*^c in Galilee (m. Ket. 5:9).⁸⁶

בְּכֶסֶף מִשְׁקָל (= בכ[ס]ף מִשְׁקָל כֶּר 2 ו 100, “in silver a weight of 100 and 2 *kr*”;⁸⁷ and in Punic; e.g., שִׁאֵר [= בְּשִׁאֵר] מִשְׁקָל מֵאָה וְחֲמִשִּׁים (= מִשְׁקָל מֵאָה וְחֲמִשִּׁים 150 ... כֶּסֶף שָׁקַל 1 ו 2 זֶר 2 150), “flesh a weight of one hundred and fifty (i.e.,) 150 (shekels) ... silver 1 shekel (and) 2 *zr* (a certain weight).”⁸⁸ The cognates of מִשְׁקָל are מִתְקָל (A), and *mitqal(un)* in Arabic (*šin-taw/ta* interchange).

Often מִשְׁקָל is understood, although not used specifically. Likewise, if מִשְׁקָל occurs with a number without specific weight, it refers to שָׁקַל, “shekel” (cf. the above Punic citation). Usually in these cases the Targumim add מִתְקָל and/or סֵלָעִין (pl. of סֵלָע; a *sela*^c is equal to a שָׁקַל קֹדֶשׁ, “sanctuary shekel”; see #59, 12:9; Appendix A). E.g., the Targum of כֶּף אַחַת עֶשְׂרֵה בְּזִיכָא חֲדָא מִתְקָל, literally “one pan (of) ten gold” (Num. 7:14, etc.), is

⁸⁴ CTL, 147.

⁸⁵ The Hebrew root שָׁקַל should not be confused with the Aramaic root of שָׁקַל (same as *šql* in Ugaritic), “to take, reach,” which is common in the Talmudic literature. E.g., the expression שָׁקַל וְנָתַן, “takes and gives” (b. Hag. 11b), which is used in its Aramaic, שָׁקְלָא וְנָתַן, as well as in its Hebraized form, שָׁקַל וְנָתַן, in Modern Hebrew.

⁸⁶ The weight of a *sela*^c in Judea was twice of that in Galilee. The tread of warp was twice as difficult to produce as the tread of woof (see Rashi [b. Ket. 64b], and Bertinoro on this Mishnah).

⁸⁷ KAI 1, 10; 2, 60 (#43:14); see Appendix A.

⁸⁸ KAI 1, 15; 2, 83 (#69:6,7).

Concerning כְּכַרִּין, the drawings differ. BAKER^{dr}: *bet/kaf*, a ligature of a *kaf* and *yod*, and a final *nun* (there is no *reš*). MILIK^{dr}: *bet/kaf, kaf*, ligature of a small *reš* and *yod*. ALLEGRO^{dr}: כְּכַרִּין, the *reš* is in an angular position; the *yod* is on the cut, as noted by Allegro.⁹³

It should be added that only Allegro's drawing indicates where the rolls were sliced longitudinal at the opening process, as well as the numerous cracks of the Scroll. Many of these cut through characters, and many letters or part of them are on the cut. Therefore, one can claim that Allegro's drawing is superior to those of Baker and Milik at certain critical points (see "The Drawings" in the Discussion). Regarding כְּכַרִּין, the plural of כְּכַר, "talent," see Appendix A; for שְׁבַעֲשָׁרָה, Appendix B.

(1:4) KEN — This the first of seven sets of Greek (some may be Latin) letters in the Scroll; all of these are discussed in Appendix C.

93 Allegro, 135 n. 8.

ITEM 2

בנפש בנדבך השלישי עשתות 1:5
 100 זהב 1:6a

1:5 In the tomb, in the third
 1:6a grave stone, (there are) 100
 masses of unused gold.

COMMENTARY

(1:5) בְּנַפֶּשׁ בְּנִדְבָךְ בְּנִדְבָךְ הַשְּׁלִישִׁי, “In/at/by a/the tomb, in/at/by the third gravestone/stone row” — After the first seven letters the drawings differ. BAKER^{dr}: A ‘dashed’ almost semicircle like fragment, *dalet/reš he/het/taw*, followed by a space for two-three letters. MILIK^{dr}: *bet/kaf*, a dashed *waw/yod*, a letter resembling *dalet/reš/final kaf*, a space, followed by השלישי of which the first *šin* is made of dotted lines, and the bottom leg of the *lamed* is absent. These eight letters are encircled with a dotted line. ALLEGRO^{dr}: There is a *yod* between the *lamed* and a smaller sized *šin*. All letters are readable, no word or part of it is encircled.

This phrase has been analyzed as follows. ALLEGRO^{pr}: “In the sepulchre, in the third course of bricks.” ALLEGRO: בְּנַפֶּשׁ בְּנִדְבָךְ הַשְּׁלִישִׁי, “In the sepulchral monument, in the third course of stones.”¹ MILIK: בְּנַפֶּשׁ בֶּן רַבָּה הַשְּׁלִישִׁי, “In the funeral monument of Ben *Rabbah* of (*Bet*) *Shalisha*” (no *Bet* in the French translation); the text in italics is “extremely uncertain.” *Rabbah*, “the Great,” is a known name from Talmudic sources. The biblical בעל שלישה was called בית שרישה in the Roman period, it is probably Khirbet Sirisiah, 22 km north of Lydda. Alternately, בְּנַפֶּשׁ בֶּן דְּכוּר הָעֵדֶשִׁי (no translation).² LURIE follows Allegro, and suggests that this tomb was located in בחרובא שבמעמק עכור. Lurie discusses נפש in the Talmudic literature, as well as the Benei Ḥazir funeral inscription from the Second Temple era.³ WOLTERS (reads as Milik): “In the sepulchre of Ben *Rabbah* the Third.”⁴ BEYER: בְּנַפֶּשׁ בֶּן דְּבִהָשׁוֹ, “In the sepulchre of D[...].”⁵ VERMES: “In the tomb of ... the

1 Allegro, 33; Allegro^{rev}, 21.

2 Milik, 284-85; 258-59 C-207; 269 D-34; Milik^E, 139, 144-45. Regarding the name *Rabbah*, cf. the Amoraim, *Rabbah bar Avuha*², *Rabbah bar Huna*, *Rabbah bar Ḥanah*, *Rabbah bar bar Ḥanah*, *Rabbah bar Naḥmani*.

3 Lurie, 60-61 and nn. 1-2.

4 Wolters, 32-33.

third.”⁶ PIXNER, GARCIA MARTINEZ, and WISE agree with Allegro.⁷

Milik reads the seventh and ninth characters as a *reš* and a *he*, while Allegro as a *dalet* and a final *kaf*. Milik notes that the ninth letter “is certainly not a final *kaf*.”⁸ This clearly indicates that he was aware of Allegro’s reading.

The common Semitic נפש, “soul, life, desire, rest,” also means “tomb” in Mishnaic Hebrew, Aramaic, Syriac, Palmyrene, Nabatean, Arabic, South Arabian, and Neo-Punic.⁹ The verbal form of נפש (*Nif'al*) in Biblical Hebrew means “to rest.”¹⁰

In several biblical verses Habermann interprets נפש as “memorial edifice, grave marking, or representation in honor of the dead.”¹¹ He would render the verse וְאֵת הַנֶּפֶשׁ אֲשֶׁר עָשׂוּ בְּהָרָן as, “and the memorial (of the patriarchs) which (Abram and Sarai) made in Haran” (Gen. 12:5).¹²

According to Rappaport, נפש, “grave,” is a “remnant of the holy tongue spoken in the days of the prophets.” Likewise, נפש in the Bible could mean a “dead body.”¹³ נפש, “tomb,” is stemming from both forms, the nominal “soul” and the verbal “to rest.”¹⁴ Mandelkern and BDB derive the verbal form of נפש, “to rest,” from the nominal “soul.”¹⁵ Mazar suggests, “The concept נפש underwent several stages of development: the soul of the dead; the symbol of the soul of the dead; a marker or stela on the tomb of the dead; the tomb itself; the mausoleum.”¹⁶

Occasionally נפש in Ugaritic is rendered as “grave (chamber).”¹⁷ Yet Pope

5 Beyer, 225.

6 Vermes, 374.

7 Pixner, 342 and n. 4; Garcia Martinez, 461; Wise, 191.

8 Milik, 284; Milik^E, 144.

9 BDB, 659-61; Jastrow, 926-27; *He'Arukh*, 363a; *AC* 5, 368-70; E. Löw, “נפש³” in *AAC*, 283a; *BY* 5, 3734-51; *EShd^{dic}* 4, 1703-06; *CTL*, 69-73; *KAI* 1, 25; 2, 133, 136 (#128:3; #136:1 [נאפש, with an *'aleff*]).

10 וַיִּנָּפֶשׁ, “and he shall rest” (Exod 23:12); וַיִּנָּפֶשׁ, “and he rested” (2 Sam. 16:14); וַיִּנָּפֶשׁ, “and he rested” (Exod. 31:17).

11 A.M. Habermann, “Tomb of Rachel and the term נפש” in *Tarbiz* 25 (1956), 363-68, i-ii.

12 This contradicts the various traditional translations, “and the souls (or servants, people, converts, spiritual gifts) that they made (or had gotten, gathered, acquired) in Haran” (cf. *The Living Torah*, 57).

13 E.g., “and one who touches anything טָמֵא נֶפֶשׁ (defiled by a corpse)” (Lev. 22:4); “If טָמֵא נֶפֶשׁ ([a person] defiled by a corpse) touches any of these, shall it be unclean?” (Hag. 2:13). Onkelos and Targum Haggai renders טָמֵא נֶפֶשׁ; and in both places Rashi defines it as one who is defiled by touching a dead body. Also, טָמֵא נֶפֶשׁ (const.), טָמֵא לְנֶפֶשׁ (abs., Num. 5:2, 9:10), and טָמֵא נֶפֶשׁ (JA) are synonymous with טָמֵא מֵת, “defiled by a corpse” (MH; e.g., m. Kel. 1:1).

14 S.J.L. Rappaport (known by his acronym as Shir), *Gal 'Ed* (1856), ix-x. This is quoted by Habermann.

15 MK 1, 757c; BDB, 661b.

16 *Beth She'arim* 1, 198, 208.

says, "The association of נפש with burial is apparently a late development. While there are uses of נפש which seem to confuse it with grave itself, there are those that make explicit distinction between the tomb and the נפש as monument stela or image commemorating or representing the deceased."¹⁸ According to Kutscher, נפש (MH, "tombstone") is an Aramaic loanword.¹⁹

The Talmud refers to various types of נפשיות (pl. of נפש, fem.). Regular נפש, a four-sided construction (t. 'Eruv. 6[5]:4); נפש שְׁנֵפְרָצָה, a bridge type of building having two open sides (t. 'Eruv. 6[5]:5); נפש אָטוּמָה, "closed *nefeš*", i.e., tombstone (m. Oh. 7:1; m. 'Eruv. 5:1). Some נפשיות were four by four cubits (t. 'Eruv. 6[5]:4), some had בֵּית דִּירָה, a "living quarter" for a watchman (m. 'Eruv. 6:1; t. 'Eruv. 6[5]:4; see #56, 11:16).

In the era of Talmud Jews from Palestine and the Diaspora used a huge underground burial site in Beth She'arim.²⁰ Inscriptions in several languages were found there. Among those in Hebrew, קָבֵר, מָקוֹם, and נֶפֶשׁ are synonyms; one reads נֶפֶשׁ נְיָחֵמְיָה (plene), "Tomb of Nehemiah" (No. 91). Those in Palmyreans, נפש occurs four times.²¹

17 Ginsberg translates the Ugaritic בנפשה יסתרנ יד בגנגנה into Hebrew as, "יִסְתֵּר מִתּוֹ בְּחֻמְרוֹ, יִסְתֵּר יָד בְּמַעְרֻתָּי!" (i.e., "Mot shall gather in his [dead] chamber, Yedad shall be hidden in his [burial] cave"), and notes that נפש meaning קָבֵר is common in Hebrew and Aramaic (*The Ugaritic Texts* [Heb., 1936], 40-41 [= UT 51:vii:47-49]; and *bnpš bn ilm mt bnh mrt ydd il gẓr* as, "From the tomb of Godly Mot, from the pit of El's Belov'd Ghazir" (*ANET* 2-3, 135a, 138b [= UT 67:i:7-8]). See M.D. Cassuto, "Death of Baal," *Tarbiz* 12 (1941), 41; "Death of Baal," *IEJ* 12 (1962), 81; *UT*, 446 [#1681]; *WUS*, 135-36 [#1238], 211-12 [#1826]; M. Held, "Pits and Pitfalls in Akkadian and Biblical Hebrew," *JANES* 5 (1973), 173-90.

18 M.H. Pope: "A Little Soul-Searching," *Maarav* 1 (1978), 25-31. Brand mentions the Ugaritic usage of נפש; he relies on Ginsberg's explanation (*CTL*, 69-73).

19 In the Kaufmann Mishnah Manuscript נפש, "tombstone," is vocalized as נֶפֶשׁ (m. Sheq. 2:5), and as נֶפֶשׁ (m. Oh. 7:1). The forms of נֶפֶשׁ and נֶפֶשׁ are known in the Yemenite tradition. Like the Babylonian vocalization, the Yemenites do not distinguish between *pataḥ* and *segol*, but they do between *qamaš* and *pataḥ*. Thus, the forms of נפש in the Kaufmann MS are essentially identical with those of the Yemenites. Kutscher states: (1) Originally the Mishnaic נפש, "tombstone," was pronounced like the Aramaic נֶפֶשׁ. (2) The vocalizer of the Kaufmann MS was a Sepharadi, since he did not distinguish between *pataḥ* and *qamaš*. (3) The vocalization of נֶפֶשׁ is a Hebraism ("Trivia," *Archive* (in Heb.), 1 [1972], 99, Eng. Sum. xxxi). Kara says that in the Yemenite tradition the קָטָל form practically disappeared, and only the קָטָל form survived ("The Vocalization of נפש [Monument over a Grave] in the Yemenite Tradition" [in Heb.], *Archive* 1 [1972], 115-16, Eng. Sum. xxxiv).

20 Mazar suggests that Beth She'arim, "House of the Gates," originally might have been Beth Sha'arayim, "House of Double Gates," cf. Sha'arayim (Josh 15:36). In the Talmud בֵּית שְׁעָרִים also called בֵּית שְׂרִיין, which may indicate that in the local dialect the *'ayin* was not pronounced. In the Greek Besara for Beth She'arim the *taw* assimilated into the next *šin*; cf. בֵּית נֶפֶשׁ for בֵּית נֶפֶשׁ (*Beth She'arim* 1, 1-2, 197-98). Cf. the possible dual vocalization of בֵּית הַשְּׁוֹחִין - האשתיין, see #55, 11:12.

21 והא נפש והא נפש (= והנפש והנפש דעתחן; No. 126); נפש אסתר (No. 126); והא נפש והא נפש (= והנפש והנפש דעתחן; No. 132); בנפשא דתמא אמשא, "Tomb of

The Peshitta renders the seven pyramids of the tomb of the Hashmonean family in Modi'in as **שבע נפשן** (= **שבע נפשן**), "seven tombs" (1 Macc. 12:38). **נפשן** (= **נפשן**) is the plural of **נפש** (= **נפש**), "tomb."

Several famous **נפשות** are mentioned in the Talmud; e.g., **נפשה דסיריקין**, "the tomb of Soriqon" (y. 'Eruv. 5:1 [26b]; TA); **נפשא דפנוטי**, "the tomb of Pante" (y. Dem. 2:1 [6b]; TA).²²

The sages of the Talmud had various views regarding erecting **נפשות** for living or deceased persons.

Rabbi Nathan says: "From the remains of the (collected funeral expense fund) of a deceased, one (must) build a **קבר נפש** upon his **קבר** (grave)" (m. Sheq. 2:5; t. Sheq. 1:12; b. San. 48a; cf. y. Sheq. 2:5 [9a]).

It was taught (in a baraita), Rabban Simeon ben Gamaliel says: "One does not build **נפשות** for righteous men; their words, those are their **זכרונות** (monuments)" (y. Sheq. 2:5 [9b]).

(If) a **נפש** is built for a living person, it is permissible to benefit from it. (But if one) **הוסיף בו דימוס אחד** (adds in it one *dimos*) for a deceased person, it is forbidden to benefit from it (b. San. 48a).

Rashi says that **נפש** is a structure erected upon a grave, while **דימוס** is a **גדבך**. Thus, **דימוס דימוס** (from the Greek-Latin *domus*), **גדבך** (masc., BA, JA, MH; pl. **גדבכים**), "large stone, row of stones," and **טור**, "row of stones," are synonyms.²³ The *Arukh* explains that **נפש** (MH), like **ציון** (BH), is something built upon a **קבר**.²⁴ The Talmud mentions that four men had to carry a **גדבך** (m. Oh. 6:1; cf. t. Oh. 7:1), and a **גדבך** used for construction was four handbreadths high" (m. Oh. 14:1; t. Oh. 14:8). Presumably, **דימוס**

Thuma (daughter of) Amase" (No. 12); ... **בת נפשא רנא ד**, "This tomb of ..." (No. 86). **נפשא** is contracted of **בית נפש**, the same as **בית נפש** (= **בית הנפש** in Hebrew), "house of the soul (or dead)" (*Beth She'arim* 1, 106, 126, 198, 204, 206-07). Cf. **בית בירבי - בירבי**, "House of the Rabbi" (e.g., b. Hul. 137a). Regarding **קבר**, see #14, 3:11.

22 Perhaps it should read **דסוריקון**. Moreover, these may be place names; cf. AC 5, 370.

23 Milik's drawing can be read as **גדבך**, where the *waw* may represent a Tiberian long *qamāṣ*; cf. **הבאות** instead of **הבאות** (see #1, 1:2). Both the singular and plural **גדבך** occurs in the Aramaic verse, **גדבך די אבן גלל תלתא וגדבך די אע חרת**, "three rows of untrimmed stone, and a row of new timber" (Ezra 6:4). The Septuagint renders **גדבך של אבן** as *δῶμος*. **גדבך** is a row of something, not necessarily of stone (cf. Jastrow, 300a). **דימוס** - **דימוס** and **גדבך** are synonyms; e.g., **דימוס של אבנים** vs. **גדבך של אבנים** (b. Shab. 125b and 102b, respectively), and are interchanged in various manuscripts (AC 3, 83-84; 5, 313). The Targum for **גדבך על אבן**, "stone upon a stone," is **גדבך על גדבך** (Hag. 2:15), and of **טור**, "row (of stone)," is **גדבך** (Ezek. 46:24). Fränkel says that the Arabic *damus* originates from Greek through Aramaic, and *midbak* was borrowed from Aramaic (*Die aramäischen Fremdwörter im arabischen*, 12-13, 112). **גדבך** is a variant of **גדבך** (a *mem-nun* interchange); e.g., b. Suk. 20b (see AC 5, 313). Regarding **טור**, see #32, 7:15; for **אבן**, #34, 8:5.

24 *He'Arukh*, 363a; cf. **וראה עצם אדם וקנה אצלו ציון**, "and he shall see a human bone, and he shall built near it a mark" (Ezek. 39:15).

is a grave stone, like מַצֵּבָה, “monument,” erected by Jacob upon Rachel’s grave.²⁵ Also, both of the above cited Mishnah and baraita appear in a Midrash, but בֵּית, “house,” is used instead of נֶפֶשׁ (Gen. Rabbah 82:9).

There is a resemblance in terminology and in sentence structure between the above baraita אַחַד (נֶדְבָךְ) = בּוֹ דִּימוֹס ... הוֹסִיף הוֹסִיף, and the beginning of this item, בְּנֶפֶשׁ בְּנֶפֶשׁ בְּנֶדְבָךְ בְּנֶדְבָךְ הַשְּׁלִישִׁי, “In/at/by a/the tomb, in the third grave stone,” i.e., in the third grave stone of the tomb.

Based on aforementioned discussion of the term נֶפֶשׁ, one can conclude the followings:

- (1) נֶפֶשׁ is built like a בֵּית, “house.”
- (2) נֶפֶשׁ is built upon the קֶבֶר, “grave.”
- (3) A נֶפֶשׁ could be built for several persons, where each body having a דִּימוֹס (= נֶדְבָךְ).
- (4) A נֶפֶשׁ used to be built for living persons, as was done by the Phoenicians.²⁶

The latter may be compared to Absalom’s reasoning for erecting his own יָד לִלְוִים, Monument of Absalom, “I have no son. (I made it) in order that שְׁמִי הִזְכִּיר (my name should be remembered)” (2 Sam. 18:18; see #48, 10:12). In the above baraita נֶפֶשׁוֹת is parallel to זְכוֹרֹנוֹת, “memories”; both הִזְכִּיר and זְכוֹרֹנוֹת are from the root זָכַר, “to remember.”

As the Talmud reports, it was a common practice to conceal objects under a נֶדְבָךְ.

Rabbi Yose said: Once Rabbi Ḥalafta went to Rabban Gamaliel (of Yavneh) at Tiberias. he found him sitting at the table of Johanan ben Hannazuf and in his hand was a Targum of the Book of Job which he was reading. Rabbi Ḥalafta said to him: “I remember Rabban Gamaliel the Elder, your father’s father, as he was sitting on a step of the Temple Mount and it was brought before him a Targum of the Book of Job and he ordered the mason, ‘build it under the נֶדְבָךְ.’” (Hearing this story) immediately Rabban Gamaliel (of Yavneh) ordered (that the Targum of Job) to be concealed” (t. Shab. 13 [14]:2-3; cf. b. Shab. 115a; y. Shab. 16:1 [45b]; Sof. 5:15).

While in this citation the objects concealed (i.e., committed to *genizah*) were

²⁵ מַצֵּבָה (from the root נָצַב, “to stand”) is a “pillar,” a stone monument (cf. Gen. 28:18).

²⁶ A Phoenician grave stone reads: אַנֶּךְ עֲבֹדָסֶר בֶּן חֶר מִצְבַּת לְמִבְחִי יִטְנָאֵת עַל מִשְׁכַּב נַחְתִּי לְעֵלָם וּלְאִשְׁתִּי לְאַמְתַּעֲשֶׁרֶת בַּת תֶּאֱמַם בֶּן עֲבֹדָמֶלֶךְ “I ‘Bd’sr (= Servant of Osiris) son of ‘Bdssm (= Servant of Ssm) son of Ḥr (= Hor, Horus), I have erected a grave stone in my life upon my resting place for my peace forever, also for my wife ‘Mt’štrt (= Maiden of Ashtoreth) daughter of T’m (= Twins, Theom = Thomas) son of ‘Bdmlk (= Servant of Milk or Servant of the King)” (KAI 1, 8; 2, 52-53 [#35:1-2]). Regarding מִשְׁכַּב, see #56, 11:16.

Targumim of Job, this does not necessarily mean that they were identical with the one found in Qumran Cave 11,²⁷ or with the one printed in the Rabbinic Bible. Yet the following facts are very interesting:

- (1) The Copper Scroll mentions hidden objects below a certain *nidbakh*.
- (2) Rabban Gamaliel the Elder in the last decades of the Temple ordered that a Targum of Job be concealed under a *nidbakh* in Jerusalem.
- (3) Rabban Gamaliel of Yavneh ordered to conceal a Targum of Job shortly after the destruction of the Temple.
- (4) A Targum of Job was discovered in Qumran.
- (5) There is a Targum of Job in the Rabbinic Bible.

Even if Targum Job of Qumran is about a hundred years older than the Copper Scroll and the Tannaic events mentioned above,²⁸ all the aforementioned seem to originate from the same historical era and region. Regarding *genizah*, see #25, 6:4; #33, 8:3; #54, 11:9; and Discussion.

In addition, סבין, a variant of ספסון, could mean “rows of stones,” thus synonymous with נדבכין.²⁹ Therefore, this phrase is similar to בקבר־בְּקֶרֶב (= הספס) שְׂתַחַת הַסִּבִּין, which could mean, “In/at/by a/the grave which is below the rows of stones” (see #53, 11:8).

The second word, בנדרבך (Allegro^{dr}) or בנדרבך (Milik^{dr}), can be divided into בִּנְ (= בֶּן), “son of,” plus a word consisting of the letters *dalet/reš*, *bet/kaf*, and *dalet/reš/final kaf*; cf. Milik’s suggestions of בן רבה and בן דכור. Consequently, this permits 38 possible letter combinations for this word.³⁰ Moreover, the fourth letter of the first word may be the first letter of the second word, i.e., שְׁבִנְךָ בֶּן־שְׁבִנְךָ, “which is in/at/by the row of stones.” Also, the *he* of השלישי may be the last letter of the previous word, and the word itself can be separated into two, i.e., שֶׁל יִשִּׁי, “of Jesse.” יִשִּׁי, Jesse, was the father of King David (1 Sam. 16:1); cf. שְׁלוֹמוֹ, Solomon (5:5, 5:8), אַבְשָׁלוֹם, Absalom (10:12), etc., in the Scroll. In addition, many of the letters can be identified several ways (some are indicated above). Thus, the letter group בנ+פ+ש+בוכ+נ+ד+ר+בוכ+ד+ר+ן+ה+ש+ל+י+ש+י (not all possible letter identifications are indicated) can be divided into three, four, and five words.

If the third word is read as השלשי (Milik^{dr}, defective) or השלישי (Alleg-

27 Sokoloff says that in his preliminary communication concerning the Targum Job of Qumran, in 1962, J.P.M. van der Ploeg quoted this story. Sokoloff adds that the editors point out that there is no connection between the Qumran Targum Job and that mentioned in the Rabbinic sources (*The Targum to Job from Qumran Cave XI* [1974], 4-5).

28 Targum of Job of Qumran has been dated to 100 BCE; cf. *The Targum to Job from Qumran Cave XI*, 9 and n. 1.

29 *He'Arukh*, 388b; *AC* 6, 98a; Jastrow, 1011a.

[illegible]

ro^{dr}, *plene*), it can be vocalized and interpreted several ways.

הַשְּׁלִישִׁי - הַשְּׁלִישִׁי, "the third (masc.)," also occurs later (2:3); e.g., וְהַשְּׁלִישִׁי, "and the third row" (Exod. 28:19, 39:12); בְּיוֹם הַשְּׁלִישִׁי, "in the third day" (2 Chron. 10:12); cf. הַשְּׁנִי, "the second (fem.)" (9:4, 10:1).

הַשְּׁלִישִׁי - הַשְּׁלִישִׁי, "the (man) of Shalishah" or "the Shalishite," is a gentile form (cf. Milik); cf. הַיֵּרֵחִי, "the (man) of Jericho" or "the Jerichoite" (11:9). בַּעַל שְׁלִישָׁה, Baal-shalishah (2 Kgs 4:42), was located in אֶרֶץ שְׁלִישָׁה, the "Land of Shalishah," near Mount Ephraim (1 Sam. 9:4).³¹

הַשְּׁלִישִׁי or הַשְּׁלִישִׁי are plural forms without the final *mem/nun* prefixed with the definite article, i.e., הַשְּׁלִישִׁים, "the officers, the mighty men, the trustees"; e.g., רֹאשׁ הַשְּׁלִישִׁים vs. רֹאשׁ הַשְּׁלִישִׁי (*qeri*), "the chief of the officers" (2 Sam. 23:8 and 1 Chron. 11:11, 12:19, respectively; cf. *Rid*). The singular is שְׁלִישִׁי, "officer, mighty man" (Exod. 14:7), or "trustee" (m. Ket. 6:7).³² Cf. לְבוּשֵׁי לְבוּשִׁין (= לְבוּשִׁין), "garments," which may be such a form in the Scroll (see #13, 3:9).

The following are possible readings, vocalizations, and interpretations for the phrase in question.

בְּנִפְשׁ בְּנִדְבָר בְּנִדְבָר הַשְּׁלִישִׁי, "In/at/by a/the tomb, in/at/by the third gravestone/stone row."

בְּנִפְשׁ בְּנִדְבָר בְּנִדְבָר הַשְּׁלִישִׁי, "In/at/by a/the tomb, at the grave stone of the Shalishite" — בְּנִדְבָר שֶׁל (= בְּנִדְבָר) is in the construct state.

בְּנִפְשׁ בְּנִדְבָר הַשְּׁלִישִׁי, "In/at/by a/the tomb, at the grave stone of the officer(s)/trustee(s)."

בְּנִפְשׁ בֶּן רֶבֶה הַשְּׁלִישִׁי (cf. Milik), "In/at/by the tomb of the son of Rabbah (= the Great) the Shalishite"; or "In/at/by the tomb of the son of Rabbah the officer/trustee" — This suggestion resembles the phrase חַנָּה רֶב שְׁלִישָׁה from a Punic inscription from Carthage that in Hebrew would be חַנָּה רֶב הַשְּׁלִישִׁי, "Hanna the third chief," or חַנָּה רֶב הַשְּׁלִישִׁי, "Hanna the chief officer."³³

בְּנִפְשׁ בֶּן דֶּקֶר (= בֶּן דֶּקֶר) הַשְּׁלִישִׁי, "In/at/by the tomb of the son of Deker the officer/trustee/Shalishite" — דֶּקֶר could be a variant of דֶּקֶר, Deker (*kaf-qof* interchange; e.g., כּוֹבַע vs. קוֹבַע, "hat, helmet," see #41, 9:10). Cf. בֶּן דֶּקֶר, Ben-deker (= Son of Sharp Weapon; 1 Kgs 4:9), one of King Solomon's twelve deputies over all Israel who provided provision for the palace. דֶּקֶר (masc.), "sharp weapon," is from the root דָּקַר, "to pierce."

31 The Targum renders both as אֶרֶץ יְרוּקָא, "southern land"; cf. Radak on both verses. Regarding Baal-shalishah, see Z. Kalai, "Baal-Shalisha and Ephraim," *Bible and Jewish History* (1971), 191-206 (in Heb.), xxi-xxii (Eng. summary).

32 *שְׁלִישִׁי* could mean the third men on the chariot (Mekhilta' Be'sallah Wayehi Be'sallah 1:7). *שְׁלִישִׁי* may have Akkadian, Ugaritic, and Aramaic (תלת) cognates. See BDB, 1026b; SB, 846b; Jastrow, 1584; BY 8, 7163b n. 1, 7164b n. 1; KB 4, 1412b-13b; D.G. Schley, "The *šališim* officers or special three-man squads?" VT 40 (1990), 321-26.

33 RES, 910. See Z.S. Harris, *A Grammar of the Phoenician Language*, 154, 151.

בְּנִפְשׁוֹ בְּנִפְשׁ בֶּן דֶּכֶר (= בֶּן דְּכֶרְוֶכֶר) הַשְּׁלִישִׁי “In/at/by the tomb of the son of Dekher/Zecher/Ram the officer/trustee/Shalishite” — דֶּכֶר is the Aramaic cognate of זָכַר, “to remember” (*dalet-zayin* interchange). The nominal דֶּכֶר means “male” and “ram”; and perhaps a variant of the name זֶכֶר, Zecher.³⁴

בְּנִפְשׁ בֶּן דְּכֶרְוֶכֶר (= זִכּוֹר) הַשְּׁלִישִׁי “In/at/by the tomb of the son of Zaccur (of the) third (watch of the Levites)” — דֶּכֶר - דְּכּוֹר (cf. Milik’s alt.) may be a variant of the name זִכּוֹר, Zaccur. Twenty-four Levitical מִשְׁמְרוֹת, “watches,” were selected by King David for Temple services, and הַשְּׁלִישִׁי “the third (was) Zaccur, his sons, and his brothers” (1 Chron. 25:10). זִכּוֹר בֶּן דְּכֶרְוֶכֶר may refer to a member of the clan of Zaccur, while הַשְּׁלִישִׁי to the third watch. Likewise, שֶׁל בֵּית הַקּוֹצַ, “In/at/by a/the cave ... of the House of Hakkoz,” may refer to the burial cave of one of the twenty-four priestly watches (see #30, 7:9). Also, שִׁיחִין, Shihin, the resident of the priestly watch יִשְׁבָּב or יִשְׁבָּבֶא, Yeshevav, may be identical with בֵּית הָאֲשִׁיחִין (see #55, 11:12).³⁵ Accordingly, the Scroll may refer to the burial places of a Levite watch, a priestly watch, and the resident of another priestly watch.

בְּנִפְשׁ בֶּן רֶבֶךְ רֶבֶךְ רֶבֶךְ רֶבֶךְ הַשְּׁלִישִׁי “In/at/by the tomb of the son of Ravukh/Revikh the officer/trustee/third”; “In/at/by the tomb of the son of Revikh the Shalishite” — Ravukh (H) or Revikh (A) is a personal of family name. Cf. the Jewish Aramaic tomb inscription, שְׁפִירָה בַּת יְהוֹחָנָן בֶּר רִבִּי, “Šappirah (= The Beautiful), daughter of Yehohanan (= Johanan), son of Revikh (= the Mixer).”³⁶ The Hebrew *Pa’ul* רֶבֶךְ (*Qal* pass. part. masc. sg.) and the Aramaic *Pe’il* רֶבִּיך (*Pe’al* masc. sg. pass. part.), “mixed” (verbal form) or “mixer” (adjective or noun; regarding these patterns, see #1, 1:1), are derived from the root רִבַּךְ, “to mix, stir”; e.g., מְרִבֶּכֶת and its Targum Onkelos, רִבִּיכָא, “well mixed” (Lev. 6:14, 7:12); לְמִרְבֶּכֶת and its Targum,

34 זֶכֶר (1 Chron. 8:31) is the same as זִכְרִיָּה (1 Chron. 9:37). Other related names are: זִכְרִי, Zichri (e.g., Neh. 11:9), זְכַרְיָה, Zechariah (e.g., Zech. 1:1), and זִכּוֹר, Zaccur (1 Chron. 8:31). Although one can read this problem word as רֶבֶךְ(ו), it is difficult to equate it, based on letter interchange of *dalet-zayin*, with זָכַר, “to bestow upon” (Gen. 30:2), and the names זָבּוּד, Zabud (1 Kgs 4:5), זָבָד, Zabad (1 Chron. 11:41), זָבְדִּי, Zabdi (Josh. 7:1), זְבַדְיָה, Zebadiah (Ezra 8:8; 1 Chron. 26:2); etc., since the root זָכַר is also זָכַר in Aramaic, and *zabada* in Arabic (cf. BDB, 256).

35 There were 24 priestly and 24 Levites watches (1 Chron. Ch. 25). Cf. “The early prophets enacted the ordinance of twenty-four מִשְׁמְרוֹת (watches). For כָּל מִשְׁמֶר וּמִשְׁמֶר (each watch) there was a delegation in Jerusalem consisting of priests, Levites and Israelites. When the time came for the מִשְׁמֶר (watch) to go up, the priests and Levites would go up to Jerusalem (to serve in the Temple), while the Israelites of that מִשְׁמֶר (watch) gather together in their towns and read (in the Torah) the story of the works of creation” (m. Ta’an. 4:2; see *Tosephot Yom-Tov*; Radak on 1 Chron. 25:1). See also J. Liver, “משמור, משמרות כהונה,” in *BE* 5, 569-80. For מִשְׁמֶר וּמִשְׁמֶר, cf. כל אחר ואחר, see #60, 12:12-13.

36 L. Y. Rahmani, *A Catalogue of Jewish Ossuaries in the Collection of the State of Israel* (1994), Nr. 198 (123f, pl. 27); ZA 9 (1996), 98, #13.

מְרֻבֶּכֶת “and for the well mixed” (1 Chron. 23:29).³⁷ The feminine מְרֻבֶּכֶת (BH) - רְבִיכָה - רְבִיכָה (MH), and רְבִיכָה (JA) refers to an offering of wheat meal well mixed in hot water, baked, then fried in olive oil (e.g., m. Men. 7:1; see Bertinoro, Maimonides, *Tiferet Israel*, Kehati; b. Men. 89a). In addition, חֲלוֹן הַיְתָה שֶׁם לְמַעְרְבוֹ שֶׁל כֶּבֶשׂ וּרְבִיכָה הֵיחָה נִקְרֵית, “there was an opening of the western side of the ascent to the altar (in the Temple), and it was called *revikhah*” (t. Zev. 7:6).

בְּנֶפֶשׁ בֶּן רַכְדִּירִי הַשְּׁלִישִׁי, “In/at/by the tomb of the young man (or son of Rakkikh) the officer/trustee/Shalishite”; “In/at/by the tomb of the third young man” — The Targum for רַךְ (adj.), “young, tender,” is רַכְיָה (1 Chron. 22:5), both from the root רַכַּךְ, “to be tender.” רַכְיָה, Rakkikh, could be a personal name.

בְּנֶפֶשׁ בֶּן רִבְדִּירִי הַשְּׁלִישִׁי, “In/at/by the tomb of the third small pavement/paved terrace/row of stone” — cf. בְּרוֹבְדִּירִי הַשְּׁלִישִׁי, “In/at/by the cave of ... in the third row of stones” (see #7, 2:3-4). רִבְדִּירִי (= רוֹבֵד, MH, רוֹבִידָא, JA) means “pavement, paved terrace, row of stones,” while בֶּן (H) and בֵּר (A), “son of,” can create diminutive forms. E.g., “And how large is a חֲרִיץ (ditch)? Six handbreadths; and a בֶּן חֲרִיץ (small ditch)? Three (handbreadths)” (m. B.B. 7:4).³⁸

בְּנֶפֶשׁ בֶּן דְּבִירִי הַשְּׁלִישִׁי, “In/at/by the tomb of the son/native of Debir the officer/trustee/Shalishite”; “In/at/by the tomb of the third son of the high priest”; “In/at/by the tomb of the high priest of Shalishah”; or “In/at/by the tomb of the third small chamber” — דְּבִיר or דְּבִיר, Debir, was the name of the King of Eglon (Josh. 10:3), a priestly city in Judah (Josh. 11:21), a settlement in northern Judah (Josh. 15:7),³⁹ and the innermost chamber and the holiest part of the Temple (2 Chron. 5:7). בֶּן דְּבִיר may mean: (a) “son of Debir”; (b) “native of Debir”; (c) “one who serves in the holy chamber,” i.e., the high priest; and (d) “small chamber.”

בְּנֶפֶשׁ בֶּן דָּבָר הַשְּׁלִישִׁי, “In/at/by the tomb of the son of the leader of Shalishah”; “In/at/by the tomb of the third son of the leader”; or “In/at/by the tomb of the son of the third leader” — דָּבָר means “leader,” from the root דָּבַר, “to lead” (e.g., b. San. 8a), while בֶּן דָּבִיר, “son of the leader.”

37 The various explanation of מְרֻבֶּכֶת are: “boiled” (Sifra; Rashi; Radak; Maimonides), “fried” (PsJ), “prepared quickly” (Sa’adiah; Ibn-Ezra), “soft” (Rashbam; Ibn-Ezra), “well mixed” (Ibn-Janah), “well kneaded” (Septuagint). See *The Living Torah*, 525.

38 Cf. חָל וְחוֹמָה, “rampart and wall” (Lam. 2:8), which is explained as שוֹרָא וְבֵר שוֹרָא (JA), “the (regular) wall and the small wall” (Lam. Rabbati 2, Hašav); וְשֵׁל הַפְּטִישׁ שֶׁשָּׁה, “the shaft of a small hammer is five and of a (regular) hammer is six (handbreadths)” (m. Kel. 29:7); the possible interpretation of בִּלְגִין as בִּלְגִין, “small flask(s)” (see #4, 1:9). חֲרִיץ (5:8), חוֹמָה (2:10), and חֵיל (10:15, alt.), occur in the Scroll.

39 בְּנֵי דַבְרִי, Dibri of Dan (Lev. 24:11), דְּבוֹרָה, Deborah (Gen. 35:8, etc.), דְּבִרַת, Dobrat, a city in Issachar (Josh. 19:12).

(1:5) 100 עֲשָׂתוֹת זָהָב, “100 masses/bars of (unused) gold” — עֲשָׂתוֹת occurs later in the phrase עֲשָׂתוֹת זָהָב שֶׁשֵׁין וְחֶמֶשׁ, “seventy-five masses/bars of (unused) gold” (2:4).

This phrase has been analyzed as follows. ALLEGRO^{pr}: “... bars of gold.” ALLEGRO: ... עֲשָׂתוֹת זָהָב וּלֵל, the last *lamed* is unfinished, probably the scribe intended to write וּלְלוֹת plus a numeral, “(...) light bars of gold.” Cf. וּלֵל, “to be light,” used in Syriac “of weight light in the balance.”⁴² MILIK: 100 עֲשָׂתוֹת זָהָב, “100 ingots of gold.”⁴³ LURIE follows Milik. Lurie cites many of the sources discussed later. he criticizes Allegro saying that עֲשָׂתוֹת are not light at all.⁴⁴ It should be added that both וּלֵל and its relative זֶל occur in Hebrew, as well as in Aramaic. The rest, including ALLEGRO^{rev}, agree with Milik.⁴⁵

עֲשָׂתוֹת זָהָב is the construct state of עֲשָׂתוֹת שֶׁל זָהָב, e.g., “in one hand עֲשָׂתוֹת שֶׁל זָהָב (gold masses/bars) and in the other hand small change” (y. Hor. 3:5 [15a]); also, “(if) one threw at him (i.e., someone) עֲשָׂתוֹת (masses [of iron]) or shapeless masses (of iron) ... he is a murderer” (Sifri on Num. 35:16). The singular עֲשֶׂת (masc.) occurs once in the Masoretic Text, עֲשֶׂת שֵׁן (sg. const.), “mass of ivory,” (Songs 5:14).⁴⁶ In Mishnaic Hebrew עֲשֶׂת means “mass/bar of (unused) material.” E.g.,

One who makes מִן הָעֲשֶׂת כֵּלִים (vessels from unused mass of metal) ... (the vessels) are (ritually) clean ... (one who makes) from (unclean) broken vessels, from (unclean) scrap metal ... (the vessels) are unclean (m. Kel. 11:3).⁴⁷

The menorah is unfit unless it is made of עֲשֶׂת (a mass of [unused gold]). (If) it is made of scrap (gold), it is unfit, but of other types of metals, it is fit. The trumpet is unfit unless it is made of silver. (If) it is made of scrap (silver), it is fit, (but) of other types of metals, it is unfit (t. Hul. 1:18-19; cf. t. Men. 9:18-20).

The Rabbis have taught (in a baraita): The menorah is made of עֲשֶׂת (a mass of [unused]) gold. (If) it is made of scrap (gold), it is unfit, but of other types of metals, it is fit. The trumpets are made of עֲשֶׂת (a mass of [unused]) silver. (If) they are made of scrap (silver), they are fit; of other types of metal, they

42 Allegro, 33, 136 n. 11.

43 Milik, 284-85, 250 C-120; Milik^E: 139.

44 Lurie, 60 n 3.

45 Allegro^{rev}, 21; Lurie, 59-60 and n. 3; Pixner, 342; Wolters, 32-33; Garcia Martinez, 461; Beyer, 225; Vermes, 374; Wise, 191.

46 Or “plate of ivory” (BDB, 799b), “polished ivory” (JPSⁱ), “a tablet of ivory” (JPSⁱⁱ), “as shiny as ivory” (*Tanach*).

47 Most commentators agree that in this Mishnah עֲשֶׂת means a chunk or mass of metal. Some even indicate that עֲשֶׂת is a previously unused mass of metal obtained directly from ore (Hai Ga’on, Maimonides, Rabbi Samson of Sens, Rabbi Asher ben Jehiel, Rabbi Obadiah of Bertinoro, Rabbi Yom-Tov Lipmann Heller, Rabbi Solomon ‘Adeni, the Ga’on of Vilna, Rabbi Israel Lipschutz, Rabbi Pinḥas Kehati, etc.).

are unfit (b. Men. 28a-28b).⁴⁸

(What does) מְקֻשָּׁה (beaten [metal means])? מְקֻשָּׁה is nothing else than מִן קֻשָּׁה ([it is made] of solid), artist's work, hammer work.... (Regarding the trumpet,) if one does not have מִן קֻשָּׁה (of solid [silver]), one can make it of scrap (silver). ... In (the case of) the menorah ... "if there is no gold, one can make it of silver, or iron, or lead," according to Rabbi (Judah the Prince). ... If one does not have מִן קֻשָּׁה (solid [metal]), one should not make (the menorah) from scrap. However, this is not the case of the trumpets. If there is no silver, one should not make (them) of gold. But if one does not have מִן קֻשָּׁה (solid [silver]), one can make it of scrap (silver; Sifri on Num. 8:4).

The last three citations do not contradict each other. The menorah of the Temple must be made of unused metal mass, preferably from gold, but other metals are acceptable. The trumpet must be made of silver, preferable from an unused silver mass, but mass of used silver, or scrap silver are acceptable.

Accordingly, מְקֻשָּׁה (BH), "beaten (metal)," as well as קֻשָּׁה, "hard, solid" (both from the root קשה, "to be hard"), are synonyms of עֲשֻׁת, "mass, bar." In addition, the term עֲשֻׁשִׁית (MH, JA) means "mass of matter, crystal ball, lantern" E.g.,

Rabbi Judah says, "They used to heat עֲשֻׁשִׁית שֶׁל בְּרוֹזַל (iron masses) before the eve of Yom Kippur and place them (on Yom Kippur) into the cold water (of the ritual bath of the High Priest) to reduce its coldness" (t. Yoma 1:20).⁴⁹

(The tribes of Israel) are compared to the twelve stars (of the sky), (they) are shining like עֲשֻׁשִׁית (crystal balls), they are glowing in their worship like ivory (Trg. Songs 5:14 on עֲשֻׁת שֵׁן).

According to Rashi, עֲשֻׁת שֵׁן means "a mass of ivory," בְּרוֹזַל עֲשֻׁת, "iron masses" (Ezek. 27:19),⁵⁰ and עֲשֻׁשִׁית שֶׁל בְּרוֹזַל, "iron masses" (b. 'A.Z. 16a), and compares them with the phrase וְשָׁמְנוּ עֲשֻׁתוֹ, "they became fat and heavy" (Jer. 5:28).⁵¹ עֲשֻׁת, עֲשֻׁת, and עֲשֻׁתוֹ, can be derived from the root עשׂת, while עֲשֻׁשִׁית, the singular of עֲשֻׁשִׁית, from the root עשׂשׁ, both mean "to be smooth, shine," and they are variants or synonyms (עשׂשׁ - עשׂת, *šintaw* interchange).⁵²

48 Lurie (59 n. 3) mentions the last two citations.

49 Also quoted in y. Yoma 3:5 [14b], and b. Yoma 34b with minor changes. Rabbenu Hananel quotes the Palestinian Talmud as עֲשֻׁתוֹת שֶׁל בְּרוֹזַל. See also BY 6, 4760a n. 2.

50 This is cited by Lurie (59 n. 3). Rid says עֲשֻׁת is a noun, עֲשֻׁת is an adjective, as בְּרוֹזַל, "great, tall" (in Ezek. 46:19).

51 By explaining these terms, Rashi employs the Old-French word *masiz*, *mases*), "mass" (עשׂת, Songs 5:14; עשׂת, Ezek. 27:19; עשׂשׁית, b. Shab. 154b; b. Yoma 34b; b. 'A.Z. 16a). See HR 3, 260b (old pagination); Greenberg, 154, 216; Catane, 32a, 46b, 118b; Gukovitzki, 70.

52 These terms have been analyzed as follows. Levy: עשׂת, *Geschmiedtes, besser Metallplatte, Klumpen* ("forged, better sheet metal, clump"; *Wörterbuch über die Talmudim und Midraschim* [1883], 3, 312). Jastrow: עשׂת, "wrought metal, bar, polished block";

The usage of the term עֲשֵׂת in the Scroll seem to refer to a certain apparently unknown weight. The Talmud discussing the making of the menorah says:

כֶּכֶר זָהָב טְהוֹר יַעֲשֶׂה אֹתָהּ אֵת כָּל הַכְּלִים הָאֵלֶּה — בָּאָה זָהָב בָּאָה כֶּכֶר, אֵינָהּ בָּאָה זָהָב
אֵינָהּ בָּאָה כֶּכֶר ... וְזֶה מַעֲשֵׂה הַמִּנְוָרָה מִקֶּשֶׁה זָהָב — בָּאָה זָהָב בָּאָה כֶּכֶר, אֵינָהּ בָּאָה
זָהָב אֵינָהּ בָּאָה כֶּכֶר

(Scripture says,) “One talent of pure gold shall he (i.e., Bezalel) make it (i.e., menorah), with all these implements” (Exod. 25:39) — (If) it came from gold (then) it was made of one talent, (if) it did not come from gold (then) it was not made of one talents ... (Scripture says,) “and this is the workmanship of the menorah, beaten out gold” (Num. 10:2) — (If) it came from gold (then) it was made of one talent, (if) it did not come from gold (then) it was not made of one talents (baraita, b. Men. 28a).

Rashi says that the term מִקֶּשֶׁה means “beaten,”⁵³ and the phrase מִקֶּשֶׁה

עֲשִׂית, “glass ball, crystal, reflector, lantern”; עֲשִׂית של ברזל, “wrought iron, bar, ball.” עֲשִׂית is related to עָשָׂה, “to be strong,” and to אָשָׁה, “to glitter, be polished, to be thick” (from the root אָשָׁה, “fire”), also אָשָׁה, “a crystal or a ball reflecting the light, reflector.” The Aramaic אֲתַעֲשֵׂשׁ (“to exercise one’s strength”), *Ipa’el* of עָשָׂה (“to be strong”), could be only a variant reading (Jastrow, 130b-31a, 1127b-28a). Kohut: עֲשִׂת is the same as עֲשִׂית (from עֲשִׂית, *klumpen* (“clump”), *Eisenklumpen* (“iron clump”; AC 6, 280a-81b). Ben-Yehuda (6, 4760a-61b): עֲשִׂת may be from the root עָשָׂה, the same as אָשָׁה, an *‘ayin-alef* interchange. Gordon says that עֲשִׂת is a block of white glowing ivory. עֲשִׂת is from the infinitive עָשָׂה, “being thick,” like עָשָׂה, “they became thick;” and בְּרִזְלֵי עֲשִׂת means “smooth iron blocks”; cf. Rashi and Ibn-Ezra (*Hameš Megillot im Bi’ur Hadaš*, “Commentary” and “Notes” on Songs 5:14, p. 50). A second root of עֲשִׂת means “to think”; יִתְעַשֶּׂה, “he will give a thought” (Jonah 1:6); עָשָׂה, “he thought” (Dan. 6:4; BA); עֲשִׂת, “thought” (Job 12:5); עֲשִׂתוֹת, “thoughts” (Ps. 146:4). Kasowski and Kosovsky: עֲשִׂת (from עָשָׂה) is a “lump, solid, thick mass of metal;” and עֲשִׂית is a “thick mass of metal” (C. Kasowski, *Ošar Lešon haTalmud* 30, 1253a; B. Kosovsky, *Ošar Lešon haTannaim, Sifri* 4, 1534c). Brand: עֲשִׂת (MH), “raw, unspecified, and unworked material,” same as עֲשִׂת (BH), pl. עֲשִׂית; its antonym is גְּרִיסָאוֹת, “broken vessels” (CTL, 298). There are some difficulty with this suggestion, עֲשִׂית is the plural of עֲשִׂית, while עֲשִׂתוֹת is the plural of עֲשִׂת. Even-Shoshan: עֲשִׂת, “bar (of metal), mass, a piece of solid material,” “solid lump”; עֲשִׂת, “bar (of metal), a mass of metal or other material”; עֲשִׂת, “solid” (ESH^{dic} 5, 2015a, 2020; ESH^{con} 3, 1725b, 1735b). Bendavid (2, 470 n. 100): עֲשִׂת, ברזל עֲשִׂת, and מִן הָעֲשִׂת, עֲשִׂת may originate from the Akkadian *ištin*, “one”; cf. עֲשִׂת, “one,” in עֲשִׂת עֲשִׂר (masc.) and עֲשִׂת עֲשִׂרָה (fem.), “eleven” (BH, e.g., Num. 7:72; Exod. 26:7). Thus, עֲשִׂת means “oneness, one unit, a mass.” Mandelkern (2, 935d): Jerome probably read עֲשִׂת as עֲשִׂת (from the root עָשָׂה, “to make, do”), “well worked out material.” Levine: עֲשִׂת may originate from the root עָשָׂה, a *šin-šin* interchange (personal communication with B.A. Levine). In addition, the phrase לַעֲשׂוֹת בְּרִזְלֵי, “to make iron” (b. Shab. 130a; b. Yev. 14a; b. Hul. 116a; cf. Rashi), is proposed by Kasowski to vocalize as לַעֲשׂוֹת בְּרִזְלֵי, with a *šin*, i.e., “to harden iron,” a denominative form of עֲשִׂת (*Ošar Lešon haTalmud* 30, 1253a).

⁵³ Rashi uses the Old-French term *batediç* (*battu* in modern French), “beaten” (Exod. 25:18,31; Num. 8:4). See Herczeg, *Exodus*, 328 and n. 4, 336; *Numbers*, 89 and n. 5; *HR* 3, 679; Greenberg, 38, 55; Gukovitzki, 135, 143.

תִּיעָשָׂה הַמְנוֹרָה, “beaten out shall be made the menorah,” means it should come from one piece (Exod. 25:31). Rashi adds a Midrash, God said to Moses, “Throw אֶת הַכֶּכֶר (the talent [of gold]) into the fire, and it (the menorah) will be made by itself.”

Since מִקְשָׁה זָהָב, “beaten out gold,” was כֶּכֶר זָהָב, “one talent of gold,” and מִקְשָׁה זָהָב is a synonym of עֲשֵׂת זָהָב, therefore it follows that עֲשֵׂת זָהָב, “one gold mass/bar” must weigh כֶּכֶר זָהָב, “one talent of gold.”

Based on the aforementioned discussion one may conclude the following suggestions.

- (1) עֲשֵׂתוֹת זָהָב followed by a number may indicate that עֲשֵׂת had a certain weight, although כֵּלִים, “vessels,” are also mentioned in the Scroll without noting their weight.
- (2) עֲשֵׂת and עֲשֵׂשִׁית, both mean, “mass, bar” of unused material, and are related or are variants of the same term.
- (3) קָשָׁה, “hard (material),” and מִקְשָׁה, “beaten out (material),” are related or are variants of the same term.
- (4) עֲשֵׂת, עֲשֵׂשִׁית, קָשָׁה, and מִקְשָׁה, are synonyms. The basic meaning of these terms is mass, bar, solid (unused) matter, such as gold, silver, iron, ivory.
- (5) The (standard) weight of a gold עֲשֵׂת, עֲשֵׂשִׁית, קָשָׁה, and מִקְשָׁה seems to be כֶּכֶר זָהָב, “one gold talent.” Perhaps the same is true regarding other materials.
- (6) Probably the best interpretation of עֲשֵׂתוֹת זָהָב is “bars/masses of unused gold (talents).”

ITEM 3

בבור הגדול שבחצר	1:6b
הפרסטלון בירכ קרקעו סתומ בחליא	1:7
נגד הפתח העליון ככרין תשע מאת	1:8

- 1:6b In the great cistern which is in the Court of
 1:7 the Peristyle, at the side of its bottom concealed in the circular-wall,
 1:8 opposite to the upper entrance, (there are) nine hundred (unspecified) talents.

COMMENTARY

(1:6) בבור־בבור הגדול שבחצר הפרסטלון, “In the great pit/cistern which is in the Court of the Peristyle” — cf. ויבא עד בור הגדול אשר בשכו, “and he came to the great cistern which is in Secu” (1 Sam. 19:22). Six items start with the word בבור־בבור, “in/at/by a/the pit/cistern (of)” (1:6, 2:1, 2:7, 2:10, 4:1, 10:3), and once בור appears in the middle of an item (2:6). בור (pl. בורות)¹ means “pit” (Gen. 37:24); “pit, cistern” (Exod. 21:33); “cistern, well” (1 Chron. 11:18); “dungeon” (Exod. 12:29); and “grave” (Ezek. 32:23). בור Mishnaic Hebrew also connotes a *mikve*, i.e., “ritual bath; e.g., הבור, שֶׁבְּחֶצֶר, “the cistern/*mikve* which in the courtyard” (m. Miq. 3:2). בור in Biblical Hebrew is masculine, but in Mishnaic Hebrew is used also as feminine; e.g., גַּת אֶחָת לְשְׁתֵּי בֹרֹת, שְׁתֵּי גִיתוֹת לְבֹר אֶחָת, שְׁתֵּי גִיתוֹת לְשְׁתֵּי בֹרֹת, “one vat for two cisterns, two vats for one cistern, two vats for two cisterns” (t. Ter. 3:7).² בור appears in the Mesha inscription, ובר אן ... בר בביתיה (= ובור אֵין ... בור בְּבִיתוֹ) (KAI 1, 33; 2, 168-69 [#181:24-25]). In Neo-Punic (with Latin letters) both BVR (= בור) and BYR (= ביר) mean “shaft tomb.”³

1 בִּירָאוֹת and בִּירִיתוֹ also occur in Mishnaic Hebrew (e.g., m. ‘Eruv. 2:1; y. ‘Eruv. 2:1 [11b]). Perhaps these plurals are derived from the Aramaic בִּיר, “pit, well,” or from בִּיר (qeri, Jer. 6:7, a *hapax legomenon*; the same as בָּאֵר, see Rashi, Rid, Radak, *Mešudat David*, *Mešudat Zion*, Malbim; the *ketiv* is בֹּר), “well, cistern, pit.” However, בִּירָאוֹת and בִּירִיתוֹ may be variants of בָּאֵר, the plural of בִּיר (fem., BH, MH), “well, pit” (a synonym of בֹּר), rather than בורות; cf. לְבִירָאוֹת אֵן (= לְבָאֵרוֹת הֵן) לְבֹרֹת לֹא, “for the wells yes, for the cisterns no” (b. ‘Eruv. 18a). See also #17, 4:6.

2 Also see, M. Avi-Yonah, “בור” in *EB* 2, 41-43; and [Editors], “Wells,” *EJ* — *Year Book* 1973, 350.

The Mishnah says that the Temple of Jerusalem had two cisterns located within the Sanctuary, and a well outside of it.

One is permitted to draw water from בור הגולה (the Cistern [of the Pilgrims] of the Diaspora) and from בור הגדול (the Great Cistern) with a wheel on Sabbath, but from באר הקר (the Gushing/Cold Well) only on festivals" (m. 'Eruv. 10:14).

Milik and Allegro raise the possibility that the "Great Cistern" in the Scroll might be identical with the one located in the Temple, but Lurie disagrees.⁴ Probably, בור הגדול, is not a geographical name.⁵

The phrase בור שיח ומערה, a group of underground cavities, is common in Mishnaic Hebrew; e.g., החופר בור שיח ומערה חריצין ונעיצין, "he who digs a rounded pit (of ten handbreadths deep), a lengthy narrow ditch, and a square shaped covered cavity with an opening, an open large cavity, and a cavity having wide opening and of narrow bottom" (m. B.Q. 5:5).⁶

On the other hand, the seven cases of בור in the Scroll can also be read as: (1) כורכור (with a *kaf*), "furnace, smelter." The latter occurs in the alternate reading of בין שני הכורים = בין שני הכונין, "between the two furnaces" (see #17, 4:6). Accordingly, בור הגדול means, "In the large furnace/smelter." And (2) כורכור (if the *reš* is read as a short-legged final *kaf*), "burial niche." Thus, בורכורכור הגדול or בכורכורכור הגדול means, "In the large burial niche." Regarding כור, see #8, 2:6; #59, 12:8.

חצר occurs in line 2:5, as well as in the possible restorations of ט[... חצר בח] (see #12, 3:1) and [בחצר הפנימית] (see #50, 10:17). It has two meanings, חצר, pl. חצרות, "enclosure, courtyard" (cf. Aramaic חוטר, Arabic *htr*), and חצר, pl. חצרים, "village, settlement" (cf. Arabic *hẓr*, "be present, dwell"); both may originate from the same proto-Semitic root. חצר is a double gender noun; e.g., החצר הפנימית (fem.) vs. החצר הפנימי (masc.), "the inner courtyard" (Ezek. 44:21,27 and 40:32, 43:5, respectively).⁷ In several compound toponyms the first element is חצר, "Courtyard of" or "Village of"; e.g., חצר אדר, Hazar-addar or "Courtyard/Village of Greatness (?)" in

3 See Ch.R. Krahmalkov, "A Neo-Punic Shaft Tomb Inscription from Roman Tripolitana," *Michigan Oriental Studies in Honor of George G. Cameron* (1976), 58-60.

4 Milik, 243; Allegro, 136 n. 12, 169 n. 304; Lurie, 60.

5 Cf. "Rabbi Meir said, 'It happened that someone fell into בור הגדול (the great cistern) and survived after three days'" (m. Yev. 16:4; t. Yev. 4:6). Regarding בור as the first element of a compound toponym, see #6, 2:1.

6 The translation follows Rashi's definitions which are based on the Talmud. Four of these terms appear in the Scroll, while חופר (*Qal* act. part. sg. masc. of חפר, "to dig") can be compared to חפורתחפור (2:14, etc.), and חפורתחפירות (9:2).

7 Cf. Rashi on Exod. 32:9 (also, BDB, 346b-47a; BY 3, 1713b-15a and n. 1; SB, 264). See H.M. Orlinsky, "Hāṣer in the Old Testament," *JAOS* 59 (1939), 22-37; and S.E. Loewenstamm, "חצר, חצרים" in *EB* 3, 273-74.

Southern Palestine (Num. 34:4); **הָצֵר גָּדָה**, Hazar-gaddah or "Courtyard/Village of Luck" in Southern Judah (Josh. 15:27); **הָצֵר עֵינָן**, Hazar-enan or "Courtyard/Village of (the) Spring" in northeast Palestine (Num. 34:9-10; Ezek. 48:1), same as **הָצֵר עֵינֹן**, Hazar-enon (Ezek. 47:17); etc.⁸ In Talmudic legal terminology **הָצֵר** includes houses, cisterns, pits, and caves of the premises;⁹ it may also indicate private property.¹⁰

'Eruvin, the second tractate of the order *Mo'ed*, has Mishnah, Tosephta, Palestinian Talmud, and Babylonian Talmud. It deals among other issues with designing an 'eruv ("mixing, partnership," from the root **ערב**, "to mix") to permit carrying certain objects on Sabbath between a house, a courtyard, and an alley. Many Halakhic rulings shed light on the nature of the Palestinian dwelling system during the Tannaic era. The following also demonstrates the close relationship between Mishnaic Hebrew and Copper Scroll Hebrew.

The entrance to an alley (**מְבוֹי**; cf. **בְּמֵבֵא**, 11:16) was from the main roadway. There were two types of alleys; open on opposite sides (like a short street), and open on one side only (like a dead-end street). The entrance of the latter had two pillars supporting a crossbar. If this bar was at a level greater than twenty cubits high above the ground (**גְּבוּהָ לְמַעַל מֵעֶשְׂרִים אַמָּה**, m. 'Eruv. 1:1; cf. **גְּבוּהָ מִן הַקֶּרֶקַע**, 1:14; **מִלְמַעַל**, 10:2; **אַמוֹת עֶשְׂרִין וָאַרְבַּע**, 8:12-13), it had to be lowered to serve as an 'eruv. Unless the entrance had a shape of a gate (**פֶּתַח**; cf. **הַפֶּתַח**, 1:8), its width (**רוֹחֵב**; cf. **מִרְחַב מֵרַחֵב**, 9:12) had to be ten cubits or less.

Each alley led into several courtyards, and each courtyard (**הָצֵר**; cf. **שֶׁבִּחְצֵר** in this item) incorporated several houses (**בֵּית**; cf. **בֵּית**, 2:3).¹¹ Some courtyards included cisterns (**בּוֹר**; cf. **בְּבוֹר**, in this item),¹² pits (**שִׁיחַ**; cf. **שִׁיחַ**, 4:9), caves (**מַעְרָה**; cf. **בְּמַעְרָא**, 6:7), bath-houses, oil presses, water canals

8 Also, the cities **הָצוֹר**, Hazor (royal Canaanite, Josh. 11:1; in Benjamin, Neh. 11:33; in Judah, Josh. 15:23). The latter is the same as **הֶזְרוֹן**, Hezron (Josh. 15:3). Moreover, one of the sons of Reuben and of Perez were named Hezron (Exod. 6:14 and Gen. 46:12, respectively). Similarly, **בֵּית**, "House of," is often used in compound toponyms (see #7, 2:3).

9 E.g., "He who sold a **הָצֵר** (courtyard), sold with it **בָּתִּים** (houses), **בּוֹרוֹת** (cisterns), **שִׁיחִין** (pits), and **מַעְרוֹת** (caves), but none of the movable objects. ... Rabbi Eliezer says, '(The seller) only sold **הָצֵר** שֶׁל **אֵיזְרָה** (the space of the courtyard)'" (m. B.B. 4:4).

10 See M. Gill, "הַמּוֹכֵר אֶת הַחֲצֵר לֹא מְכָר אֶלָּא אוֹרֵה שֶׁלֹּחֲצֵר" in *Tarbiz* 46 (1976/77), 17-28, ii.

11 E.g., "Five **הָצֵרוֹת** (courtyards) are open to each other and are open **לְמְבוֹי** (to the alley) ... **שֶׁהֲמְבוֹי לְהָצֵרוֹת כְּהָצֵר לְבָתִּים** (since the alley [is related] to the courtyards like the courtyards to the houses)" (m. 'Eruv. 6:8). Some of the courtyards were indeed very small **אַמוֹת מְאַרְבַּע פְּחוּתָה**, "A courtyard which is less than four cubit (by four) cubits" (m. 'Eruv. 8:9); while others were inside another courtyard **מוֹז לְפָנִים מִזֶּה לְפָנִים**, "two courtyards, one inside the other" (m. 'Eruv. 6:9).

12 E.g., **בּוֹר שְׁבִין שְׁתֵּי הָצֵרוֹת**, "A cistern which is between two courtyards" (m. 'Eruv. 8:6).

(אֶמֶת הַמַּיִם; cf. אֶמֶת הַמַּיִם, 5:1) exiting at the water exit (יִצִּיאָה¹³ cf. יִצִּיאָת, 7:14), cisterns with circular-walls or sealing rings (חֹלֶית הַבּוֹר; cf. חֹלֶית הַבּוֹר ... בְּחֹלִיאָ in this item), rocks (סֶלַע¹⁴ cf. הַסֶּלַע, 2:11), etc.

The courtyards were separated by a ditch (חֲרִיץ¹⁵ cf. חֲרִיצוֹת הָרוֹצַח, 5:8), or by a ten (handbreadths) high (גְּבוּהָ; cf. גְּבוּהַ מִן הַקְּרָקַע אֲמוֹת שְׁלוֹשׁ, 1:14) by four (handbreadths) wide walls.¹⁶ One could build (הַבְנוֹה; cf. הַבְנָא, 6:7) an upper floor (עֲלִיָּה; cf. בְּעֲלִיָּא הַשְּׁנִית, 10:1) on two houses (עַל גְּבֵי שְׁנֵי; cf. 4:6).¹⁷ Some courtyards were surrounded by a porch called exedra (אֶכְסְדְּרָה; cf. אֶכְסְדְּרָנָא, 11:3).¹⁸ Additional terms used in the Scroll can be found in the tractate 'Eruvin.¹⁹

The Mishnah distinguishes between חֶצֶר, "courtyard," and גִּינָה, "garden" (see #52, 11:6); e.g., מִן הַגִּינָה לְחֶצֶר, "from the garden into the courtyard" (m. Ter. 8:3). It also mentions חֶצֶר הַצּוֹרִית, "Tyrian court," in which the כְּלִים, "utensils" (cf. 2:5-6) were guarded against stealing (m. Ma'as. 3:5).

חֶצֶר could be a shortened form of הַקְּבֵר, literally "court of the grave," i.e., "grave site, cemetery" (cf. m. Oh. 15:8). Thus, it may be an additional burial term used in the Scroll, such as אֶסְטָאן = אֶסְטָן, "bone box" (11:12), בּוֹר, "cistern, pit, grave" (as in this item), בֵּית הַמְּשָׁכָב, "resting place" (11:16), גִּנַּת צְדוֹק, "(Grave) Garden of Zadok" (11:6); יֵד אֲבִשְׁלֹם, "Monument of Absalom" (10:12), כּוֹנֵה־כּוֹף, "burial niche" (12:3; 12:8), מְעָרָא, "cave, underground grave site" (e.g., 6:7), מִשְׁכַּן הַמַּלְכָּא, "Abode/-Tomb of the Queen" (6:11), גִּפְשׁ, "tomb" (1:15), סֶלַע, "rock," could mean "grave site" (2:11; 11:5), צְרִיחַ, "underground chamber, grave site" (2:5), קֶבֶר, "grave" (3:11), and שׁוֹבֵךְ, "dovecote, tower, columbarium," may mean "underground grave site" (9:1, 9:17).

The Scroll scholars read the fourth word פֶּרַסְטַלִּין as the Greek *περίστυλον*

13 E.g., "One is not permitted to draw (water) on Sabbath from אֶמֶת הַמַּיִם (a water canal) שֶׁהִיא עוֹבֶרֶת בְּחֶצֶר (which passes through the courtyard), unless a separation-wall is made גְּבוּהָ עֶשְׂרֵה טְפָחִים (of ten handbreadths tall) בְּכְנִיסָהּ וּבִיצִיאָהּ (at [the canal's] entrance and exit)" (m. 'Eruv. 8:7).

14 E.g., "(If) חֹלֶית הַבּוֹר וְהַסֶּלַע (the ring-wall of a cistern or a rock) גְּבוּהִים עֶשְׂרֵה טְפָחִים (are ten handbreadths high [it belongs]) to the porch, less than that לְחֶצֶר (it belongs] to the courtyard)" (m. 'Eruv. 8:3).

15 E.g., חֲרִיץ שֶׁבֵּין שְׁתֵּי חֲצֵרוֹת עֲמוּק עֶשְׂרֵה וָרֶחֶב אַרְבָּעָה, "A ditch which is between two courtyards, ten (handbreadths) deep by four (handbreadths) wide" (m. 'Eruv. 7:3).

16 E.g., כּוֹתֵל שֶׁבֵּין שְׁתֵּי חֲצֵרוֹת גְּבוּהָ עֶשְׂרֵה וָרֶחֶב אַרְבָּעָה, "A wall between two courtyards which is ten (handbreadths) high and four (handbreadths) wide" (m. 'Eruv. 7:2).

17 E.g., הַבְנוֹה עֲלֶיהָ עַל גְּבֵי שְׁנֵי בָתִּים, "he who builds a second story upon two houses" (m. 'Eruv. 9:4).

18 "and it is so when a courtyard is surrounded by an exedra" (m. Oh. 14:4).

19 E.g., רַבִּית בֵּית שַׁעַר הָעֵרֻב (in a gate-house), אֶכְסְדְּרָה (exedra) ... רַבִּית בֵּית הָעֵצִים (or in the woodshed), וּבֵית הָאוֹצְרוֹת (or in the storehouse) ... Rabbi Judah says, אִם יֵשׁ שָׁם תְּפִיסַת יָד שֶׁל בַּעַל הַבֵּית (if the owner has there right of access) ... (m. 'Eruv. 8:4).

(*peristylon*), “peristyle, colonnade.” According to Milik, *περίστυλιον*, is a diminutive form, “the small Cloister,” rather than the plural of *περίστυλον*.²⁰ Thorion questions whether the proper reading is פרסטלין or פרסטלון.²¹ Moreover, the Septuagint translates רִצְפָּה as *περίστυλα* (*perystila*, Ezek. 40:17) and στοά (*stoai*, Ezek. 40:18). The latter is used in Talmudic and Targumic literature as סְטִי.²² The term פרסטלון or פרסטלין does not occur in the Rabbinic literature.

Finally, “great cistern” indicates: (1) that it was larger than an average cistern, and (2) that the Court of the Peristyle had more than one cistern.

בְּצִרְיָהי הַחֲרוֹן בְּבוֹר הַגָּדוֹל ... בְּיִרְכּוֹבְזֹרֵב קֶרְקָעו (1:6-7) resembles the phrases בְּצִרְיָהי הַחֲרוֹן ... בְּיִרְכּוֹבְזֹרֵב, “In/at/by/between the catacombs of Horon ... in/at/by the bottom/canal” (see #40, 9:7-8); בְּקֶרְקָעו ... בְּבוֹר, “In (the) pit ... in its bottom” (10:3-4).

In both cases יִרְכּוֹב have been analyzed as follows. ALLEGRO^{Pr}: “rim”; “side.” ALLEGRO: both זֹרֵב, “plaster,” noting “lining,” rather than יֶרֶךְ, “side, recess.” ALLEGRO^{rev}: both “spout,” i.e., זֹרֵב.²³ MILK: יֶרֶךְ, “bottom”; זֹרֵב, *basin*.²⁴ LURIE: both זֹרֵב, “channel”; זֹרֵב (Job 6:17) in Arabic means “to flow,” and it is related to זָרַם, “to flow.”²⁵ PIXNER: “recess”; “tomb’s bed” (i.e., both יֶרֶךְ).²⁶ WOLTERS: both יֶרֶךְ, “bottom”; “recess.”²⁷ GARCIA

20 Milik, 285, 248 C-104, 273-74 D-64; Milik^E, 139, 145; also, BA, 19 (1956), 62; SVT (1957), 22; Allegro^{Pr}, Allegro, 33, 136 n. 13; Allegro^{rev}, 21; Lurie, 60-61 and n. 2; Pixner, 342 and n. 5; Wolters, 32-33; Garcia Martinez, 461; Beyer, 225-26; Vermes, 374; Wise, 191.

21 Thorion, 169.

22 E.g., t. Mo’ed Q. 2:13; Targum Esther 1:6 for רִצְפָּה. The Targum for עֲמֹד (“pillar”) is אִיסְטוֹנָא (2 Kgs 22:11), a variant of סְטִי (2 Kgs. 11:14), סִיטִין (t. Kel. B.M. 2:8), and אִיסְטִין in the Palestinian Talmud (see Y. Yadin, *The Temple Scroll* [Heb.], 1, 204-05). עֲמֹד is found three times in the Scroll (4:1, 6:1, 11:3). BDB (826b) explains פְּרוֹר (2 Kgs 23:11) and פְּרָר (1 Chron. 26:18) as a “structure (colonnade?) attached to the west side of Solomon’s Temple.” Jastrow (1218a) lists various spellings, פְּרוֹרָא, פְּרוֹרָא, and renders, “court, market, open place, outwork.” According to Yadin, פְּרוֹר (BH), פְּרָר (BH), פְּרוֹר (MH), also mentioned in the Temple Scroll (5:13), and פְּרוֹרָא (Targum), are identical with סִי and *περίστυλα* (*The Temple Scroll* [Heb.], 1, 184; 2, 16; “Addenda,” 136, n. 13). רִצְפָּה (“pavement”) is rendered by the Targumim as רִצְפָּתָא (Ezek. 40:17-18, 42:3), סְטִי (Esth. 1:6), and רִוְבָּא (2 Chron. 7:3). The latter is the same as רִוְבָּר (MH) in the Scroll (2:3) and in the Temple Scroll (4:4-5; 46:6). Jastrow (1455) renders רִוְבָּא - רִוְבָּר as “pavement, mosaic pavement, especially the paved level space between steps in the Temple hall, landing, terrace” (see #7, 2:3). Jastrow (972) vocalizes סְטִי = אִיסְטִי when it means “colonnade,” and סְטִי when it means “mosaic pavement.”

23 Allegro, 33, 49, 136 n. 14; Allegro^{rev}, 21, 25.

24 Milik, 293-94, 245-46 C-81; Milik^E, 141; also (first case), BA, 19 (1956), 62; SVT (1957), 22.

25 Lurie, 60-61 and n. 3, 108-09.

26 Pixner, 342, 352.

27 Wolters, 32-33, 48-49.

MARTINEZ: “hollow”; “basin.”²⁸ BEYER: both ירך, “deepest place.”²⁹ VERMES: “bottom”; “narrow part (?)”.³⁰ WILMOT: for קרקעו בירך קרקעו read בקרקעו (בור) הפרסטלון.³¹ WISE: “bottom”; “recess.”³²

יֶרֶךְ (abs., יֶרֶךְ, const.) means “side, base, thigh, loin.”³³ When in the Masoretic Text יֶרֶךְ means “side,” the Targumim usually render צִדָּא or שִׁידָּא, “(the) side.” E.g., the Targum (O, PsJ) of יֶרֶךְ הַמִּשְׁכָּן על צִדָּא־שִׁידָּא is על צִדָּא־שִׁידָּא, “on the side of the Tabernacle” (Exod. 40:22,24).³⁴ בִּירְכָּ קֶרְקְעוּ, “in/at/by the side of its bottom,” is similar to the biblical phrase על יֶרֶךְ יְמִינוֹ, “on his right thigh” (Judg. 3:16).

בְּיֶרֶךְ קֶרְקְעוּ, “in/at/by the canal of its ground,” is also a valid reading. It would indicate that the pit and/or catacomb had a water outlet. זרב, “to flow,” occurs once in the Masoretic Text; בְּעֵת יִזְרְבוּ נִצְמְתוּ, “at the time when they flow (i.e., melt) they vanish” (Job 6:17).³⁵ זרב is a cognate of the Arabic *zariba*, “to flow,” and related to זרם, “to flow” (noted by Lurie). רוב is a variant for ורף, “to drip” (*bet-pe* interchange); it occurs once in the Masoretic Text, וְרִיף, “dripping” (Ps. 72:6).³⁶

Finally, in both cases, בְּיֶרֶךְ קֶרְקְעוּ ... בְּבוֹרֵיבְבוֹר and בְּקֶרְקְעוּ ... בְּבוֹר (10:3-4), “in (..) its bottom,” refers to the “cistern/pit,” the proper meaning of בְּבוֹר is, “in (the) cistern/pit,” rather than “at/by (the) cistern/pit.” The form וַיְהִי... (ש)ב... means, “in (a/the) ... (which is) in it(s) ...” (see #9, 2:9; #11, 2:13-14; #37, 8:14; #43, 9:14-16; #45, 10:3-4; #54, 11:9).

(1:7) סְתוּמָּ בְּחוֹלִיאֵיבְחולִיא, “concealed in/at/by a/the circular-wall” — BAKER^{dr}: סְתוּמָּ בְּחולִיא; MILIK^{dr}: סְתוּמָּ בְּחולִיא; ALLEGRO^{dr}: סְתוּמָּ בְּחולִיא, with a final *mem*, but without a *yod*. The photographs of the Zuckermans seem to support Milik’s drawing. ALLEGRO^{pr}: “hidden in a hole.” ALLEGRO: סְתוּמָּ בְּחולִיא, “concealed in a hole.” סְתוּמָּ, the only final *mem* in the text. חולִיא,

28 Garcia Martinez, 461-62.

29 Beyer, 225-26, 229, 231.

30 Vermes, 374, 376.

31 “David J. Wilmot and the Copper Scroll,” 20.

32 Wise, 191, 196.

33 Ben-Yehuda (3, 2159-60) lists separate יֶרֶךְ and יֶרֶךְ.

34 Neophyti renders על שְׁפּוֹלַי רִמְשִׁקָּנָא, “upon the bottom of the Tabernacle.” Rashi comments that יֶרֶךְ means “as its Targum צִדָּא (‘side’), like the thigh which is on the man’s side” (Exod. 40:22). צִדָּא and שִׁידָּא are cognates of the Hebrew צֶדֶד, “side”; a *šade-šin* interchange, which also occurs within Hebrew. E.g., יוֹשְׁבֵי צִיאָן, “the inhabitants of Zaanan” (Micah 1:11), means יוֹשְׁבֵי צִיאָן, “the inhabitants of a tranquil place,” cf. נְרָה שִׁיאָן, “the tranquil abode” (Isa. 33:20); cf. the comment of Rid on Michah 1:11.

35 Rashi considers זרב as a variant of צרב, “be burnt, scorched,” and so Maimonides, Rabbenu Meyuhās, *Mešudat Zion*, Malbim; see also Ralbag (a *zayin-šade* interchange).

36 AC 3, 319a; SB, 213a, 214a; BDB, 279b; BY 2, 1393 and n. 3; ESh^{dic} 2, 696a.

"hole," is from חלל, "to drill, pierce," or it is a variant of חור, "hole" (see #33, 8:2).³⁷ MILIK: סתום בחליא, "the one which is closed by means of a stone drilled clear through."³⁸ LURIE: בורב קרקעו סתום בחלא, "in the canal which is in the ground ... and they concealed the canal with sand."³⁹ WOLTERS (reads as Milik): "which is plugged up with sediment" (cf. Lurie).⁴⁰ Essentially PIXNER, BEYER, and WISE agree with Milik, while GARCIA MARTINEZ and VERMES concur with correspond to Wolters.⁴¹

סָתוּם (*Qal* pass. part. masc. sg. of the root סָתַם, "to seal off") means "concealed." Seven of the fourteen verbal forms of סָתַם in the Masoretic Text⁴² refer to sealing off water sources (e.g., 2 Chron. 32:30). סָתַם is common in Mishnaic Hebrew. E.g., "Why every *mem* in the middle of a word is פְּתוּחָה (open, i.e., medial) and this one סָתוּם (closed, i.e., final)?" referring to לסרבה (*ketiv*; לְמַרְבָּה, *qeri*) in Isa. 9:6 (t. Shab. 16[17]:13; b. San. 94a; see #19, 4:11). The presence of סָתוּם may support the vocalization of חָפּוּר - חָפּוּן, "hidden," in the Scroll, rather than חָפּוּר - חָפּוּן, "dig" (*Qal* sg. masc. imperf.); cf. חָפּוּן (masc.), "hidden" (see #60, 12:10), and חָבּוּאָה (= חָבּוּיָה, fem., Lurie), "hidden" (see #1, 1:2).

בור וחוליה are often used together. E.g., בור בְּרִשּׁוֹת הָרָבִים וְחוֹלִייתוֹ, גְּבוּהָה עֲשָׂרָה טַפְחִים חוֹלִית הַבּוֹר וְהַסֵּלַע שֶׁהֵן גְּבוּהֵיךְ, "A cistern in the public domain and its circular-wall that is ten handbreadths high" (m. 'Eruv. 10:7); עֲשָׂרָה וְרִחְבֵּן אַרְבָּעָה חוֹלִית הַבּוֹר, "The circular-wall of a cistern and the rock that are ten (handbreadths) high and their width are four (handbreadths)" (m. Shab. 11:2).⁴³ חוֹלִית הַבּוֹר, "the circular-wall" is made of the excavated earth around the cistern.⁴⁴ Others define this term as "sealing ring," i.e., a sealing stone covering a well and has a hole through which water is drawn.⁴⁵ סָתוּם בחלא (*Allegro*^{dr}) can be vocalized and interpreted as follows.

סָתוּם בְּחוֹלָה = סָתוּם בְּחוֹלָה, "hidden by its (fem.) sand," i.e., hidden by the sand of the בור (as fem.); an *'alef-mappiq* *he* interchange.

סָתוּם בְּחוֹל = סָתוּם בְּחוֹל, "hidden by its (masc.) sand," i.e., hidden by the sand of the בור (as masc.). The latter would represent the

37 Allegro, 33, 136 nn. 15 and 17; Allegro^{rev}, 21.

38 Milik, 284-85, 244 C-66; Milik^E, 139.

39 Lurie, 60-61 and n. 4.

40 Wolters, 32-33.

41 Pixner, 342; Beyer, 225-26; Wise, 191; Garcia Martinez, 461; Vermes, 374.

42 Once is spelled as שָׁתַם (Lam. 3:8), with a *šin*.

43 Cf. גְּבוּהַ מִן הַקֶּרֶקַע אֲמוֹת שְׁלוֹשׁ, "three cubits above the ground" (1:14); and סֵלַע (2:11; 11:5).

44 See Rav Nissim Ga'on, Rabbenu Hananel, Rashi, *Tosaphot*, Bertinoro, *Tif'eret Israel*, and Kehati on b. Ber. 3b; b. San. 16a; b. 'Eruv. 78a, 83b; b. Shab. 99a; m. Shab. 11:2.

45 Ben-Yehuda 2, 1465b-66a n. 2; M. Avi-Yonah, "בור" in *EB* 2, 42-43; R. Amiran, "הפסקת המים לירושלים" in *Qadmoniot* 1 (1968), 18 (with a photograph of a sealing ring); Steinsaltz, *Berakhot*, 17 (it has a photograph of a sealing ring); ESh^{dic} 2, 773.

archaic suffix of *he/alef* instead of *waw* (masc. sg. poss.), which may occur several times in the Scroll (see #11, 2:14).

סָתוּם בְּחֶלֶא, “hidden in the sand,” where בְּחֶלֶא is an Aramaism instead of the Hebrew בְּחוֹל. Cf. the Targum for וַיִּטְמְנֵהוּ בְּחוֹל is וַיִּטְמְרֵהּ בְּחֶלֶא (TO, PsJ, TN) and וַיִּטְמֵן יְתִיה בְּחֶלֶא (Frag.), “and he hid him in the sand” (Exod. 2:12).⁴⁶

סָתוּם בְּחוֹלָאֻבְחוּלָא = סָתוּם בְּחוֹלָהֻבְחוּלָה, “hidden in a/the sandy-land,” where חוֹלָה (fem., MH, from חוֹל, “sand”) means “sandy-land, “desert”; e.g., הַמְקַדֵּישׁ בְּחוֹלַת הַמָּחֹז, “who sanctifies (an area) in the sandy-land of the Mahoz” (‘Arakh. 3:2).⁴⁷

נִגְדַּת הַפֶּתַח הָעֶלְיוֹן (1:8), “opposite to the upper entrance,” indicates that this cistern or pit also had an additional entrance, perhaps on its side.

The preposition נִגְדַּת, “opposite to, in front of, against,” occurs in two additional places in the Scroll (נִגְדַּת, 11:6; שְׁנִיגְדַּת, 2:7). The Biblical usage is נִגְדַּת, while the usual Mishnaic Hebrew form is כְּנִגְדַּת (with the prefixed preposition *kaf*);⁴⁸ e.g., פֶּתַח נִגְדַּת פֶּתַח (Ezek. 40:13) vs. פֶּתַח כְּנִגְדַּת פֶּתַח, “entrance against entrance” (m. B.B. 3:7).

Scripture says, וַיִּחַן שָׁם יִשְׂרָאֵל נִגְדַּת הָהָר, “and Israel encamped there (i.e., in the Wilderness of Sinai) opposite the Mount (Sinai)” (Exod. 19:2). The Midrash explains that נִגְדַּת הָהָר, “opposite the Mount,” means לְצֵד מִזְרָחוֹ שֶׁל הָהָר, “toward the east side of Mount (Sinai)”; and adds as a rule, “Whenever you find נִגְדַּת (in Scripture, it means), פָּנִים לְמִזְרָח (facing the eastern side [of something]),” i.e., facing west (Mekhilta’ Yitro 1).⁴⁹

הַפֶּתַח הָעֶלְיוֹן, “the upper entrance,” is like שֵׁית הָעֲלִינוּא, “the upper deep pit” (see #57, 12:4). The adjectives עֶלְיוֹן (masc.), עֲלִיוְנָה (fem.), as well as the noun עֲלִיָּא (= עֲלִיָּה, fem.), “upper level” (10:1), are from the root עלה, “to go up.” Regarding פֶּתַח, see #4, 1:11.

כְּכַרְיִן תִּשְׁעַ מֵאֹת (1:8), “nine hundred talents” — מֵאֹת is a defective spelling for מֵאוֹת;⁵⁰ cf. אַרְבַּע מֵאֹת שְׁקָל כֶּסֶף ... אַרְבַּע מֵאֹת שְׁקָל כֶּסֶף, “four hundred

46 Note the letter interchange of *reš-nun* in טמן - טמר; cf. חפן - חפר in the Scroll.

47 The phrase חוֹלַת הַמָּחֹז has been explained as: “cheap land around the city” or “cheap land around (the place named) Mahoz” (Rashi, b. ‘Arakh. 14a; so Bertinoro); “land of sand” (AC 3, 386b); “sand land near the sea” (*Tif’eret Israel*).

48 Cf. Jastrow, 572a. גִּבְחָה, a synonym of נִגְדַּת appears as an alternate reading (see #44, 9:17).

49 Rashi, adapting this explanation, says, נִגְדַּת הָהָר לְמִזְרָחוֹ, “opposite the mount toward its east side” ... (ad. loc.; see Herczeg, Exodus, 221 and n. 2). Ibn-Ezra disagrees with Rashi (ad. loc.). *Be’er Yisḥaq* (1, 198) solves this apparent contradiction stating that the Mekhilta’ and Rashi refer to cases where no further definition is given.

50 So it is read by Milik, 284; Allegro, 33; Lurie, 60; Wolters, 32; Beyer, 225; and Wise, 191.

silver shekel ... four hundred silver shekel" (Gen. 23:15-16); תִּשְׁעַ מֵאוֹת רֶכֶב, "nine hundred iron chariots" (Judg. 4:3,13). It can also be read as תִּשְׁעַ מֵאָה וּמֵאָה, "nine hundred," which could be an Aramaism; cf. תּוֹרִין מֵאָה דְּכָרִין, "one hundred bulls, two hundred rams, four hundred lambs" (BA, Ezra 6:17).

It is possible to read בְּכָרִין, "talents," as בְּכִדִּין, "in pitchers," as in six other cases in the Scroll. Accordingly, תִּשְׁעַ מֵאָה בְּכָרִין could mean: (1) "in (an undisclosed number of) pitchers (there are) nine hundred (unspecified objects)"; (2) "(there are) in nine hundred pitchers (unspecified objects)." These objects may be coins, since it was a common practice to store or hide coins in pitchers. See Appendix A.

ITEM 4

בתל של כחלת כלי דמע בלגין ואפורין	1:9
הכל של הדמע והאצר השבוע ומעסר	1:10
שני בפי גל פתחו בשולי האמא מן הצפון	1:11
XAG אמות שש עד ניקרת הטבילה	1:12

- 1:9 In the mound of Kahelet (there are) dedicated objects consisting of flasks and jars with handles;
- 1:10 all are of the dedicated (material), plus the treasury of the Sabbatical year and second
- 1:11 tithe. Its entrance is by the mouth of the well at the edge of the canal, (at a distance of) six cubits
- 1:12 from the north toward the cave of the immersion pool. (Code:) XAG.

COMMENTARY

(1:9) בַּתְּלוֹבֵּתַל שֶׁל כַּחֲלַת־שְׁלֹכְכֵלַת, “In/at/by a/the mound of (the) Kahelet” or “In/at/by Tel Kahelet” — The toponym כַּחֲלַת occurs four times in the Scroll (here, 2:13, 4:11-12, 12:10). A fifth case appears in the suggested restoration of הַגְּדוֹל שֶׁבְּכַחֲלַת־שְׁלֹכְכֵלַת, “In/at/by the la[rge] cistern [which is in Ka]helet” (see #15, 4:1).

The four cases of כַּחֲלַת have been interpreted as follows. ALLEGRO^{pr}: “In the tell of Khlt”; כחלת may be the same as כוחלית (b. Kid. 66a). The other three cases are read as בחלת, “in a (or the) hole,” from חלל, cf. Arabic *hallat*, “hole.” ALLEGRO: בחל של בחלה or בחלת של בחלת, “In the trough (?) of the Place of the Basin (?)” חל rather than תל, from חלל (MH), “cavity, empty space”; חל = חול, “unconsecrated area”; or חל = חיל, “rampart.” The *bet* is an abbreviation for בית, “house of,” while חלת - חלה means “basin(s), hollow(s),” from חל(ל) (i.e., בית חלה). בחלת - בחלה may be “another name for the Bathhouse below the *Moqed* chamber of the Jerusalem Temple.” The other three cases are rendered as “in a hole.” ALLEGRO^{ev}: “In the mound of KHLT” (1:9); KHLT (2:13, 4:11); “in a hole” (12:10).¹ MILIK^{org}: בחלה, “in a cavity” (12:10).² MILIK: כחלת, Kohlit, in all four cases.

1 Allegro, 33, 136-37 nn. 17-18, 170 n. 316; Allegro^{ev}, 21-23, 25.

2 Milik published four items of his original version (#3, 1:6-8; #11, 2:10-12; #52, 11:1-

בתל של כחלת, "On the hill of Kohlit." The possible identifications are: כוחלית שבמדבר (cf. Allegro^{pr}), Beit Kaḥil near Hebron, and Khirbet Kuḥlat near Beer-sheba. Based on the Beirut Plaque which states that Temple vessels were hidden in עין כחל (Ein-koḥel) on the western slope of Mount Carmel (lines 3-4), Milik in מסכת כלים amends עין כחל to עין כחל.³ DUPONT-SOMMER: Milik is in error. עין כחל apparently was in Babylon, while תל is "a mound of debris, a tell," not a "hill."⁴ BARDTKE: The first edition of מסכת כלים indeed has עין כחל.⁵ LURIE: כחלת in all four cases. בתל של כחלת, "in the Tell of כחלת"; cf. כוחלית שבמדבר, Beit Kaḥil near Hebron, Khirbet Kuḥleh near Beer-sheba (cf. Milik), 'Ein Kuḥleh in the Negev, and 'Ein el-Kuḥleh near Abadat. Perhaps, תל כחלת is Tell Muḥalhil near Nabi Musa.⁶ PIXNER: בתל של כחלת, "On the hill of Kohlit." כחלת is a monastic center of a community. Tell Kohlit must have been located what is currently the Greek Orthodox cemetery in Jerusalem. One Kohlit was in Sekakah (which is Khirbet Qumran), and another in Ṣehab, in the Land of Damascus (?).⁷ BEYER: כחלת, "kaḥolet ('black object')." ⁸ The rest of the scholars agree with Milik.⁹ תל (masc., BH, MH) means "hill, mound, tell" (pl. תילים, e.g., b. Men. 29b). תל could be the first element of an unattested compound toponym, i.e., תל כחלת = תל כחלת, Tel Kaḥelet or "Mound of Kaḥelet"; cf. the Babylonian place names תל אביב, Tel-abib (Green Mound; Ezek. 3:15; cf. Tel-Aviv in Israel), תל חרשא, Tel-harsha (Magic or Deaf Mound), and תל מלח, Tel-melah (Salt Mound; Ezra 2:59; Neh. 7:61).

כחלת, Kaḥelet, may well be the same as כוחלית, Kohalit mentioned once in the Babylonian Talmud (cf. Allegro^{pr}, Milik, Lurie).

4; #62 [later #64], 12:10-13; according to his 'itemization'), in "The Copper Document from Cave III, Qumran," *BA* 19 (1956), 62-63; "Le travail d'édition des manuscrits du Désert de Juda," *SVT* 4 (1957), 22. Translations of items #11, #52, and #62, were published earlier by S. Roland, Jr., "The Dead Sea Scroll Tell of Treasure — Key to Vast Riches Written on Copper Is Deciphered," *The New York Times*, June 1, 1956, p. 21, c. 2.

3 Milik^F, 323-5, 328, 355-57; Milik^E, 139; Milik, 287-89, 240 C-20, 274-75 D-71.

4 A. Dupont-Sommer, *The Essene Writings from Qumran* (1961), 382, 390-91.

5 H. Bardtke, "Qumran und seine Probleme," *THR* NF 33 (1968), 185-204. מסכת כלים, "Treatise of the Vessels," is an Aggadic work describing the hidden treasures of the First Temple. It was first published by Naphtali Hirtz ben Jacob Elhanan (Amsterdam, 1648). It was reprinted by A. Jellinek in *Bet ha-Midrash* (1853) 2, xxvi-xxvii, 88-91 (עין כחל occurs in Mishnah 10, p. 90). Milik published a combined critical edition of מסכת כלים and the Beyruth Plaque with a French translation ("Notes d'épigraphie et de topographie palestiniennes," *RB* 66 [1959], 368-75; especially 570 and n. X:a, 574).

6 Lurie, 61-62 and n. 1, 65, 73, 83, 126.

7 Pixner, 337, 343 and n. 6, 346, 348 and n. 20, 358. In the last item, Pixner originally equated כחלת with כחלת ("An Essene Quarter on Mount Zion?" *SH* 1 [1976], 275).

8 Beyer, 225-27, 232-33.

9 Wolters, 32-35, 38-39, 54-55; Garcia Martinez, 461, 463; Vermes, 374-75, 378; Wise, 191-93, 198.

It happened with King Yannai when he went to שְׁבַמְדָּבָר (Kohalit which is in the Wilderness) and conquered there sixty cities (b. Qid. 66a).¹⁰

Rashi comments that Kohalit is a district in the Wilderness. Jastrow suggests that כֹּהֲלִית may be identical with the biblical נֹפֶחַ, Nophah (Num. 21:30),¹¹ a place captured by the Amorites from Moab (in Transjordan). If כְּחֹלֶת is identical with שְׁבַמְדָּבָר, כֹּהֲלִית, then perhaps it was located in Transjordan, as Goranson suggests.¹² Regarding purifications, the Mishnah rules that:

יָוֶן אֶזוֹב רוֹמִי, אֶזוֹב כֹּהֲלִית, אֶזוֹב יְנִי (Greek hyssop), אֶזוֹב מִדְּבָרִי (wilderness hyssop) are unfit" (m. Par. 11:7).¹³

כֹּהֲלִית may be diminutive form for כְּחֹלֶת; cf. צֶלֶחֶת, "jug" (i.e., small vessel, 2 Kgs 2:20), vs. צֶלֶחַת, "dish" (i.e., large vessel, 2 Kgs 21:13).¹⁴ כְּחֹלֶת and כֹּהֲלִית are probably from the root כָּחַל, "to color azure"; e.g., צִיִּיךָ, "you (sg. fem.) painted your eyes," or "you (sg. fem.) colored your eyes azure" (Ezek. 23:40); כְּחֹל — כְּדִי לְכָחוֹל עֵין אֶחָת, "(the paint) azure, enough to color one eye azure" (m. Shab. 8:3).¹⁵ Moreover, כֹּהֲלִית, "Kohalit hyssop," was either named after the place כֹּהֲלִית, Kohalit,¹⁶ or its color was כָּחוֹל, "azure."¹⁷ The names of the other hyssops, Greek, Roman, and wilderness, support the first suggestion.¹⁸ Perhaps the jewel כֹּהֲלִי or

10 יָנָאִי and יְנִי (Jannaeus) are variants of יוֹחָנָן (Johanan, John), and יוֹנָתָן (Jonathan). יָנָאִי could be John Hyrcanus (135-104 BCE), or his son Jonathan Alexander (c. 126-76 BCE). See Jastrow, 580b; AC 4, 140a; L. Ginzberg, "Alexander Jannaeus (Jonathan)," *JE* 1, 352a-354b; M. Kayserling, "Hyrcanus, John (Johanan) I," *JE* 6, 515a-517a; Y. Even, "(Hyrcanus) הוֹרְקָנוֹס" in *OY* 4, 130a; J.D. Eisenstein, "אלכסנדר (Jannaeus יוֹנָתָן)" in *OY* 5, 159b-161b; editors, "יָנָאִי (יוֹנָתָן) אֶלְכָּסְנֶדֶר" in *EH* 19, 932-34. Also, G. Vermes, "The So-Called King Jonathan Fragment (4Q448)," *JJS* 44 (1993), 294-300.

11 Jastrow, 618. נֹפֶחַ, Nophah, may be same as נֹבַח, Nobah (Num. 32:42), a *bet-pe* interchange (cf. SB, 527a; Harkavy, 434a, 462b).

12 Regarding כְּחֹלֶת, Goranson criticizes the suggestions offered by Pixner and Beyer; "Sectarianism, Geography, and the Copper Scroll," *JJS* 43 (1992), 286-87; "Further Reflections on the Copper Scroll," a paper submitted to the *International Symposium on the Copper Scroll* at the University of Manchester, 1996.

13 Cf. m. Neg. 14:6; Sifri on Num. 19:6; b. Suk. 13a; and b. Hul. 62b. Some editions have כֹּהֲלִי while others כֹּהֲלִית, some יָוֶן אֶזוֹב while others אֶזוֹב יָוֶן (as one word).

14 Both are rendered by the Targum as צִלְוִחִתָּא. Regarding diminutive forms, see M.Z. Segal, "Mišnaic Hebrew, Biblical Hebrew and Aramaic," *JQR* 20 (1908), 712-13; *Diqduq Lešon hamMišnah* (1935), 78, 84.

15 Also in Aramaic, e.g., וְכִחְלָת, "and she painted" (Trg. 2 Kgs 9:30); כְּחֹלָא, "eye paint" (Targum Šeni Esth. 1:3).

16 See Rashi (b. Hul. 62b); Maimonides, *Tif'eret Israel*, *Rišon leŠion*, *Mishnah Ašaronah*, Kehati (m. Neg. 14:6).

17 See *He'Arukh*, 276b; AC 4, 213-15; Jastrow, 618b; S. Klein, "Zur Ortsnamenkunde Palästinas," *MGWJ* 64 (1920), 190-91. Rashi renders כְּחֹלָא (the Aramaic cognate of כֹּהֲלִי) as לָאזוֹר, *lazur* in Old French (i.e., "azur, blue"), "neither green nor black" (b. Hul. 47b; also *HR* 3, 510b [old pagination]; Catane, 139b; Gukovitzki, 58 #860).

בְּחָלִי, “carbuncle” (Exod. Rabbah on 28:19 and Trg. Songs 5:14, respectively), originated from כּוֹחֲלִית, Kohalit, or כְּחָלֶת, “Kahelet.

(1:9) בְּלִיכְלֵי דְמַע בְּלִגְיָן וְאִפּוּרִין, “(there are) dedicated objects consisting of flasks and jars with handles” — For the various readings, vocalizations and interpretations of this problematic phrase, as well as an in-depth discussion of the *dema* vessels mentioned in the Scroll, see Appendix D.

(1:10-11) הַכֹּל שֶׁל הַדְּמַע וְהָאֶצֶר הַשְּׁבוּעַ וּמַעְסֵר שְׁנֵי בְּפִימָפִי גַל פֶּתָחוֹ, “all are of the dedicated (material), plus the treasury of the Sabbatical year and second tithe. Its entrance is by the mouth of the well” — ALLEGRO¹⁸: “the whole being of *dm*^c oil, and *šb*/*šm*^c treasure, and *ma*^c*aser šeni* tithe, of *piggul* offerings of Passover and *biššul* meal” (i.e., הַכֹּל שֶׁל הַדְּמַע וְהָאֶצֶר הַשְּׁבוּעַ וְשִׁמְעַ, (וּמַעְסֵר שְׁנֵי מַפִּיגֵל פֶּסַח וּבִשּׁוּל (ALLEGRO¹⁹: The comma between “and *ma*^c*aser šeni* tithe” and “of *piggul*” is crossed out. ALLEGRO: הַכֹּל שֶׁל הַדְּמַע וְהָאֶצֶר, “all of tithe and stored Seventh-Year produce and Second Tithe, from (the) mouths to the opening.” The *waw* of הַשְּׁבוּעַ is on the cut. הָאֶצֶר הַשְּׁבוּעַ, “the store — the Seventh-Year produce”; or an error for הַשְּׁבוּעַ אֶצֶר, “store of the Seventh-Year produce”; or הַשְּׁבוּעַ for הַשְּׁבוּעַי, haplograph of following *waw/yod*, a gentile adjective, “Seventh-Year store”; מַפִּית = מַפִּיּוֹת, the *taw* is written as a *gimmel*; cf. חֲפוּרוֹת (9:2), (9:4); cf. הַפֶּתַח (1:8). ALLEGRO²⁰: “all of tithe and stored Seventh-Year produce and Second Tithe of rejected offerings (*piggul*). Its opening”¹⁹ MILIK: הַכֹּל שֶׁל הַדְּמַע וְהָאֶצֶר שֶׁבַע וּמַעְסֵר שְׁנֵי מַפִּי גַל פֶּתָחוֹ, “the sum of the aromatic spices and of the treasure: seven and *one tenth* (of a talent). *Sight* from the entrance of the turning door.” אֶצֶר is a feminine formation of אוֹצֵר (masc.), a special kind of treasure; like דָּג (masc.) vs. דִּגָּה (fem., “fish,” Jon. 2:1,11, and 2:2, respectively). מַעְסֵר is “one tenth,” rather than “tithe”; alternatively שְׁנֵי מַעְסֵר is “two tenths,” rather than “second tithe.”²⁰ GREENFIELD takes “strong exception” to Milik’s interpretation of אֶצֶר.²¹ LURIE: הַכֹּל שֶׁל הַדְּמַע וְהָאֶצֶר הַשְּׁבוּעַי וּמַעְסֵר שְׁנֵי פְנוֹת לִפְתָּח, “after two turns to the entrance ... everything (in them are) *terumah* and treasure, seventh-year produce and tithes.” שְׁבוּעַי is שְׁבוּעִית, “seventh-year produce,” and מַעְסֵר is מַעְשֵׁרוֹת, “tithes.” שְׁנֵי is connected to the next phrase. Since this item does not list talents of silver and gold, the *lagenae* and *amphorae* vessels stored priestly share, tithe, and seventh-year produce, consisting of fruits, grains or oil, rather than their exchange money.²² It should be noted that to

18 Cf. Kohut, who adds that כּוֹחֲלִית is a metathesis for כּוֹלֲחִית, Cilicia in Asia Minor, and that many soldiers of King Jannaeus were from Cilicia (AC 1, 49b-50a; 4, 214a).

19 Allegro, 33, 137 nn. 24-26, 157 n. 190; Allegro^{rev}, 21.

20 Milik, 284-85, 233 B-18e, 235 B-20d, 247 C-90, 249 C-116; Milik^E, 139.

21 Greenfield, 139.

22 Lurie, 62-65 and nn. 2-7 (וּמַעְסֵר is instead וְהַמַּעְסֵר, cf. n. 5; also, “to the entrance” is

read פָּנוֹת the text must be amended. PIXNER: "All of the tithe and of the treasure: a seventh of the second tithe (הַשְּׁבַעִי מֵעֶסֶר שְׁנִי), from the adulterated offering (מִפִּיגֵל). The opening (is found)." ²³ WOLTERS: הַכֹּל שֶׁל "the whole of the", הַדְּמָע וְהָאֶצֶר הַשְּׁבַעִי מֵעֶסֶר שְׁנִי מִפּוֹגֵל פֶּתַח "All of these belongs to the tribute and the seventh treasure, a second tithe rendered unclean. Its opening is"; מִפּוֹגֵל, passive participle of פָּגַל, "renders unclean, spoil." ²⁴ GARCIA MARTINEZ: "total of the tithes and of the treasure: a seventh of the second tithe made unclean(?). Its opening lies" ²⁵ BEYER (reads as Wolters): "to the total of the priestly share and (also) the (content of the) seventh storage, a second tithe rendered unusable. The entrance is." ²⁶ MCCARTER: הַכֹּל שֶׁל הַדְּמָע וְהָאֶצֶר, הַשְּׁבֹעִי וְהַשְּׁבַעִי שְׁנִי מִפּוֹגֵל, "As for all the *dema*^c and the Seventh-(Year) accumulation and disqualified Second Tithe." ²⁷ VERMES: "The total of the offering and of the treasure: seven (talents?) and second tithe rendered unclean. At the exit of." ²⁸ WISE: "All the votive offerings, and what comes from the seventh treasury, are impure second tithe. The cache's opening." ²⁹

הַכֹּל (BH, MH), "everything, all, the whole (of), a/the total (of)" — cf. כָּל־יָסָף וְכָל־יָסָף שֶׁל הַדְּמָע וְכָסֶף הַכֹּל כְּכָרִין שֶׁשׁ מֵאוֹת, "dedicated silver vessels and gold vessels, plus silver, a total of six hundred talents" (see #58, 12:6-7; Appendix D), and כָּל־בֵּית הַכֹּהֲנִים הַכֹּל מִשְׁקָל כְּכָרִין 17 מִנִּין, "vesse<ls> of the house of the burial niche, a total weight of 71 talents and twenty minas" (see #59, 12:8-9); also. הַכֹּל מֵאָה שְׁלֹשִׁים וְתִשְׁעָה, "the total one hundred and thirty-nine" (Ezra 2:42); הַכֹּל שְׁלֹשִׁים מִנָּה, "the total is thirty minas" (m. Yoma 3:7); הַכֹּל טָמֵא בַּמַּחֲזֵק הַכֹּל, "the whole (cistern) is unclean, in the cistern, the whole (cistern) is unclean, in the ladling jar, the whole (cistern) is unclean" (m. Ṭoh. 10:7).

Moreover, these three cases in the Scroll, as well as the Copper Scroll itself, should be compared with the following citation.

I (Ezra) set aside twelve of the chiefs of the priests ... וְאֶשְׁקוּלָהּ לָהֶם אֶת הַכֶּסֶף וְאֶת הַזָּהָב וְאֶת הַכֵּלִים (And I weighed out to them the silver and the gold and the vessels), בֵּית אֱלֹדִינוּ (the elevated gift for the Temple of our God) that

missing in the translation; both are typographical errors).

²³ Pixner, 343.

²⁴ Wolters, 32-33; "Analysis," 248; "Vocabulary," 493 #49 and n. 69. Also, Wolters' comment in McCarter's article, "The Copper Scroll Treasure," 144.

²⁵ Garcia Martinez, 461.

²⁶ Beyer, 225-26.

²⁷ "The Copper Scroll Treasure," 137-39 and nn. 6-9, 144. McCarter discusses the readings of Allegro, Milik, and Lurie, as well as Biblical and Talmudic references.

²⁸ Vermes, 374.

²⁹ Wise, 191.

the king, and his counselors, and his officers, and all of Israel who were present (in Babylon), had offered. וַאֲשַׁקְלָהּ (And I weighed out) into their hands: וְכָלִי כֶסֶף מָאָה (six hundred fifty talents of silver); וְכָלִי כֶסֶף מָאָה (one hundred talents of gold); וְהָב מָאָה כֶּכֶר (and one hundred silver vessels, each a talent); וְכַפְרֵי זָהָב עֶשְׂרִים לְאֹדְרָכָנִים אֵלֶּיךָ (and twenty golden sprinkling bowls, of a thousand darics); וְכָלִי נְחֹשֶׁת מְצֻהָב טוֹבָה שְׁנַיִם (and two vessels of fine polished bronze) (as splendid as gold). And I said to them, “וְהַכֵּלִים קֹדֶשׁ, אַתֶּם קֹדֶשׁ לַיהוָה” (You are holy to the Lord), (and the vessels are sacred), וְהַכֶּסֶף וְהַזָּהָב (and the silver and the gold) are a freewill offering to the Lord, the God of your forefathers. Be diligent and guard (them) until תִּשְׁקְלוּ (you weigh [them]) before the chiefs of the priests, and the Levites, and the heads of families of Israel in Jerusalem הַלְשָׁכוֹת בֵּית ה' (in] the chambers of the Temple of the Lord).” And the priests and the Levites took over מִשְׁקָל וְהַכֵּלִים וְהַכֶּסֶף וְהַזָּהָב (the weight of the silver, the gold, and the vessels), to bring them to Jerusalem, to the Temple of our God ... And we came to Jerusalem ... On the fourth day נִשְׁקַל הַכֶּסֶף וְהַזָּהָב וְהַכֵּלִים בְּבֵית אֱלֹהֵינוּ (the silver, the gold, and the vessels were weighed in the Temple of our God), by the hand of the priest Meremoth son of Uriah along Elazar son of Phinehas, and with them were ... the Levites, בְּמִסְפָּר בְּמִשְׁקָל לְכָל (with the count, with the weight for everything). וַיִּכְתֹּב כָּל הַמִּשְׁקָל בְּעֵת הַהִיא (And all the weight was recorded at that time; Ezra 8:25-30,32-34).

Since in the Scroll many letters are indistinguishable, and essentially the the script is continuous, most words in lines 1:10-11 can be read in more than one ways. In addition, there is a minor difference between the drawings. The fifth word of line 1:10 contains, among others, a *bet* and an *ayin*. These two letters in the drawings of BAKER and MILIK are almost touching each other. However, the drawing of ALLEGRO has between them a dotted *waw/yod* right on the cut, where the roll was sliced into strips (see “The Drawings” in the Discussion). The following are possible suggestions.

הַכֵּל שֶׁל הַדְּמַע, “all of the dedicated (material)” (cf. הַכֵּל תְּרוּמָה, “all of *terumah*,” m. Ket. 5:2), restates that everything in this cache is dedicated; cf. “and upon it is a capital of נְחֹשֶׁת (copper) ... and a meshwork and pomegranates are on the capital all around; הַכֵּל נְחֹשֶׁת (all are of copper)” (2 Kgs 25:17; Jer. 52:22).

הַכֵּל שֶׁל הַדְּמָעוֹת, “all are of the dedicated (material),” where הַדְּמָעוֹת would be the only plural form of דְּמַע in the Scroll (see Appendix D).

הַכֵּל <הַכֵּל> שֶׁל הַדְּמָעוֹת הַכֵּלִים or הַכֵּלִים שֶׁל הַדְּמָעוֹת הַכֵּלִים, “the *dema*^c vessel(s)”; cf. כֶּסֶף וְזָהָב שֶׁל דְּמַע, “silver and gold *dema*^c vessels” (see #58, 12:6-7); and כֵּלִים בֵּית הַכּוֹרֶה בּוֹךְ, “vessels of the house of the burial niche” (see #59, 12:8); also כֵּלִים שֶׁל דְּמַע, “*dema*^c vessel(s)” (see #22, 5:7). כֵּל or כֵּלִים could be a shortened plural form of כֵּלִין (see Appendix D).

וְהָאֵצֶרֶת, אוֹצְרוֹת = אֵצֶרֶת, וְהָאֵצֶרֶת = אוֹצְרָה (sg.), אוֹצְרָה = אֵצֶרֶת (pl.), אוֹצְרָה = אֵצֶרֶת

וְהַאֲצָרוֹת, or אֲצָרָת = אוֹצְרוֹת (pl. const), all are defective spellings — אוֹצֵר (masc., BH, MH) means “treasure, store” (from the root אָצַר, “to store”). אוֹצֵר also means בֵּית אוֹצֵר, “store house,” a term that appears later in the Scroll (see #33 8:1-2). Also,

And men were appointed on that day over the chambers, לְתַרְוֹמוֹת, לְהָאֲשִׁית וּלְמַעֲשָׂרוֹת (for the treasures, for the heave offerings, for the first fruits, and for the tithes) to gather into them, according to the fields of the cities ... (Neh. 12:44).

אֲצָרוֹתֵינוּ וְהָאֲצָרָת שְׁבַע־שָׁבוּעַ or אֲצָרוֹהָאֲצֵר הַשְּׁבַע־הַשְּׁבוּעַ, “(and the) treasury/treasuries of (the) Sabbatical year” — שְׁבוּעָה (masc., pl. שְׁבוּעִים, “seven”) means: (a) “week, weekdays,” i.e., seven days; e.g., מִלֵּא שְׁבַע זֹאת, “fulfill this week” (Gen. 29:27); (b) “week-years,” i.e., seven years, or one Sabbatical cycle; e.g., שְׁבוּעָה אֶחָד וְחֲצִי הַשְּׁבוּעָה, “one week-years and one half week-years” (Dan. 9:27);³⁰ מוֹעֲדֵי שָׁנִים לְשְׁבוּעֵיהֶם וּבְרֹאשׁ, “the appointed times of the years for their week-years and the beginning of their week-years for the appointed time of freedom (i.e., Jubilee)” (1QS 10:7-8);³¹ בְּשָׁאָר שְׁנֵי שְׁבוּעַת חַיִּיב בְּמַעֲשָׂרוֹת, “in the other years of the Sabbatical cycle one is obligated to give tithes” (m. Shevi. 4:7); יוֹם אֶחָד שָׁבַת אֶחָת חֹדֶשׁ אֶחָד שָׁנָה אֶחָת שְׁבוּעָה אֶחָד, “one day, one week, one month, one year, one week-year” (m. Ned. 8:1).

McCarter raises the problem with וְהָאֲצֵר הַשְּׁבוּעָה, “and the store, the seventh year,” since one would expect וְהָאֲצֵר הַשְּׁבוּעָה, the first definite article is superfluous.³² However, there are similar cases in the Masoretic Text; e.g., וְעַל הָאֲצָרוֹת בֵּית הָאֱלֹדִים, “and on the treasures of the House of God” (1 Chron. 9:26; cf. *Mešudat David*), vs. עַל אוֹצְרוֹת בֵּית הָאֱלֹדִים וְלֹאֲצָרוֹת, “the treasures of the House of God and the treasures of the dedicated gifts” (1 Chron. 26:20); וּבַשָּׁנָה הַשְּׁבִיעִית = וּבַשָּׁנָה הַשְּׁבִיעִית, “and in the year, the seventh” (in the verse mentioned below).

אֲצָרוֹתֵינוּ וְהָאֲצָרָת שְׁבַע־שָׁבוּעַ or אֲצָרוֹהָאֲצֵר הַשְּׁבַע־הַשְּׁבוּעָה, “(and the) treasury/treasuries of (the) Sabbatical year.” Twice in the Masoretic Text וּבַשְּׁבִיעִית is a shortened form of הַשְּׁבִיעִית, “the seventh year”: וּבַשְּׁבִיעִית, “but in the seventh year (the slave) shall go free without payment” (Exod. 21:2), vs. וּבַשָּׁנָה הַשְּׁבִיעִית תִּשְׁלַחְנוּ חֶפְשִׁי מֵעַמֶּד, “but in the

30 שְׁבוּעָה, “week-years,” is found in the Masoretic Text seven times, and only in Daniel. Steinberg (818b) suggests that this meaning was introduced in the Babylonian exile, therefore, when the meaning is “weekdays,” יָמִים, “days,” is added (Ezek. 45:11; Dan. 10:2-3).

31 Licht discusses the seven year cycles and Jubilee, and quotes Biblical, Talmudic, and Dead Sea Scroll sources (*The Rule Scroll* [Heb., 1965], 211). See also, B.A. Levine, “A Further Look at the Mo‘adim of the Temple Scroll,” *Archaeology and History in the Dead Sea Scrolls* (1990), 53-66.

32 “The Copper Scroll Treasure,” 137 n. 6.

seventh year you shall set (the slave) free from you" (Deut. 15:12); and *וּבַשְּׁנָה הַשְּׁבִיעִית תִּשְׁמְטָהּ וְנָטְשָׁתָה*, "but in the seventh year you shall let (the field) rest and lie fallow" (Exod. 23:11), vs. *וּבַשְּׁנָה הַשְּׁבִיעִית שְׁבַת שְׁבַת תִּהְיֶה לָאָרֶץ*, "but in the seventh year it shall be a Sabbath of complete rest for the land" (Lev. 25:4). *שְׁבִיעִית* (MH) means "Sabbatical year," and "produce of the Sabbatical year"; e.g., *סוֹחֲרֵי שְׁבִיעִית*, "trader of the produce of the Sabbatical year" (m. San. 3:3). Since *שְׁנָה*, "year," is feminine, one would expect *הַשְּׁבִיעִית* (fem.), rather than *הַשְּׁבִיעִי* (masc.). Yet *שְׁנָה* may be a double gender noun, or the compiler(s) considered it as such.³³ Thus, *שְׁבִיעִי* (masc.), like *שְׁבִיעִית* (fem.), "seventh," may refer to the seventh year produce.

שִׁבְעִים, "seventy" — *אֲצֻרְתּוֹ וְהָאֲצֻרֹת שִׁבְעִים*, "(and the) seventy treasures"; cf. *כִּכְרִין שִׁבְעִין*, "seventy talents" (2:6)); *כַּכ שִׁבְעִין*, "seventy *kk*" (4:12).

מַעֲשֵׂר שֵׁנִי, "(and) second tithe" — *מַעֲשֵׂר* (masc., pl. *מַעֲשֵׂרוֹת*; *sa-mekh-sin* interchange), "tenth, tithe," is derived from *עָשָׂר*, "ten."³⁴ The Torah obligates the farmer to give to the Levites *מַעֲשֵׂר רִאשׁוֹן* (MH), "first tithe," a tenth of his produce, in each of the first six years of the seven year cycle. In addition, the farmer must set aside *מַעֲשֵׂר שֵׁנִי* (MH), "second tithe," in the first, second, fourth, and fifth years. If the farmer lives far from Jerusalem, he may exchange it. The second tithe or its exchange must be brought to and consumed in Jerusalem in a state of ritual cleanness. It can also be utilized for peace offerings (most of which were consumed by the donor, his family, etc.). In the third and sixth years the farmer must provide *מַעֲשֵׂר עָנִי* (MH), "tithe for the poor," for the Levites, proselytes, orphans, and widows. In the seventh or Sabbatical year the land must be left untilled.³⁵

During the Second Temple era all tithes were deposited in the storehouse of the Temple: *הָבִיאוּ אֶת כָּל הַמַּעֲשֵׂר אֶל בֵּית הָאוֹצָר*, "You shall bring all the tithes into the storehouse (of the Temple; Mal. 3:10)."³⁶

The following Tosephta describes of the collection of the produce of the Sabbatical year and its deposition in the city storehouse.

33 Cf. the *ketiv* *בַּשְּׁנָה הַהִיא* which seems to be masculine, vs. the *qeri* *בַּשְּׁנָה הַהִיא* (fem.), "in that year" Gen. 26:12). The plural absolute is *שָׁנִים*; and the plural construct are *שָׁנֵי* and *שָׁנוֹת*, a latter reflects the *-ית* formation. The *ketiv* and the plural *-ים* ending may indicate that *שְׁנָה* is a double gender noun, although in the Torah *הִיא* (fem.) is always written as *הִוא* except 11 or 14 cases (ESh^{con} 1, 532a; Gordis, 166, respectively).

34 The Judeo-Aramaic *מַעֲשֵׂר* = *הַמַּעֲשֵׂר*, "the tithe," as alternate readings, occurs several times in the Scroll (see Appendix D).

35 The laws of the (first) tithe are discussed in *מַסְכְּתוֹ מַעֲשֵׂרוֹת*, the Tractate Ma'aserot, of the second tithe in *שֵׁנִי מַסְכְּתוֹ מַעֲשֵׂר*, the Tractate Ma'aser Šeni, while of the Sabbatical year and its produce in *שְׁבִיעִית מַסְכְּתוֹ*, the Tractate Shevi'it. All three are in the order *Zera'im* (Seeds), and have Mishnah, Tosephta, and Palestinian Talmud. Regarding the vocalization and meaning of *מַסְכְּתוֹ*, see Schottenstein Edition, *Talmud Bavli, Tractate Berachos* 1, "Introduction" (1997, Eng. ed., p. li; 1997, Heb. ed., np.).

36 Also, Neh. 10:33-40 (esp. 10:39).

At the beginning (of the Sabbatical year) agents of the court made rounds at the town entrances. He who brought fruits in his hand (the agents) took (the fruit) away, gave him back food for three meals, and deposited the rest *לְאוֹצָר שְׁבַעִיר* (in the city storehouse). Upon arrival of the fig season agents of the court hired laborers for picking figs, making fig cakes, collecting the cakes in barrels, and depositing the barrels *לְאוֹצָר שְׁבַעִיר* (in the city storehouse). Upon arrival of the grape season agents of the court hired laborers for cutting grapes and pressing into barrels, collecting (the wine) in barrels, and depositing the barrels *לְאוֹצָר שְׁבַעִיר*. Upon arrival of the olive season agents of the court hired laborers for harvesting olives, packing olives into the vat, and collecting (the oil) in barrels, and depositing the barrels *לְאוֹצָר שְׁבַעִיר* (in the city storehouse). And from them (the agents) distributed (food) every Friday, *כָּל אֶחָד וְאֶחָד* (each and every [man received]) according to the size of his family (t. Shevi. 8:1).

It was the responsibility of the Jerusalem Court during the Sabbatical year, to collect the produce that had grown on the untilled land, deposit it in city storehouses, and later distribute it to the population. Paying the agents, hiring labor to collect the produce, maintaining the storehouses, distributing the food during the Sabbatical year, must have been costly. Thus, one can reasonably assume that a part of the collected food must have been exchanged for money to cover operating expenses. Furthermore, referring to an ancient custom, the Talmud mentions both the storehouse and the tithe together.

Initially the (collected) *מַעֲשֵׂר* (tithe) was divided into three parts, a third for the known priests and Levites, a third for the *אוֹצָר* (storehouse), and a third for the poor and *Haverim* (strict observers of ritual cleanness) that were in Jerusalem (y. Sot. 9:11 [43b]; y. Ma'as. Sh. 5:5 [24a]).

Albeck says, since the first tithe may be consumed by Israelites, "the third of the tithe" deposited in the treasury was also used for public purposes.³⁷

וְהָאֹצָר הַשְּׁבִיעִי מֵעֵסֶר שְׁנִי or *וְהָאֹצָר הַשְּׁבִיעִי וּמֵעֵסֶר שְׁנִי* may refer to the converted funds controlled by the Jerusalem Court. Although it is not specifically mentioned, the treasury had to contain money, rather than produce. Accordingly, the phrase in question means, "the treasury consisting of both, the exchange of the Sabbatical year produce and of the second tithe."

מִזְוָמָן = מַעֲשֵׂרוֹ וּמֵעֵשָׂר = מֵעֵסֶר וּמֵעֵשָׂר can also be vocalized as *מִזְוָמָן = מַעֲשֵׂרוֹ וּמֵעֵשָׂר*, "and) from ten (fem.)"; cf. *עָרִים עָשָׂר*, "ten cities" (Josh. 15:57, 21:26); *מִן שָׁלֹשׁ עֶשְׂרֵה שָׁנָה*, "from (the) thirteenth year (fem.)" (Jer. 25:3).

שְׁנִי can be read with the following letter as *שְׁנִימ*. It can be vocalized as *שְׁנִימ* (masc.), "two"; cf. *כְּכַרְיִנ שְׁתֵּימ*, "two (fem.) talents" (7:16), and *כְּכַרְיִנ שְׁנִימ*, "sixty two (masc.) talents" (10:7); and as *שְׁנִימ*, the plural of *שָׁנָה* (fem.), "year," especially, since *שְׁבִיעִי* could mean "seven years"; cf. *שְׁבַע*

37 H. Albeck, *Seder Zera'im, Meforaš Peruš Hadaš, 'im Mevo'ot, Hosafot wehaššelemot* (1957), 219. See also b. Yev. 74a.

שָׁנִים שֶׁבַע פְּעָמִים, "seven years, seven times" (Lev. 25:8).

Based on the above discussion, the following are possible readings, vocalizations, and translations for line 1:10 and the first word of line 1:11.

הַכֹּל שֶׁל הַדְּמֵעַ וְהָאֶצֶר הַשְּׁבַעִי וּמַעְסָר שְׁנִי, "all are of the dedicated (material), plus the treasury of the Sabbatical year and second tithe."

הַכֹּל שֶׁל הַדְּמֵעוֹת אֶצֶר הַשְּׁבַעִי וּמַעְסָר שְׁנִי, "all are of the dedicated (materials), treasury of the Sabbatical year and second tithe."

הַכֹּל שֶׁל הַדְּמֵעַ וְהָאֶצֶר שְׁבַעִי וּמַעְסָר שְׁנִי, "all are of the dedicated (material), and the treasures of Sabbatical year and second tithe."

הַכֹּל שֶׁל הַדְּמֵעוֹת אֶצֶר וְהָאֶצֶר שְׁבַעִי וּמַעְסָר שְׁנִי, "all are of the dedicated (materials), treasures of Sabbatical year and second tithe."

הַכֹּל שֶׁל הַדְּמֵעַ וְהָאֶצֶר הַשְּׁבַעִי וּמַעְסָר שְׁנִי, "all are of the dedicated (material), plus the treasury of the Sabbatical year (and of) second tithe."

הַכֹּל שֶׁל הַדְּמֵעוֹת אֶצֶר הַשְּׁבַעִי וּמַעְסָר שְׁנִי, "all are of the dedicated (materials), treasury of the Sabbatical year and of) second tithe."

הַכֹּל שֶׁל הַדְּמֵעַ וְהָאֶצֶר שְׁבַעִים עָסָר שְׁנִים, "all are of the dedicated (material), plus the treasures of seventy (years and) ten years."

הַכֹּל שֶׁל הַדְּמֵעַ וְהָאֶצֶר שְׁבַעִים עָסָר שְׁנִים, "all are of the dedicated (material), and the treasures (numbered) seventy, ten, two."

הַכֹּל שֶׁל הַדְּמֵעוֹת אֶצֶר וְהָאֶצֶר שְׁבַעִים עָסָר שְׁנִים, "all are of the dedicated (materials), treasures of seventy (years and) ten years," or "all are of dedicated treasures of seventy (years and) ten years."

הַכֹּל שֶׁל הַדְּמֵעוֹת אֶצֶר שְׁבַעִים עָסָר שְׁנִים, "all are of the dedicated treasures (numbered) seventy, ten, two."

הַכֹּל שֶׁל הַדְּמֵעַ וְהָאֶצֶר שְׁבַעִי וּמַעְסָר שְׁנִי, "all are of the dedicated (material), plus the treasures of seven years and from ten years."

הַכֹּל שֶׁל הַדְּמֵעוֹת אֶצֶר וְהָאֶצֶר שְׁבַעִי וּמַעְסָר שְׁנִי, "all are of the dedicated (material), treasures of seven years and from ten years."

Concerning these suggestions, the following should be added. If it is הַכֹּל שֶׁל הַדְּמֵעַ, then it refers to the previous phrase, i.e., a restatement that לָגִין, etc., are dedicated vessels, and -וְהָ indicates that there are additional hidden things. If it is הַכֹּל שֶׁל הַדְּמֵעוֹת, it introduces the facts that are followed.

The possible readings of the next word as מַפִּיגָל or מַפּוּגָל deserve detailed analysis. מַפִּיגָל = מַפְּגוּל, "of *piggul* offering of," is Allegro's original reading which he linked with the next misread word, "Passover." This is evident from the comma separating the phrases, which at a later time Allegro crossed out. In his first edition Allegro rejects this reading, but in his second one *piggul* reappears again, although connected with the previous phrase, i.e., with the second tithe. This was accepted by Pixner. Wolters, Wise, and McCarter read מַפּוּגָל (MH, *Pu'el* [pass.] part. masc. sg., also used as an adjective).³⁸

³⁸ By explaining that *mefuggal* is a passive participle of *piggel* (*Pi'el*), Wolters follows Jastrow (1133b).

The Torah commands that a vow, pledge, or peace sacrifice should be eaten on the same day, but may be eaten the second day. Any left over on the third day must be burned. If one eats from it on the third day, the sacrifice will not be accepted; it is considered *piggul*, “rejected, refused, disgusting,” and that person will bear his guilt (cf. Lev. 7:18, 19:7). Halakhically a sacrifice becomes *piggul*: (a) if it is eaten after the prescribed time; (b) if part of the sacrificial ritual is performed after the prescribed time; or (c) if there is intent to do so (cf. m. Zev. 2:2-3). Also,

He who slaughters the thank offering (with the intention) to eat from it next day, it (the offering) and the (companion) bread are מְפוגֵלִין (they became *piggul*); (he who slaughters with the intention) to eat from the bread next day, the bread is מְפוגֵל (became *piggul*), but the thank offering is not מְפוגֵלֶת (did not become *piggul*; m. Men. 2:3).

This Mishnah uses מְפוגֵל (sg. masc.), מְפוגֵלֶת (sg. fem), and מְפוגֵלִין (pl. masc.), three of the four *Pu'al* (passive) participle forms. מְפוגֵל is related to or variant of פָּגַר, “corpse, carcass”; cf. Rashi on פָּגְרִים and its Targum Onkelos פְּגִלִין, “carcasses” (Gen. 15:11). Moreover, the roots פָּגַל and פָּגַר are related to פָּגַם (MH), “to spoil,” *lamed-mem-reš* interchanges.³⁹

The second tithe is given from agricultural products, such as grain, fruit, oil, wine. It can become טָמֵא, ritually unclean, but redeemable, especially outside of Jerusalem. If one brings from the exchange of the second tithe a peace sacrifice (and perhaps sacrificial bread, oil, or wine), it may become *piggul* if the sacrifice is performed by the priest with improper intention. However, a sacrifice has no longer the status of a second tithe. Even if second tithe *piggul* could exist, it would have to be burned,⁴⁰ therefore, it would be pointless to record its hidden location on a copper sheet.

The second and third words of line 1:11 can be read as בְּפִה שֶׁל = בְּפִי גֵל, cf. בְּסֶךְ אִישׁ בְּפִי אֲמַתְחָתוֹ, “(every) man’s money (is) in (the) mouth of his sack” (Gen. 42:27, 43:21, 44:1). However, the first letter looks more like a *mem* than a *bet*, plus *waw* and *yod* are indistinguishable in the Scroll. Thus, it can be read as מִפִּי שֶׁל = מִפִּי, “from the mouth of”; cf. מִפִּי צָר, “from (the) mouth of distress” (Job 36:17). It is also possible to read as מִפּוֹ = מִפֶּה, “from/on this side.” פּוֹ, as well as פֶּה (Job 38:11) are variants of פֶּה; cf. אֶחָד מִפֶּה וְאֶחָד מִפּוֹ and אֶחָד מִפּוֹ וְאֶחָד מִפּוֹ, “one is this side, and one on that side” (Ezek. 40:26 and 40:49, respectively).⁴¹

39 Regarding פִּיגּוּל, see “מילואים” in *Torah Shelema* 27, 203-05.

40 נותר like פִּגּוּל, “sacrificial remains,” must be burned during the next non-festival daytime hours (see Maimonides, *Mišneh Torah, Pesulei hamMiqdašim*, 19).

41 The prepositions בִּ- and מִן-בִּ- as well as בִּ- with כִּ- occasionally are interchanged. E.g., ה' וַיִּרְעַם בְּשָׁמַיִם vs. ה' יִרְעַם מִן שָׁמַיִם ה', as well as their Targum, ה' (וְ)אַכְלִי מִן שָׁמַיָּא ה' “(and) the Lord thundered from heaven” (Ps. 18:14 and 2 Sam. 22:14, respectively); בָּאָדָם (ketiv), מֵאָדָם (qeri), “from man” (Josh. 3:16); בְּעֵלּוֹת (ketiv), מֵעֵלּוֹת (qeri), “as they came

גַּל (masc., BH, MH; from the root גָּלל, "to roll"), has several meanings, such as "well,"⁴² "wave" (Ps. 107:26), "(stone) heap" (Gen. 31:46), "ruin" (Jer. 9:10), "hinge, revolving door" (b. Shab. 81a). גַּל, גָּר, גֵּר (9:15, 10:3), and יָגַר (4:13, 6:14, 8:8) may be synonyms and/or variants, a *lamed-reš* interchange (see #20, 4:13; #43, 9:15).

תֵּל, "mound, tel" — Since the *gimmel* could be for a *taw*, as תַּפּוּרוֹג for תַּפּוּרוֹת and שְׁנִיג for שְׁנִית (see #38, 9:2) as noted by Allegro.

פֶּתַח (masc.), "entrance," or פֶּתְחוֹ, "its (masc.) entrance" — פֶּתְחוֹ is in apposition to תֵּל (masc.), "mound, tel." Likewise, פֶּתְחָה = פֶּתְחָה, "its (fem.) entrance," is in apposition to שְׁוִתְּשִׁיחַ (fem.), "deep (pit)" (see #60, 12:10). פֶּתַח (masc. sg., is from the root פָּתַח, "to open," BH, MH, A) occurs seven times in the Scroll.⁴³ Also its synonym, בִּיאָה (fem.), "entrance," appears in the Scroll: בִּיאָתָה = בִּיאָתָה, "its (fem.) entrance," or בִּיאָתָה = בִּיאָתָה, as well as בִּיאָתוֹ, "its (masc.) entrance" (see #10, 2:12).

The following are possible readings, vocalizations, and interpretations for this problematic phrase. Many of these lack the expected definite article *he*; cf. בְּפִי כְסִילִים, "in (the) mouths of (the) fools" (Prov. 26:7,9), vs. מִפִּי הַנְּבִיאִים, "from (the) mouths of the prophets" (Zech. 8:9); also, בְּפִי הַמְּבוּעַ, "at/by/in (the) mouth of the spring" (12:6).

בְּפִימִי גַל פֶּתְחוֹפֶתַח, "in/at/by/along/from (the) mouth/opening of (the) well/heap/revolving-door of (the/its) entrance."

מִפּוֹ גַל פֶּתְחוֹפֶתַח, "from/of/on this side of (the) well/heap/revolving-door of (the/its) entrance."

בְּפִימִי תֵל פֶּתַח, "in/at/by/from (the) opening of (the) mound/tel (there is) an entrance," referring to תֵּל שֶׁל כְּהֶלֶת, Tel Kahelet.

בְּפִימִי תֵל פֶּתַח, "in/at/by/from (the) opening of (the) mound/tel is its entrance," referring to תֵּל שֶׁל כְּהֶלֶת, Tel Kahelet.

שְׁנַיִם פִּיתּוּפִית לְפֶתַח, "(there are) two openings of its (masc.) entrance"; or שְׁנַיִם פִּיתּוּפִית לְפֶתַח, "(there are) two openings for the entrance" (the *waw*

up" (Josh. 4:18; cf. Gordis, 143-44). These are also known in Ugaritic (see *UT*, 92-93).

42 E.g., גַּל נֶעוּל, "locked well" (Songs 4:12). Also, עַל גַּל שְׁרָשָׁיו יִסְבְּכוּ is usually translated as "upon the heap its roots are twined" (Job 8:17; cf. Targum, Rashi, Rik, Ibn-Ezra, Malbim). Yet it may mean, "upon the well its roots are twined" (cf. Ralbag, *Mešudat David*, *Mešudat Zion*; also ESh^{con} 1, 437a). גִּלְת, "wells" (Josh. 15:19, sg. גִּלְתָּה), is the feminine form of גַּל (cf. Rashi, Ibn-Ezra, *Mešudat Zion*, *Seror Hamor*, also SB, 146a [on Songs 4:12]; Radak, *Mešudat Zion* [on Josh. 15:19]; *Mešudat Zion* [on Jud. 1:15]). Ben-Yehuda (2, 761a and n. 2, 773b-74a) notes that גַּל ("well") has no parallel in the Semitic languages, and suggests the reading גֵּן, as in the first hemistich (cf. BDB, 164b). Apparently Ben-Yehuda reads, לְשֶׁכֶּת הַגִּזְלָה שָׁם הָיָה בּוֹר הַגִּזְלָה, "The chamber of the Spring, there was the cistern of the spring" (m. Mid. 5:4).

43 1:8, 1:11, 6:3, 6:9, 10:10, 12:10, and the plural פִּתְחֵינִי, 6:2. פִּתְחָה (pl. פִּתְחֵינִי) is the Aramaic cognate of פֶּתַח; e.g., Trg. 1 Chron. 17:25.

belongs to the next phrase); where שְׁנִי = שְׁנַיִם is instead שְׁנִי (see #38, 9:2), while פִּית = פִּיּוֹת and פִּית = פִּיּוֹת (defective) are the plurals of פֶּה (masc.), “mouth, opening, edge” (see #32, 7:14; #35, 8:8). Cf. חֶרֶב וְלֶה שְׁנִי פִיּוֹת, “a sword, and it has two edges,” i.e., a double edged sword (Judg. 3:15). In these suggestions the *gimmel* is instead of a *taw*, cf. the possible readings of גַּל for תַּל. Also, the previous שְׁנִי is connected to this phrase.

Thus far the text has been separated as: (a) The first phrase ends with הַכֹּל שֶׁל הַדְּמָעוֹת הַדְּמָעוֹת. (b) הַכֹּל שֶׁל הַדְּמָעוֹת הַדְּמָעוֹת is the beginning of the second phrase. (c) The second phrase ends with מַעֲסָר שְׁנִי, while מַפִּי גַל is the beginning of the third one. (d) The second phrase ends with מַפִּי גַל, while פֶּתָחוֹ is the beginning of the third one. Moreover, גַּל בְּפִי גַל may belong to the previous phrase, i.e., the deposit is located in the well, heap, or grave in Tell Kafelet. If, however, it belongs to the next phrase, it may indicate the entrance of the hiding place. Also, בְּפִי גַל, may refer to a second location where additional objects are hidden.

(1:11) בְּשׁוּלֵי הָאָמָא, “in/at/by/along the edge/bottom of the canal” — This is the accepted reading of the scholars.⁴⁴ Since often *bet* and *mem* are indistinguishable in the Scroll, it can be read as מְשׁוּלֵי הָאָמָא, “from the edge of the canal.” Also possible to read as וּבְשׁוּלֵי מְשׁוּלֵי הָאָמָא (with the previous *waw*), “and in/at/by/along/from the edge/bottom of the canal.”

שׁוּלִים (const. שׁוּלִי, BH, MH), “edge/bottom/base,” is always plural or dual. מְשׁוּלֵי = מְשׁוּלֵי (defective) means “from its (masc.) bottom”; e.g., שׁוּלֵי, “its (masc.) bottom” (Exod. 28:33); cf. תַּחְתֵּי for תַּחְתֵּי, “under it (masc.)” (see #25, 6:5). The assumed singular is שׁוּל (masc.). It is related to שָׁבֵל (prob. masc.), “skirt,” שְׁפֹל (masc.), “lower part,” שְׁפֹל (masc.), “low, humble,” שְׁפֹלָה (fem.), “lowland” (from the root שָׁפַל, “to be low”), *waw-bet-pe* letter interchanges.⁴⁵

44 Allegro, 33, 137-38 n. 27; Milik, 284; Lurie, 62, 64-65 n. 6; Wolters, 32; Beyer, 225.

45 The term שָׁבֵל occurs in the biblical phrase חָשַׁף שָׁבֵל, “strip off (your) skirt” (Isa. 47:2). This phrase appears in the Isaiah Scroll as חָשׁוּפֵי שׁוּלִיךְ, “strip off your skirt(s).” Cf. חָשַׁפְתִּי שׁוּלִיךְ, “I will strip off your skirt(s)” (Jer. 13:26), and וְגִלִּיתִי שׁוּלִיךְ, “and I shall uncover your skirt(s)” (Nah. 3:5; see *LLBIS*, 25, 218, xi). The Midrash explains בְּשׁוּלֵיהָ as בְּשִׁפּוּלֵיהָ, “her (skirt’s) lower part” (Lam. Rabbati on 1:9). The Targum of גַּל שׁוּלֵי הַמַּעֲלִיל (TO), “at the bottom of the skirt” (Exod. 28:34); and of תַּחַת הָהָר and בְּתַחֲמֵית הָהָר is בְּשִׁפּוּלֵי טוֹרָא (TO), “at the bottom of hill” (Exod. 32:19 and 19:17, respectively). The roots שׁוּל, שָׁבֵל, and שָׁפַל are related to each other (see #40, 9:7; also SB, 820b, 829b, 868a; *CTL*, 530-32; *HR* 1, 1254). Moreover, Hebrew - Aramaic roots נָפַל, “to fall,” שָׁפַל, “to be low,” may originate from the bilateral root פָּל. Therefore, שָׁפַל may be a *šaf’el* form (cf. Jastrow, 1617a). The antonym of שׁוּלִים is פֶּה, “mouth” (t. Oh. 10:2; see #32, 7:14).

The term שולִים, including the various alternate and possible reconstructions, appears in the Scroll in the following manner.

		האמא	בשולי	1:11
		האמא	משולי	1:11, alt.
		העצ	שבשולי	4:9-10
		עצ	שבשולו	4:9-10, alt.
		עצ	שבשוליה	4:9-10, alt.
		העצלא	שבשולי	4:9-10, alt.
		הנטף	שבשולי	9:1
	משח	משולו	בשובך	7:3-6, alt.
משח	...	מש[ו]לו	באמא של	7:3-6, alt.
משח	...	שבש[ו]לו	באמא של	7:3-6, alt.
	...	שבשולו	בתבסת	11:5-7
	...	שבשוליה	בתבסת	11:5-7, alt.

שולִי is in the Scroll is followed by a noun prefixed by the definite article (האמא, העצוהעצלא, or הנטף). שולִי = שולִיו must refer to a masculine, while שולִיה to a feminine noun. Regarding אמה, "canal," see #21, 5:1.

(1:11-12) מן הצפון אמות שש עד ניקרת הטבילה — This phrase has an unusual word order instead of מן הצפון עד ניקרת הטבילה אמות שש, "(at a distance of) six cubits from the north toward the cave of the immersion pool"; cf. מעל, "above the Ditch of Solomon toward the large clod/sepulcher" (see #23, 5:8-10); also אמות שלוש עד הטורהטפ, "three cubits toward the wall/stream" (see #32, 7:15). Unusual word orders can be found in the Scroll (1:2-3; 2:14-15; 3:12-13; 10-11), as in the Masoretic Text. E.g., on the verse וַיֵּרָא (Exod. 16:20), the Mekhilta says, הֲרִי מְקָרָא זֶה מְסוּרָה, "behold, this verse is inverted"; i.e., it should be וַיֵּרָא וַיֵּבֶאֱשׁ תוֹלְעִים, "and it became rotten and it became infested with worms" (see also Rashi on this verse).⁴⁶

The preposition set מן הַמָּה... עד הַ... is commonly used in Hebrew, as מן-מְנַהֵר מְצָרִים, "from the ... till the ..."; e.g., מְנַהֵר מְצָרִים, "from the river of Egypt to the great river, the river Euphrates," and its Targumim, מְנַהֵר מְצָרִים עַד נְהָרָא רַבָּא נְהָרָא דְפָרַת (TO), מְנִילוּס דְמְצָרִים עַד נְהָרָא רַבָּא נְהָרָא דְפָרַת (PsJ; cf. TN), "from the Nile of Egypt to the great river, the river Euphrates" (Gen. 15:18).

In Biblical Hebrew מן הַ... plus a direction means "from that direction," however, in Mishnaic Hebrew it also means "on/at/to that direction." Therefore, מן הצפון can be rendered as "from/to/on the north," and מן המזרח as "from/to/on the east" (see #10, 2:10; #14, 3:11-12; #19, 4:11). Regarding אמה, "cubit," see #1, 1:2-3.

⁴⁶ There are many similar cases; e.g., Exod. 20:21 (see b. Sof. 38a); Isa. 30:32 (see Rashi, *Mesudat David*); Eccl. 9:10 (see Rashi); etc.

The last two words of this item have been interpreted as follows. ALLEGRO^{PT}: “to the chiseled cleft of the baptistry. ...” ALLEGRO^{PT}: “טבול that which is served for gifts” (it is difficult to read the second and fifth words in the copy of the manuscript). ALLEGRO: הטבול עד ניקרת הטבול, “towards the hewn immersion pool.” עד ניקרת is from the root נקר, “to hewn, chisel”; cf. Syriac נוקרא, “hole, cavity.” טבול is compared to הטבילה, “Chamber of Immersion” below the *Moged* Chamber of the Temple Court (m. Mid. 1:5-6); etc.⁴⁷ MILIK: עד ניקרת הטבילה, “in the direction of the crevice (used) for ritual bath.” נקירה (H) - נקירתא (A) means “crevice.” טבילה (from טבל), ביאה (4:3), יציאה (7:14), ירידה (10:1), and עליאה (10:1), are typical Mishnaic *Qetilah* forms; cf. בית הטבילה (m. Mid. 1:6-9).⁴⁸ LURIE: עד ניקרת הטבילה, “to the crevice of the immersion pool.” נקרה (BH) is a cavity hewn in a rock (Exod. 33:22), while in Aramaic it is a tunnel (b. ‘A.Z. 10b).⁴⁹ THORION: In ניקרת, like in שילוחו (4:9, Lurie) and גריזי (12:4), the vocal *i* is spelled *plene*.⁵⁰ The other scholars agree with Milik.⁵¹

נִקְרָת = נִקְרָת (*plene*) is the construct state of נִקְרָה (fem.), “cave, hole, tunnel” (from the root נקר, “to bore, chisel, dig”). It can also be vocalized as נִיקְרָת = נִקְרֹת (pl. const.). The Aramaic forms are: נִקְרִיתָא, נִקְרִיתָא, נִקְרִיתָא, etc. נִקְרָה occurs only twice in the Masoretic Text: בְּנִקְרָת, Trg. בְּמַעַרְתַּ טִּינָא (TO), בְּנִקְרָה דְּטִינָא (TN), בְּאַסְפִּילְדָא דְּטִינָא (PsJ), “in the cave of the rock” (Exod. 33:22); and בְּנִקְרֹת הָצִרִים, Trg. בְּמַעַרְתַּ טִּינָא, “in the cave(s) of the rocks” (Isa. 2:21). Moreover, the Targums of צִרִים בְּמַעַרְתַּ טִּינָא (Isa. 2:19);⁵² of בְּסִלְעַ, “in the rock,” is בְּנִקְרִיתָא (PsJ) and בְּנִקְרָת דְּכִיפָה (TN), “in the cave(s) of the rock(s)” (Num. 24:21);⁵³ חֲרֵי עֶפְרָ וּבְכֵים, “holes of the earth and of the rocks,” is בְּנִקְרִיתָא (Job 30:6).⁵⁴

The Talmud relates that Emperor Antoninus daily visited Rabbi Judah the Prince by walking through the tunnel (נִקְרִיתָא) that connected their houses (b. ‘A.Z. 10b).⁵⁵ Rashi and Rabbeinu Ḥananel explain that the Aramaic נִקְרִיתָא

47 Allegro, 32-33, 138 n. 31; Allegro^{rev}, 21.

48 Milik, 284-85, 234 B-19a, 241 C-35; 242 C-55; Milik^E, 139.

49 Lurie, 62-64, and n. 7 (there are several typographical errors).

50 Thorion, 165. and n.4

51 Pixner, 344; Wolters, 32; Garcia Martinez, 461; Beyer, 225-26; Vermes, 374; Wise, 191.

52 נִקְרָה and מְקוֹר, “source” (e.g., Prov. 25:26, from the root קור, “to bore, dig,” perhaps from the bilateral root קר), are synonyms of מְקוֹה, “gathering [of water]” (Gen. 1:10).

53 The Fragmentary Targum renders בְּנִקְרֹת צוֹר; it may be a Hebraism.

54 These can be compared to the alternate בְּשִׁיתֵּי בְּשִׁיתֵּי סִלְעַ (cf. Milik^{OT}), “in a/the pit of (the) rock” or “in a/the rocky pit” (see #10, 2:11).

55 See M. Kunitz, “Toledot Rabbeinu haqQadoš” (from *Beth Rabbi*) in the front matter of *Mišnayot Tiferet Israel* 1, 24 and n. 7; J.D. Eisenstein, “אַנְטוֹנִינוּס” in *OY* 2, 121a-123a; S. Lieberman, *Greek in Jewish Palestine* (1965), 78-82; J. Gutmann and eds., “Antoninus Pius (In Talmud and Aggadah),” *EJ* 3, 165-66.

טָבֵל טָבוֹל שֶׁל תְּרוּמָה לֹא טָבֵל טָבוֹל שֶׁל תְּרוּמַת מַעֲשֵׂר *terumah*, (but) not *tevel* which is subject to *terumah* of the tithe (that the Levite gives to the priest)” (b. Beis. 13a). Since the Scroll uses such terms as דְּמַע, “dedicated object,” מַעֲסֵר שְׁנִי, “second tithe,” תְּרֵמָה, “dedicated object” (see #41, 9:10), it is plausible that טָבוֹל has this meaning.

טָבִילָה = טַבְּלָאוּה (fem.) or טַבְּלִית = טַבְּלוֹת = טַבְּלָאוֹת (pl.), from the Greek *τάβλα*, *tabula*, means, “board, tablet, document”; e.g., כְּטַבְּלָא, “like a square tablet” (m. ‘Eruv. 4:8). The *yod* may represent a Tiberian *šewa*;⁵⁹ cf. שִׁיבְצָפוֹן, “in/at/by (the) north of” (see #43, 9:14), שִׁיבִית, “which is (in/at/by the) house of” (see #46, 10:5), while the plural is a defective and non-expanded form (see Appendix D). The usage of כְּתָב, “document” (6:5, etc.), and מִדָּף, “board” (3:12-13, alt.), in the Scroll may support this suggestion.

Based on the above, the following are possible readings, vocalizations, and interpretations for the phrase in question.

נִקְרָה שֶׁל הַטַּבְּלִיָּהוּ הַטַּבְּלִית = נִיקְרַת הַטַּבְּלִיָּהוּ הַטַּבְּלִית, “(the) cave of the immersion(s),” i.e., one *mikve*.

נִקְרוֹת שֶׁל הַטַּבְּלִיָּהוּ הַטַּבְּלִית = נִיקְרַת הַטַּבְּלִיָּהוּ הַטַּבְּלִית, “(the) caves of the immersion(s),” i.e., several *mikves*.

נִקְרָה שֶׁל הַטַּבּוֹל הַטַּבּוֹל = נִיקְרַת הַטַּבּוֹל הַטַּבּוֹל, “(the) cave of the immersion,” i.e., one *mikve*.

נִקְרוֹת שֶׁל הַטַּבּוֹל הַטַּבּוֹל = נִיקְרַת הַטַּבּוֹל הַטַּבּוֹל, “(the) caves of the immersion,” i.e., several *mikves*.

These can be compared with בָּיִת חֹמִים, “in (the) hot bath-house” (see #49, 10:15, alt.). Essentially these possibilities have the same meaning as מַעְרַת הַטַּבְּלִיָּה, “the cave of immersion.” In Mishnaic Hebrew מַעְרָה often refers a “ritual bath,” since many of those were in caves (cf. Bertinoro on m. Miq. 6:1); e.g., “a (ritually impure) needle which is placed *עַל מַעְרַת הַמַּעְרָה* (on the steps of the ritual bath)” (m. Miq. 7:7). מַעְרָה may be a shortened form of מַעְרַת, “waters of (the) cave.”⁵⁹ Regarding מַעְרָה, see #7, 2:3.

נִקְרָהוּ הַטַּבּוֹל = נִיקְרַת הַטַּבּוֹל, “(the) cave(s) of the *tevel*,” i.e., storage caves for *tevel*; cf. בֵּית הַדְּמָע, “house of the *dema*” (t. Ter. 10:16; see Appendix D).

נִקְרָהוּ הַטַּבְּלִיָּהוּ הַטַּבְּלִית = נִיקְרַת הַטַּבְּלִיָּהוּ הַטַּבְּלִית, “(the) cave(s) of the document(s)/tablet(s)/board(s).”

(1:12) ΧΑΓ, “(Code:) ΧΑΓ” — For a detailed discussion of the seven sets of Greek letters in the Scroll, see Appendix C.

59 Cf. אָחֵר מִי גִבָּאִים מִי בּוֹרוֹת מִי שִׁיחִים מִי מַעְרוֹת מִי תַּמְצִיז שְׁפִסְקוּ וּמִקְוֹאוֹת שְׁאִין בָּהֶם. “All are the same, waters of ponds, waters of cisterns, waters of pits, waters of rain that stopped, and *mikves* that do not have forty *se’as* (of water)” (m. Miq. 1:4).

ITEM 5

בשיא המסבא של מנס בירדא לסמל	1:13
גבה מן הקרקע אמות שלוש [כ]סף ארבעין	1:14
[כ]כר	1:15

- 1:13 In the tower of the staircase of Manos, in the descent to the left,
 1:14 three cubits above the ground, (there are) forty [ta]lents of
 1:15 [si]lver.

COMMENTARY

(1:13) מְנָסִים־שֶׁל־מְנָסִים־שֶׁל־מְנָסִים־שֶׁל־מְנָסִים, “In the tower of the staircase of Manos/Mannas” — ALLEGRO^{pr}: “In the ruin of the molten image of *MNS*” (i.e., בשואת מסכא של מנס). ALLEGRO: בשיא המסבא של מנס, “In the ascent of the Staircase of Refuge.” שיא is from the root נשא, cf. Job 20:6; also cf. הר שיאן, Mount Sion, Deut. 4:48, one of the names of Mount Hermon. מנס is from the root נוס. ALLEGRO^{rev}: “In the ascent in the escape staircase.”¹ MILIK: בשוא המעבא של מנס, “In a hole of the *mine* which is at Manos.” שוא is like the biblical שוה מעבא; מעבא is like מעבה (1 Kgs 7:46; *hapax legomenon*). The personal name Manos (“refuge”) could be an unattested place name.² LURIE: בשיאח מסבא של מנס, “In the pool of Manos (in which there is) a staircase (or cavity).” שיאח, *plene* spelling for שיח, “pool, pound,” is related to אשיח (Ben-Sirah), אשוח (Mesha Stone), שיחה (*ketiv*, Jer. 18:22), and שיח (MH). מנס was the owner of the “pool” or “courtyard.” מנס, name of an Arab king, is like the Mishnaic name מנסיא.³ PIXNER: בשיא המסבא של מנס, “On the elevation of the Manos (Emergency exit) staircase.”⁴ WOLTERS: בשיאח = מעבא של מנס, “In the plastered cistern of Manos.”⁵ BEYER: בשיא (= בשיח) המעבא של מנס, “In the pit of the ground-foundry of Mannos.”⁶ VERMES: “In the hole of the waterproofed refuge.”⁷ GARCIA MAR-

1 Allegro, 33, 138 nn. 32-34; Allegro^{rev}, 21.

2 Milik, 285-85, 241 C-36, 259 C-209, 265 D-20a, 300 Addenda to D-20a; Milik^E, 139, 145.

3 Lurie, 65-67 and nn. 1-3.

4 Pixner, 344 and n. 9.

5 “The Fifth Cache,” 169-76; Wolters, 32-33.

TINEZ and WISE agree with Wolters.⁸

Regarding the first two words, the drawings differ. BAKER^{dr}: *bet/kaf, šin, 'alef, he/het/taw, bet/kaf*, a dotted curve that may be the right part of an *'ayin* or *samekh*, *bet/kaf*, and *'alef*. MILIK^{dr}: *bet/kaf, šin*, dotted *waw/yod, 'alef, he/het/taw, mem* (the upper left part is dotted), *'ayin* (a dotted curve plus a solid right hand), *bet/kaf*, and *'alef*. ALLEGRO^{dr}: *bet/kaf, šin, waw/yod* (on a crack), *'alef, he/het/taw, mem, samekh, bet/kaf*, and *'alef*. Milik's and Allegro's third letter is absent in Baker's drawing.

Three words in the Scroll can be read as שׁיא or שׁוא (1:13, 8:10, 8:14). In the first two cases the next word begins with a *he*, the definite article. However, this character can also be read as a *het* or *taw*, and may be the last letter of the word in question. Consequently, there are numerous possible readings, vocalizations, and interpretations. Many of these suggestions are applicable only to some of the three cases (see #36, 8:10; #37 8:14).

שׁוא (masc.), which occurs once in the Masoretic Text, is the same as or a variant of שׁיא; cf. בְּשׁוֹא גִלְיוֹ, “at the rise/top of its waves” (Ps. 89:10).⁹

שׁוא, Sheva, was the father of Machbenah (1 Chron. 2:49), and according to the *qeri*, the name of King David's scribe, while the *ketiv* is שְׁיָא (it will be mentioned later). Sheva could be an unattested toponym.

שׁוא (masc.) means “emptiness,” or perhaps “empty space”; e.g., אֵל יֵאֲמֵן, בְּשׁוֹא נִתְּעָה כִּי שׁוֹא תִהְיֶה תְּמוֹרָתוֹ, “Do not trust a man lost in emptiness, for emptiness will be his recompense” (Job 15:31).¹⁰

שׁוא = שׁוה, Shaveh is the first element of two biblical compound toponyms, שׁוה קִרְיָתַיִם, Shaveh-kiriathaim in south Moab, and עֲמֶק שׁוה, Valley of Shaveh south of Jerusalem.

And in the fourteenth year Chedorlaomer and the kings who were with him came and subdued the Rephaim in Ashteroth-karnaim, and the Zuzim in Ham, and the Emim קִרְיָתַיִם (in Shaveh-kiriathaim) ... And the King of Sodom went out to meet him (Abraham), after his return from defeating Chedorlaomer and the kings that were with him, עֲמֶק שׁוה הוּא עֲמֶק הַמֶּלֶךְ (at the Valley of Shaveh, which is the King's Valley; Gen. 14:5,17).

שׁוה is explained as “plain” (from the root שׁוה, “to be even, smooth”);¹¹ cf. the Targum for עֲמֶק שׁוה, is מִישֵׁר מִפְּנֵא (TO, PsJ), “clear/leveled valley.”¹² Gordon notes that in the above verse שׁוה is a synonym of מֶלֶךְ, “king,

6 Beyer, 225-26.

7 Vermes, 374.

8 Garcia Martinez, 461; Wise, 191.

9 Tur-Sinai compares שׁיא with גִּלְיוֹ (The Book of Job [1967], 310-11).

10 In some editions it is spelled as בְּשֹׁן, lacking the *'alef*, or it is a *qeri-ketiv* case; see *Minḥat Šay*. Regarding the translation, cf. Targum, Rashi, Rik, Ralbag, and *Mešudat David*.

11 BDB, 1000b-01a; SB, 828b-29a; BY 7, 6955b and n. 2; ESh^{con} 3, 2089b.

12 See also Rashi on this verse. Other Targumic renderings are, מִישֵׁר הַחֻזָּא, Valley of

ruler," and it is a cognate of the Ugaritic *ṭwy*, "to rule, govern" (interchanges of *ṭaw-šin*, and *yod-he* in final position, respectively).¹³ Accordingly, עֶמְקֵי שֹׁן could mean "Valley of the Ruler."

שִׂיא (masc.) means "top, elevated, tower, rise" (from the root נשא, "to lift, carry, take"). In the verse יָגִיעַ לְעֵב יִרְאֹשׁוּ לְעֵב יִגִּיעַ, "Though his top mounts up to the heavens, and his head reaches to the cloud" (Job 20:6), the *hapax legomenon* שִׂיא is paralleled to ראש, "head."¹⁴ The Targum renders שִׂיא as וּזְקָפִיה, "his elevation" or "his pride." Most biblical commentators follow this explanation.¹⁵

שִׂיא (ketiv), Sheya, or שְׂוֵא, Sheva (*qeri*), Sheva, was King David's scribe (2 Sam. 20:25).¹⁶ Sheva or Sheya could be an unattested toponym.

שְׂוֵא, *plene* spelling for שֹׁן (prob. masc. in MH; prob. fem. in the CS), "pit" (a variant of the next reading).

שְׂוֵא, *plene* spelling for שִׁית (mas. in MH; prob. fem. in the CS), "pit."

שְׂוֵא, *plene* spelling for שִׁית, "deep pit." Regarding שֹׁן - שִׁית - שִׁית, see #18, 4:9.

שְׂוֵא, *plene* spelling for שָׂאת (fem.), "ruin" (from the root שָׂא, "to crash," the *yod* may represent a Tiberian *šewa*), which occurs once in the Masoretic Text in the phrase הַשָּׂאת וְהַשֹּׁבֵר, "the devastation and the destruction" (Lam. 3:47).

שְׂוֵא, *plene* spelling for שָׂאת (fem.), "rising, top" (from the root נשא, "to lift, carry, take"); e.g., מִשְׁתּוֹ יִגְרוּ אֱלִים, "from his rising the mighty are afraid" (Job 41:17; מִשְׁתּוֹ is a defective spelling for מִשְׁאָתוֹ); and יִתֵּר שְׂאָת, "excess of rank and excess of power" (Gen. 49:3).

שְׂוֵא (fem.), "ruin" (from the root שָׂא); e.g., בְּשֹׂאָה יִפֹּל בָּהּ, "with destruction he shall fall in it" (Ps. 35:8); cf. בְּחִרְבּוֹהָ (1:1).

שְׂוֵא, "ruin of," construct state of the previous suggestion; e.g., וּמִשְׂאָת, "and from the destruction of the wicked" (Prov. 3:25).¹⁷

the Vision (Frag.; see Jastrow, 442a), and מִישַׁר פְּרָדִסִּיא, Valley of the Gardens (TN).

13 UT, 501b (#2662). Aistleitner renders *ṭwy* as *freundlich aufnehmen* ("to receive someone in a friendly manner"), based on the Arabic *ṭawa, jemand gastlich aufnehmen* ("to receive someone in a hospitable manner"; WUS, 333 [#2851]).

14 Guillaume compares שִׂיא with the Arabic *ṣawwan*, "head, skull." He says that שִׂיא means "crown of the head," and it is a synonym for and parallel to ראש in the second hemistich; *Studies in the Book of Job with New Translation* (1968), 43, 103; *Hebrew and Arabic Lexicography — A Comparative Study* (1965), 7. Similarly, B.A. Levine suggests that שִׂיא of this item means "top" (personal communication); cf. Allegro's note.

15 E.g., Rashi, Rabbag, Rik, Rabbeinu Meyuḥas, *Meṣudat David*, *Meṣudat Zion*, Malbim. Regarding וּזְקָפִיה, see Jastrow, 389b.

16 This vocalization of the *ketiv* is offered by Gordis (156), who notes (203, n. 589) that the same name also occurs as שְׂוֵאָה, Shavsha (1 Chron. 18:16), שִׁישָׁה, Shisha (1 Kings. 4:3), and שְׂרִיָּה, Seraiah (2 Sam. 8:17).

17 Allegro's original reading seems to be like this suggestion. This writer arrived independently to this alternate reading.

The second word is *הַמִּסְבָּא* or *מִסְבָּא* (depends whether the *he/het/taw* belongs to this word or the previous one). *מִסְבָּא* (also spelled as *מִסְבָּה*, *מְסִיבָה*, fem.) means “staircase” (from the root *סבב*, “to go around, surround”). It occurs in the Temple Scroll, Mishnaic Hebrew, and Aramaic.¹⁸ Two types of stairs were discovered in Palestine: (a) spiral stair of cisterns, such as the the Pool of Gibeon near Jerusalem having a total of 93 steps;¹⁹ and (b) square shaped staircase towers.²⁰

Yadin describes *מְסִיבָה* (בֵּית) of the Temple Scroll as a square type of staircase. He reads a second occurrence of this word in the Copper Scroll, נֶגֶד *הַגְּדֹלָא הַמִּסְבָּא תַּחַת צְרוּק*, “opposite to the garden of Zadok below the large staircase”; i.e., *הַמִּסְבָּא*, “the staircase,” rather than *הַמִּסְמָא*, “the (large) stone” (see #52, 11:6-7).²¹

The Jerusalem Temple had several *מְסִיבוֹת* (pl. of *מְסִיבָה*), underground pathways or pathways with steps. The Mishnah rules that:

(A defiled priest) goes out and proceeds along the *מְסִיבָה* that leads under the *בֵּירָה* (Temple), and lamps are burning on both sides, until he reaches *בֵּית הַטְּבִילָה* (the ritual bath). Rabbi Eliezer ben Jacob says, “in that *מְסִיבָה* which leads under the *חֵיל* (the rampart)” (m. Mid. 1:9; cf. m. Tam. 1:1).²²

מְסִיבָתָא, the plural of *מִסְבָּא*, is the Targum for *לִוְלִים* (pl. of *לִוֵל*); “and one goes up in the *מְסִיבָתָא* from the ground to the upper floor” (Trg. 1 Kgs 6:8). According to Rashi, *מְסִיבָתָא* is a “winding pathway, passage way.”²³

18 Jastrow (803b) renders *מְסִיבָה* as “winding staircase.”

19 Excavated by Pritchard in 1956-62. Some identify this pool with *גִּבְעוֹן* (Trg. *בְּרִכַּת גִּבְעוֹן*), “Pool of Gibeon,” where King David’s men prevailed over the follower of Ish-bosheth, son of King Saul (2 Sam. 2:12ff). See J.B. Pritchard, *Gibeon Where the Sun Stood Still* (1962), 53-78 and photographs 33-35; H.M. Orlinsky, *Understanding the Bible Through History and Archaeology* (1972), 116-17; J. Elizur, “גִּבְעוֹן” in *EH* 10, 246-47; J. Elbaum, “Gibeon,” *EJ* 7, 550-52. Regarding *בְּרִכָּה*, see #11, 2:13.

20 A. Negev, “The Staircase-Tower in Nabatean Architecture,” *RB* 80 (1973), 364-83, ii-vi; “מגדל-מדרגות באדריכלות הנבטית” in *EI* 9 (1972), 197-207.

21 *The Temple Scroll* (Heb.) 1, 163-68 (in the citation, *בֵּית* is a printing error for *גֶּנֶת*).

22 A short but interesting article appeared in the *Algemeiner Journal — A National Jewish Journal*, Feb. 18, 1983, p. 16, entitled *הַמְסִיבָה* אונטערן הר “איז אנטפלעקט געווארן די ‘מְסִיבָה’ אונטערן הר (= Has the *Mesibbah* under the Temple Mount been discovered?). The article, referring to this Mishnah, relates that Meir Ben-Dov discovered a 200 meter long tunnel leading to a ritual bath under the Temple Mount. The article includes an excellent photograph of the ritual bath. This structure consists of three square shaped platforms at descending levels, each separated on its four sides by four steps, with a square shaped pool in its center. Regarding *מְסִיבוֹת* in the Temple, cf. m. Mid. 4:3,5, 5:3. See also, I. Magen, “הַמְסִיבָה” של המקדש או “הַמְסִיבָה” או “בֵּית הַמְסִיבָה” של המקדש in *EI* 17 (1984), 226-35, 10*; J. Patrich, “הַמְסִיבָה” של “הַמְסִיבָה” של המקדש על פי מסכת מדרות in *Cathedra* 42 (1987), 39-52. Regarding *טְבִילָה*, see #4, 1:12; for *בֵּירָה*, #17, 4:6; for *חֵיל*, #49, 10:15.

23 Rashi in his comment on *בְּלִוְלִים* says that *מְסִיבָתָא* in Old-French is *wiz*, *viz*, and in German *Wendel Stein*, *Schwindel Stieg*. It is a stone pillar having many steps, and one who goes up turns around the pillar. There is no need to extend it like a ladder, since the circular

וְרַחֲבָה וְנִסְבָּה לְמַעְלָה לְמַעְלָה, occurs in the verse וְרַחֲבָה וְנִסְבָּה לְמַעְלָה לְמַעְלָה (Ezek. 41:7, JPSi). Its Targum is, וּפְתִיחָא מִסְבְּתָא וְסִלְקָא לְעֵלָא לְעֵלָא, “and widening the staircase and elevating higher (and) higher.” Thus, נִסְבָּה (also from the root סבב) is a synonym of מִסְבָּא, and so is explained by the traditional commentators.²⁴ Moreover, if שִׂיא is a tower, then הַמִּסְבָּא שִׂיא means “staircase tower.”

To Allegro’s original reading of מִסְכָּה = מִסְכָּה, “molten image, idol” (from the root מִסַּךְ, “to pour”), one can add additional interpretations. מִסְכָּה (fem.) also means “cover”; e.g., וְהַמִּסְכָּה, “and the cover” (Isa. 25:7, 28:20).²⁵ Likewise, מִסְכָּה - מִסְכָּה - מִסְכָּה can be vocalized as מִסְכָּה (Micah 7:4; Ezek. 28:13), and מְשֻׁכָּה (Isa. 5:5), “covering, fence, covered” (fem. *Pe‘ulah* forms), all from the root שָׁכַךְ/סָכַךְ, “to cover” (see #20, 4:13).

According to Baker’s drawing, the second word can be read, vocalized, and interpreted as follows.

בִּבְיָאָהּ/בִּבְיָאָהּ הַגְדֹּלָא שֶׁל הַבְּזֵךְ, “In/at/by the large drain of the Bezekh” (12:8). בִּיבְיָאָהּ (MH) is a rarely used feminine formation of בִּיב (masc., MH), “drain” (see #42 9:11).

כִּנְיָאָהּ or הַכִּנְיָאָהּ, “(the) burial niche” — כִּנְיָאָהּ is an unattested feminine form of כִּנְיָאָהּ (masc., MH), “burial niche” (see #59, 12:8).

Based on Milik’s drawing, the second word can be read as מַעְבָּא - מַעְבָּא, with a *bet*, or מַעְכָּא - מַעְכָּא, with a *kaf*. The following are possible readings, vocalizations, and interpretations for this word.

מַעְבָּא = מַעְבָּה or מַעְכָּא = מַעְכָּה, “(the) foundry, (the) pit” (cf. Milik); cf. מַעְבָּה הָאֲדָמָה (1 Kgs 7:46), it may be a toponym, i.e., “(the) Ma‘aveh.”

מַעְבָּא = מַעְבָּה (cf. Wolters), מַעְכָּא = מַעְכָּה (masc.), מַעְכָּא = מַעְכָּה or מַעְכָּא = מַעְכָּה (fem.; depending on the gender of the previous noun), “(the) heavy (one)”; e.g., אֶחָד מְעֻבָּה וְאֶחָד דָּק, “one is heavy, and one is thin” (m. Suk. 4:9). Regarding עֵבֶה, see #18, 4:9.

מַעְכָּא = מַעְכָּה or מַעְכָּא = מַעְכָּה, “(the) Maacah” — Maacah, is a personal name (Gen. 22:24, masc.; 1 Kgs 15:2, fem.), an Aramaic nation (2 Sam. 10:6, also מַעְכָּת, Josh. 13:13), and a city in Naphtali, אֶבְלָה בֵּית, אֶבְלָה, Abel Beth-maacah (2 Sam. 20:15).²⁶

path itself is an incline. Rashi similarly discusses שֶׁבֶכָה (2 Kgs 1:2), נִסְבָּה (Ezek. 41:7), and מִסְבָּה (b. Yoma 19a). See Greenberg, 81, 85, 160, 280 n. 257, 295 n. 474; Catane, 46; Gukovitzki, 44. Jastrow (698b) renders לֹלַל as “winding pathway, passage way, especially a small room with a staircase leading up to the upper room.”

24 E.g., Rashi, Radak, *Mešudat David*, *Mešudat Zion*, Malbim. Some consider נִסְבָּה as a *Nif‘al* perf. third pers. fem. sg. of the verb סבב (MK 2, 788b; SB, 584b; ESh^{con} 2, 1490b). BDB (686a) suggests that נִסְבָּה should be read as וְנִסְפָּה. Note, the word וְנִסְפָּה, “and it shall be added” (from the root יסַף, “to add”), occurs in Num. 36:4.

25 מִסְכָּה may be a variant of מִסְכָּה (masc.), “cover” (e.g., Exod. 26:14), a metathesis.

26 According to Radak, Abel and Beth-maacah were two neighboring cities.

מַעֲכָא = מְעוֹכָה or הַמְעוֹכָה = “(the) crashed/ruined” (cf. 1 Sam. 26:7; *Qal* pass. part. fem. sg. of the root מַעַךְ, “to press, crash, ruin”).

In light of the above discussion, the following are the possible readings, vocalizations, and interpretations for the first two words. In some the definite article seems to be superfluous, while in others it is apparently missing.

בְּשׂוֹא הַמַּעֲכָא = בְּשׂוֹה הַמַּעֲכָה, “In/at/by the Plain of (the) Ma‘aveh,” or “In/at/by a/the plain of the foundry/pit.”

בְּשׂוֹא הַמִּסְכָּא = בְּשׂוֹה הַמִּסְכָּה, “In/at/by the Plain of the Idol”; cf. עֲמָק שׁוֹה, Valley of Shaveh/Plain (mentioned above).

בְּשׂוֹאֻבְשׂוֹא הַמִּסְכָּא = בְּשׂוֹהֻבְשׂוֹה הַמִּסְכָּה, “In/at/by a/the covered plain.”

בְּשׂוֹאֻהֻבְשׂוֹא הַמִּסְכָּא = בְּשׂוֹהֻהֻבְשׂוֹה מִסְכָּה, “In/at/by a/the covered ruin.”

בְּשׂוֹאֻהֻבְשׂוֹא הַמַּעֲכָא = בְּשׂוֹהֻהֻבְשׂוֹה מַעֲכָה, “In/at/by a/the thick ruin.”

בְּשׂוֹאֻהֻבְשׂוֹא הַמַּעֲכָא = בְּשׂוֹהֻהֻבְשׂוֹה מְעוֹכָה, “In/at/by a/the devastated ruin.”

בְּשׂוֹאֻת בִּיבָה = בְּשׂוֹאֻת בִּיבָה, “In/at/by a/the ruined drain.”

בְּשׂוֹאֻת כּוֹכָה = בְּשׂוֹאֻת כּוֹכָה, “In/at/by a/the ruined burial niche.”

בְּשׂוֹאֻת מַעֲכָה = בְּשׂוֹאֻת מַעֲכָה, “In/at/by a/the thick ruin.”

בְּשׂוֹאֻת מִסְכָּה = בְּשׂוֹאֻת מִסְכָּה, “In/at/by a/the ruined staircase.”

בְּשׂוֹאֻת מִסְכָּא = בְּשׂוֹאֻת מִסְכָּה, “In/at/by a/the destroyed idol.”

בְּשִׂא הַבִּיבָה = בְּשִׂא הַבִּיבָה, “In/at/by the top of the drain.”

בְּשִׂא הַכּוֹכָה = בְּשִׂא הַכּוֹכָה, “In/at/by the top of the burial niche.”

בְּשִׂא הַמַּעֲכָא = בְּשִׂא הַמַּעֲכָה, “In/at/by the height of Ma‘aveh,” or “In/at/by the upper part of the foundry/pit.”

בְּשִׂאֻבְשִׂא הַמַּעֲכָה = בְּשִׂאֻבְשִׂא הַמַּעֲכָה, “In/at/by the strong tower.”

בְּשִׂא הַמִּסְכָּה = בְּשִׂא הַמִּסְכָּה, “In/at/by (the) height/tower of the staircase,” or “In/at/by the staircase tower.” This is the suggested reading.

בְּשִׂא הַמִּסְכָּא = בְּשִׂא הַמִּסְכָּה, “In/at/by an/the top/upper part of the covering/fence/idol.”

בְּשִׂא הַמִּסְכָּא = בְּשִׂא הַמִּסְכָּה, “In/at/by the top/upper part of the covering/fence,” or “In/at/by a/the covered tower.”

בְּשִׂאֻבְשִׂא הַמַּעֲכָה = בְּשִׂאֻבְשִׂא הַמַּעֲכָה, “In/at/by a/the ruined tower.”

בְּשִׂאֻבְשִׂא הַמַּעֲכָא = בְּשִׂאֻבְשִׂא הַמַּעֲכָה, “In/at/by a/the tower of (the) Maacah.”

בְּשׂוֹאֻחַבְשִׂאֻחַ בִּיבָה = בְּשׂוֹחַבְשִׂיחַ בִּיבָה, “In/at/by a/the cistern/pit of a/the drain” (cf. Lurie).

בְּשׂוֹאֻחַבְשִׂאֻחַ כּוֹכָה = בְּשׂוֹחַבְשִׂיחַ כּוֹכָה, “In/at/by a/the cistern/pit of a/the burial niche.”

בְּשׂוֹאֻחַבְשִׂאֻחַ מִסְכָּה = בְּשׂוֹחַבְשִׂיחַ מִסְכָּה, “In/at/by a/the pit of a/the staircase.”

בְּשׂוֹאֻחַבְשִׂאֻחַ מִסְכָּא = בְּשׂוֹחַבְשִׂיחַ מִסְכָּה, “In/at/by a/the pit of a/the idol.”

בְּשׂוֹאֻחַבְשִׂאֻחַ מִסְכָּא = בְּשׂוֹחַבְשִׂיחַ מִסְכָּה, “In/at/by a/the covered pit.”

בְּשׂוֹאֲחוֹבְשִׁיָּא מַעְבָּה = בְּשׂוֹאֲחוֹבְשִׁיָּא מַעְבָּה, "In/at/by a/the pit of a/the Ma'aveh/foundry/pit."

בְּשׂוֹאֲחוֹבְשִׁיָּא מַעְבָּה - בְּשׂוֹאֲחוֹבְשִׁיָּא מַעְבָּה = בְּשׂוֹאֲחוֹבְשִׁיָּא מַעְבָּה, "In/at/by a/the strong/thick pit."

בְּשׂוֹאֲחוֹבְשִׁיָּא מַעְבָּה = בְּשׂוֹאֲחוֹבְשִׁיָּא מַעְבָּה, "In/at/by a/the ruined pit/cistern."

בְּשׂוֹאֲחוֹבְשִׁיָּא מַעְבָּה = בְּשׂוֹאֲחוֹבְשִׁיָּא מַעְבָּה, "In/at/by a/the pit/cistern of Maacah," i.e., Maacah's pit/cistern, or which is located in Maacah.

בְּשִׂיָּא בִּיבָה = בְּשִׂיָּא בִּיבָה, "In/at/by a/the deep pit of a/the drain."

בְּשִׂיָּא בִּיבָה = בְּשִׂיָּא בִּיבָה, "In/at/by a/the ruin of a/the drain."

בְּשִׂיָּא בִּיבָה = בְּשִׂיָּא בִּיבָה, "In/at/by a/the top of a/the drain."

בְּשִׂיָּא כּוּכָא = בְּשִׂיָּא כּוּכָא, "In/at/by a/the deep pit of a/the burial niche."

בְּשִׂיָּא כּוּכָא = בְּשִׂיָּא כּוּכָא, "In/at/by a/the ruin of a/the burial niche."

בְּשִׂיָּא כּוּכָא = בְּשִׂיָּא כּוּכָא, "In/at/by a/the top of a/the burial niche."

בְּשִׂיָּא מַסְבָּה = בְּשִׂיָּא מַסְבָּה, "In/at/by a/the deep pit of a/the staircase."

בְּשִׂיָּא מַסְבָּה = בְּשִׂיָּא מַסְבָּה, "In/at/by a/the ruin of a/the staircase."

בְּשִׂיָּא מַסְבָּה = בְּשִׂיָּא מַסְבָּה, "In/at/by a/the top of a/the staircase."

בְּשִׂיָּא מַסְכָּה = בְּשִׂיָּא מַסְכָּה, "In/at/by a/the deep pit of a/the idol."

בְּשִׂיָּא מַסְכָּה = בְּשִׂיָּא מַסְכָּה, "In/at/by a/the ruin of a/the idol."

בְּשִׂיָּא מַסְכָּה = בְּשִׂיָּא מַסְכָּה, "In/at/by a/the top of a/the idol."

בְּשִׂיָּא מְסוּכָה = בְּשִׂיָּא מְסוּכָה, "In/at/by a/the covered deep pit."

בְּשִׂיָּא מְסוּכָה = בְּשִׂיָּא מְסוּכָה, "In/at/by a/the covered ruin."

בְּשִׂיָּא מְסוּכָה = בְּשִׂיָּא מְסוּכָה, "In/at/by a/the covered top."

בְּשִׂיָּא מַעְבָּה = בְּשִׂיָּא מַעְבָּה, "In/at/by a/the deep pit of a/the Maabeh/foundry/pit."

בְּשִׂיָּא מַעְבָּה = בְּשִׂיָּא מַעְבָּה, "In/at/by a/the ruin of a/the Ma'aveh/foundry/pit."

בְּשִׂיָּא מַעְבָּה = בְּשִׂיָּא מַעְבָּה, "In/at/by a/the top/height of a/the Ma'aveh/foundry/pit."

בְּשִׂיָּא מַעְבָּה = בְּשִׂיָּא מַעְבָּה, "In/at/by a/the thick deep pit."

בְּשִׂיָּא מַעְבָּה = בְּשִׂיָּא מַעְבָּה, "In/at/by a/the thick ruin."

בְּשִׂיָּא מַעְבָּה = בְּשִׂיָּא מַעְבָּה, "In/at/by a/the thick top."

בְּשִׂיָּא מַעְבָּה = בְּשִׂיָּא מַעְבָּה, "In/at/by a/the deep pit of a/the Maacah/drain."

בְּשִׂיָּא מַעְבָּה = בְּשִׂיָּא מַעְבָּה, "In/at/by a/the ruin of a/the Maacah/drain."

בְּשִׂיָּא מַעְבָּה = בְּשִׂיָּא מַעְבָּה, "In/at/by a/the top of a/the Maacah/drain."

בְּשִׂיָּא מַעְבָּה = בְּשִׂיָּא מַעְבָּה, "In/at/by a/the devastated deep pit."

בְּשִׂיָּא מַעְבָּה = בְּשִׂיָּא מַעְבָּה, "In/at/by a/the devastated ruin."